CHENNAI - FRIDAY - AUGUST 21, 2026 ₹10 • Pages 14 • Volume 33 • Number 232

www.businessline.in businessline thehindubusinessline

the hindu businessline

BENGALURU - CHENNAI - COIMBATORE - HUBBALLI - HYDERABAD - KOCHI - KOLKATA - MADURAI - MALAPPURAM - MANGALURU - MUMBAI - NOIDA - THIRUVANANTHAPURAM - TIRUCHIRAPALLI - VIJAYAWADA - VISAKHAPATNAM Regd. TN/ARD/14/2012-2014, RNI No. 55320/94

(Please scan this QR code to view the Red Herring Prospectus and the Abridged Prospectus)

GAJA CAPITAL

GAJA ALTERNATIVE ASSET MANAGEMENT LIMITED
(TO BE LISTED ON THE MAIN BOARD OF BSE AND NSE)

Our Company was incorporated on April 9, 1999 in New Delhi, India as 'View Advisors Private Limited', a private limited company under the Companies Act, 1956 and was granted a certificate of incorporation by the Registrar of Companies, N.C.T. of Delhi and Haryana at New Delhi. Subsequently, pursuant to a special resolution passed by our Shareholders dated May 18, 2006, the name of our Company was changed to 'Gaja Advisors Private Limited' and a fresh certificate of incorporation dated June 8, 2006 was issued by the Registrar of Companies, National Capital Territory of Delhi and Haryana at New Delhi. Thereafter, pursuant to a special resolution passed by our Shareholders dated May 25, 2022, the name of our Company was changed to 'Gaja Alternative Asset Management Private Limited' and a fresh certificate of incorporation dated July 5, 2022 was issued by the Registrar of Companies, Delhi and Haryana at New Delhi. Our Company was then converted into a public limited company under the Companies Act pursuant to a special resolution adopted by our Shareholders on December 9, 2024, consequent to which, the name of our Company was changed to 'Gaja Alternative Asset Management Limited' and a fresh certificate of incorporation was issued to our Company by the Registrar of Companies, Central Processing Centre on January 1, 2025. For further details in relation to changes in the name and the registered office of our Company, see *"History and Certain Corporate Matters"* on page 250 of the red herring prospectus dated August 12, 2026 ("**RHP**" or "**Red Herring Prospectus**") filed with the RoC.

Registered Office: 302, 3rd Floor, Kanchenjunga Building, 18, Barakhamba Road, Connaught Place, New Delhi - 110 001, India. **Corporate Office:** 1402, Tower 2B, One World Center, Senapati Bapat Marg, Lower Parel, Delisle Road, Mumbai - 400 013, Maharashtra, India
Contact Person: Ms. Ishu Jain, Company Secretary and Compliance Officer; **Tel:** +91 91368 89894; **E-mail:** compliance@gajacapital.com; **Website:** www.gajacapital.com; **Corporate Identity Number:** U67190DL1999PLC099260

OUR PROMOTERS: MR. GOPAL JAIN, MR. RANJIT JAYANT SHAH, MR. IMRAN JAFAR, MS. CHITRA JAIN AND MS. MONA RANJIT SHAH

INITIAL PUBLIC OFFERING OF UP TO [●] EQUITY SHARES OF FACE VALUE ₹5 EACH ("EQUITY SHARES") OF GAJA ALTERNATIVE ASSET MANAGEMENT LIMITED ("OUR COMPANY" OR THE "COMPANY" OR THE "ISSUER") FOR CASH AT A PRICE OF ₹[●] PER EQUITY SHARE (INCLUDING A PREMIUM OF ₹[●] PER EQUITY SHARE) (THE "OFFER PRICE") AGGREGATING UP TO ₹5,500.00 MILLION (THE "OFFER") COMPRISING A FRESH ISSUE OF UP TO [●] EQUITY SHARES AGGREGATING UP TO ₹4,500.00 MILLION BY OUR COMPANY (THE "FRESH ISSUE") AND AN OFFER FOR SALE OF UP TO [●] EQUITY SHARES AGGREGATING UP TO ₹1,000.00 MILLION (THE "OFFER FOR SALE"), COMPRISING UP TO [●] EQUITY SHARES OF FACE VALUE ₹5 EACH AGGREGATING UP TO ₹293.50 MILLION BY MR. RANJIT JAYANT SHAH JOINTLY HELD WITH MS. MONA RANJIT SHAH AND UP TO [●] EQUITY SHARES OF FACE VALUE ₹5 EACH AGGREGATING UP TO ₹200.00 MILLION BY MR. IMRAN JAFAR (THE "PROMOTER SELLING SHAREHOLDERS"), UP TO [●] EQUITY SHARES OF FACE VALUE ₹5 EACH AGGREGATING UP TO ₹187.50 MILLION BY MR. SANJAY HIRALAL PATEL, UP TO [●] EQUITY SHARES OF FACE VALUE ₹5 EACH AGGREGATING UP TO ₹100.00 MILLION BY MS. SUDESH JAIN JOINTLY HELD WITH MR. GOPAL JAIN, UP TO [●] EQUITY SHARES OF FACE VALUE ₹5 EACH AGGREGATING UP TO ₹94.00 MILLION BY MR. ANSHUMAN GOYAL, UP TO [●] EQUITY SHARES OF FACE VALUE ₹5 EACH AGGREGATING UP TO ₹50.00 MILLION BY MR. ABHINAV JAIN AND UP TO [●] EQUITY SHARES OF FACE VALUE ₹5 EACH AGGREGATING UP TO ₹50.00 MILLION BY MR. SUSHANE CHOPRA AND UP TO [●] EQUITY SHARES OF FACE VALUE ₹5 EACH AGGREGATING UP TO ₹25.00 MILLION BY MS. SUPARNA KUMAR (THE "OTHER SELLING SHAREHOLDERS", COLLECTIVELY WITH THE PROMOTER SELLING SHAREHOLDERS, THE "SELLING SHAREHOLDERS", AND SUCH EQUITY SHARES CUMULATIVELY OFFERED BY THE SELLING SHAREHOLDERS, THE "OFFERED SHARES").

DETAILS OF THE SELLING SHAREHOLDERS, OFFER FOR SALE AND THE WEIGHTED AVERAGE COST OF ACQUISITION

NAME OF THE SELLING SHAREHOLDERS	TYPE OF SELLING SHAREHOLDER	NUMBER OF EQUITY SHARES OFFERED / AMOUNT	WEIGHTED AVERAGE COST OF ACQUISITION PER EQUITY SHARE (₹)*
Mr. Ranjit Jayant Shah jointly held with Ms. Mona Ranjit Shah	Promoter Selling Shareholder	Up to [●] Equity Shares of face value ₹5 each aggregating up to ₹293.50 million	0.10
Mr. Imran Jafar	Promoter Selling Shareholder	Up to [●] Equity Shares of face value ₹5 each aggregating up to ₹200.00 million	7.28
Ms. Sudesh Jain jointly held with Mr. Gopal Jain	Promoter Group Selling Shareholder	Up to [●] Equity Shares of face value ₹5 each aggregating up to ₹100.00 million	0.00
Mr. Sanjay Hiralal Patel	Other Selling Shareholder	Up to [●] Equity Shares of face value ₹5 each aggregating up to ₹187.50 million	0.12
Mr. Anshuman Goyal	Other Selling Shareholder	Up to [●] Equity Shares of face value ₹5 each aggregating up to ₹94.00 million	0.00
Mr. Abhinav Jain	Other Selling Shareholder	Up to [●] Equity Shares of face value ₹5 each aggregating up to ₹50.00 million	11.66
Mr. Sushane Chopra	Other Selling Shareholder	Up to [●] Equity Shares of face value ₹5 each aggregating up to ₹50.00 million	20.58
Ms. Suparna Kumar	Other Selling Shareholder	Up to [●] Equity Shares of face value ₹5 each aggregating up to ₹25.00 million	0.10

**As certified by Nangia & Co. LLP, Chartered Accountants, pursuant to the certificate dated August 12, 2026, UDIN: 26076879RYKHAC8740. For further details, see "The Offer" on page 64 of the RHP.*

PRICE BAND: ₹152 TO ₹160 PER EQUITY SHARE OF FACE VALUE OF ₹ 5 EACH.
THE FLOOR PRICE AND THE CAP PRICE ARE 30.40 TIMES AND 32.00 TIMES THE FACE VALUE OF THE EQUITY SHARES, RESPECTIVELY.
BIDS CAN BE MADE FOR A MINIMUM OF 93 EQUITY SHARES OF FACE VALUE OF ₹ 5 EACH AND IN MULTIPLES OF 93 EQUITY SHARES OF FACE VALUE OF ₹5 EACH THEREAFTER.
THE PRICE TO EARNINGS RATIO ("P/E") BASED ON BASIC AND DILUTED EARNINGS PER SHARE ("EPS") FOR FINANCIAL YEAR ENDED 2026 FOR THE COMPANY AT THE UPPER END OF THE PRICE BAND IS 22.32 TIMES AND AT THE LOWER END OF THE PRICE BAND IS 21.20 TIMES.
WEIGHTED AVERAGE RETURN ON NET WORTH FOR LAST THREE FISCAL YEARS IS 13.90%.

The details of the Fresh Issue, Offer for Sale, Total Offer Size and the post Offer market capitalization of the Company, each at the Floor Price and the Cap Price, are given below:

Particulars	At Floor Price of ₹152		At Cap Price of ₹160	
	Up to No. of Equity Shares of face value of ₹ 5 each	Up to Amount (₹ in million)	Up to No. of Equity Shares of face value of ₹5 each	Up to Amount (₹ in million)
Fresh Issue	2,96,05,263	4,500.00	2,81,25,000	4,500.00
Offer for Sale	65,78,947	1,000.00	62,50,000	1,000.00
Total Offer Size	3,61,84,210	5,500.00	3,43,75,000	5,500.00
Post-Offer market capitalization of the Company	14,24,90,493	21,658.55	14,10,10,230	22,561.64

BID/OFFER PROGRAMME	BID/OFFER CLOSES TODAY*

**UPI mandate end time and date shall be at 5.00 p.m. on the Bid/Offer Closing Date.*

We are an investment manager to India focused funds, including category II and category I alternative investment funds ("AIFs") and also act as advisors to offshore funds, which provide capital to companies in India.

THE OFFER IS BEING MADE THROUGH THE BOOK BUILDING PROCESS IN ACCORDANCE WITH REGULATION 6(1) OF THE SEBI ICDR REGULATIONS.
THE EQUITY SHARES OF OUR COMPANY WILL GET LISTED ON THE MAIN BOARD OF THE STOCK EXCHANGES. NSE SHALL BE THE DESIGNATED STOCK EXCHANGE.
QIB PORTION: NOT MORE THAN 50% OF THE OFFER | NON-INSTITUTIONAL PORTION: NOT LESS THAN 15% OF THE OFFER | RETAIL PORTION: NOT LESS THAN 35% OF THE OFFER

IN MAKING AN INVESTMENT DECISION, POTENTIAL INVESTORS MUST ONLY RELY ON THE INFORMATION INCLUDED IN THE RED HERRING PROSPECTUS AND THE TERMS OF THE OFFER, INCLUDING THE RISKS INVOLVED AND NOT RELY ON ANY OTHER EXTERNAL SOURCES OF INFORMATION ABOUT THE OFFER AVAILABLE IN ANY MANNER. IN RELATION TO PRICE BAND, POTENTIAL INVESTORS SHOULD ONLY REFER TO THE PRE-OFFER AND PRICE BAND ADVERTISEMENT DATED AUGUST 12, 2026 AND PUBLISHED ON AUGUST 13, 2026, FOR THE OFFER AND SHOULD NOT RELY ON ANY MEDIA ARTICLES / REPORTS IN RELATION TO THE VALUATION OF OUR COMPANY AS THESE ARE NOT ENDORSED, PUBLISHED OR CONFIRMED EITHER BY THE COMPANY OR THE BOOK RUNNING LEAD MANAGERS TO THE OFFER ("BRLMs").

IN ACCORDANCE WITH THE RECOMMENDATION OF THE COMMITTEE OF INDEPENDENT DIRECTORS OF OUR COMPANY, PURSUANT TO THEIR RESOLUTION DATED AUGUST 12, 2026, THE ABOVE PROVIDED PRICE BAND IS JUSTIFIED BASED ON QUANTITATIVE FACTORS/ KEY PERFORMANCE INDICATORS ("KPI") DISCLOSED IN THE *'BASIS FOR OFFER PRICE'* SECTION *VIS-A-VIS* THE WEIGHTED AVERAGE COST OF ACQUISITION ("WACA") OF PRIMARY AND SECONDARY TRANSACTION(S), AS APPLICABLE, DISCLOSED IN *'BASIS FOR OFFER PRICE'* SECTION ON PAGE 124 OF THE RHP.

RISK TO INVESTORS
For details refer to section titled "Risk Factors" beginning on page 20 of the RHP

1. **Dependence of our total income on the performance of funds -** A significant portion of our total income is derived from Management Fee, Carried Interest and Income from Sponsor Commitment in relation to funds managed and advised by us. For Fiscals 2026, 2025 and 2024, Management Fee from the funds managed and advised by us constituted 38.07%, 46.65%, and 72.96% of our total income, respectively. Poor performance of the funds managed and advised by us would cause a decline in our income from such funds and could therefore have a negative effect on our performance, cash flows and financial condition.
2. **Historical returns of the funds may not be indicative of future performance -** We commenced our initial investment management and advisory operations with a set of four investments made on a deal-by-deal basis between 2005 and 2007 ("Prior Investments"). Our Prior Investments aggregated to ₹210.93 million which was invested by us on a deal-by-deal basis between 2005 and 2007. As of March 31, 2026, all the Prior Investments have been fully realized with an MOIC of 5.61x. Fund II was formed in 2007 and Fund III was formed in 2015 and was deployed by 2020 with ten investments and is in its exit phase with two partial realizations, as of March 31, 2026. Fund IV was formed in 2021 and as of March 31, 2026, had made six investments, deploying 62.00% of the total capital of the fund. The historical returns attributable to the funds managed and advised by us should not be considered as indicative of the future results of such funds and may be significantly lower than the historical returns.
3. **Uncertainty in timing and receipt of Carried Interest -** Decline in realized or unrealized gains, or an increase in realized or unrealized losses on account of fluctuation in our Carried Interest, could adversely affect our investment income, which could further increase the volatility of our quarterly results and adversely affect our financial condition and results of operations. The breakdown of our income from Carried Interest for the periods indicated have been set forth below:

Particulars	For the Financial Year ended,					
	March 31, 2026		March 31, 2025		March 31, 2024	
	Income	% of total Income	Income	% of total Income	Income	% of total Income
	(₹ million)	%	(₹ million)	%	(₹ million)	%
Carried Interest	754.11	47.79	644.26	52.25	183.95	17.69

4. **Valuation risk in respect of fund assets -** Valuation methodologies for certain assets of the funds managed and advised by us can be susceptible to significant subjectivity and the derived values of assets may not be realized, which could result in significant losses for such funds. The table below sets out the fair market value of Sponsor Commitments to Gaja Capital Funds for the periods indicated.

Particulars	Fiscal				
	2026	Change from the prior Fiscal	2025	Change from the prior Fiscal	2024
	(₹ million)	%	(₹ million)	%	(₹ million)
Financial Assets					
Fair market value of Sponsor Commitments to Gaja Capital Funds	2,436.23	20.88	2,015.42	(8.59)	2,204.75

5. **Risk relating to capital commitments from Limited Partners -** We depend on Limited Partners for capital infusion in the funds managed and advised by us. Further, the funds managed and advised by us are also dependent on the Limited Partners honoring their capital calls, in accordance with the agreements entered into between the Limited Partners and our Company. As of March 31, 2026, we had 298 Limited Partners associated with us, of which 139 were located in India and 159 were located outside India. Our inability to raise sufficient capital from Limited Partners or their inability to honor capital calls in relation to the funds managed and advised by us could adversely affect our results of operations, financial condition and cash flows.
6. **Regulatory compliance and inspection risk -** The alternative asset management industry, securities market and our business are subject to regulations in India issued by the SEBI, the MCA, the RBI, and other governmental and regulatory authorities. We are also subjected to periodic reviews, requests for submission of information, audit and inspections from the SEBI for the funds managed and advised by us. Any future violation of an applicable regulation may result in administrative or judicial proceedings being initiated against us that may result in fines, trading bans, deregistration or suspension of our business and the licenses of the funds managed and advised by us, the suspension or disqualification of our Directors or employees, or other adverse consequences.
7. **Risk of adverse audit remarks and matters of emphasis -** The auditor's report to the standalone financial statements of our Company as of and for the Fiscal ended March 31, 2026 and March 31, 2025 makes reference to certain matters of emphasis and the auditor's report to the consolidated financial statements of our Company as of and for the Fiscals ended March 31, 2026, March 31, 2025 and March 31, 2024, includes adverse remarks relating to the audit trail feature in the accounting software, which has since been addressed through implementation of an audit trail-enabled accounting system effective August 28, 2025. However we cannot assure that our financial information for future periods will not contain such adverse remarks. *For further details please refer to Risk Factor no. 7 of the RHP.*
8. **Risk associated with overseas operations -** As a part of our business operations, we operate Subsidiaries in Cayman Islands and Mauritius. Each of these countries have distinct legal and regulatory systems and we may be subject to risks arising from the distinct legal, regulatory and operational environments in these jurisdictions.
9. **Related party transactions risk -** We enter into certain related party transactions (including our Promoters, members of the Promoter Group, Directors, and Group Companies) in the ordinary course of our business and we cannot assure you that such transactions will not adversely affect our business, results of operations and financial condition. Set out below are the details of our related party transactions (excluding related party transactions eliminated during the year) for the period indicated.

Particulars	Fiscal		
	2026	2025	2024
	(₹ million)		
Total related party transactions#	1,621.57	1,402.44	1,101.96
Total income	1,577.97	1,233.07	1,039.60
Related party transactions as a percentage of total income (%)*	102.76%	113.74%	106.00%

 # Total related party transactions means sale of services (in the form of Advisory services, Trustee Fees and Fund set up fees), employee benefit cost, finance cost, consultancy charges, legal and professional charges, rent paid and director's sitting fees (including directorship fees) (in absolute terms).
** Includes transactions relating to income and expenses and therefore, for Fiscals 2026, 2025 and 2024 this total exceeds 100.00%.*

10. **Risk relating to Promoter Group disclosures -** One of the members of our Promoter Group, Mr. Johrilal Jain, has not provided his consent to be identified as a member of our Promoter Group and has not provided any information in respect of himself and his relevant entities as Promoter Group. All the disclosures pertaining to Mr. Johrilal Jain and his relevant entities (if any) as members of the Promoter Group in the Red Herring Prospectus, have been included based on, and limited to the extent of, publicly available information.
11. **Liquidity Risk -** The funds managed and advised by us typically make investments in equity and convertible securities of private companies, which are unlisted, and such securities are generally illiquid and comparatively less active when compared to the listed counterparts, exposing our Sponsor Commitment to the risk of illiquidity.
12. **Offer-related risk -** We will not receive any proceeds from the Offer for Sale, which aggregates up to ₹1,000.00 million (i.e. 18.18% of the Offer size) and such proceeds from the Offer for Sale will be received by the Selling Shareholders.
13. The details of the Price/Earnings (P/E), Earnings per Share (EPS), Return on Net Worth (RoNW) and Net Asset Value (NAV) per Equity Share for our Company and peer group for Fiscal 2026 are set forth below:

Name of Company	Revenue from operations (₹ million)	Face value (₹ per share)	Closing price on August 11, 2026# (in ₹)	EPS		NAV (per share) (₹)	P/E (no. of times)	RoNW (%)
				Basic	Diluted			
Gaja Alternative Asset Management Limited*	1,355.31	5.00	160***	7.17	7.17	53.73	22.32***	13.13
Listed peers**								
360 One WAM Limited	43,616.20	1.00	1,168.00	30.16	29.19	242.17	40.01	12.37
Aditya Birla Sun Life AMC Limited	18,450.30	5.00	1,019.70	33.76	33.68	139.94	30.28	24.13
Anand Rathi Wealth Limited	11,488.25	5.00	2,158.00	47.87	47.17	120.23	91.50 ^	39.64
HDFC Asset Management Company Limited	41,221.60	5.00	2,515.00	66.77	66.50	215.42	37.82	30.97
ICICI Prudential Asset Management Company Limited	57,646.30	1.00	3,028.50	66.73	66.73	84.39	45.38	79.07

Continued on next page...

...continued from previous page.

Name of Company	Revenue from operations (₹ million)	Face value (₹ per share)	Closing price on August 11, 2026# (in ₹)	EPS		NAV (per share) (₹)	P/E (no. of times)	RoNW (%)
				Basic	Diluted			
Nippon Life India Asset Management Limited	27,087.40	10.00	1,171.30	24.05	23.63	73.01	49.57	32.83
Nuvama Wealth Management Limited	46,306.90	2.00	1,706.70	57.59	56.06	226.37	30.44	25.26
SBI Funds Management Limited	43,894.88	1.00	568.45	15.08	15.04	29.28	37.80	51.44
UTI Asset Management Company Limited	16,980.50	10.00	905.80	31.51	31.41	350.50	28.84	8.97

*Financial information of our Company has been derived from the Restated Consolidated Financial Statements for the Fiscal ended March 31, 2026.
**All the financial information for listed industry peers mentioned above is on a consolidated basis (unless otherwise available only on standalone basis) and is sourced from the financial statements of the respective companies for the financial year ended March 31, 2026, submitted to stock exchanges.
#Share price reported above are the closing price on the NSE as of August 11, 2026.
^Anand Rathi Wealth Limited undertook a bonus issue (one bonus equity share of face value ₹5 each for every one equity share held). Record date for the corporate action was June 3, 2026. The P/E Ratio presented is after taking into consideration this bonus issue by retrospectively adjusting as if the event had occurred at the beginning of the period presented.
Source: Annual report of the peer companies for the Financial Year 2026 submitted to the relevant stock exchanges.
***Determined based on the Cap Price.
For further details please refer - *"Basis for Offer Price"* beginning on page 124 of the RHP

14. Average cost of acquisition of specified securities for our Promoters and the Selling Shareholders:
The average cost of acquisition of Equity Shares for our Promoters and the Selling Shareholders as of the date of the Red Herring Prospectus is as set out below:

S. No.	Name	Number of Equity Shares held	Face Value ₹	Average cost of acquisition per Equity Share(1)* ₹
Promoter Selling Shareholders				
1.	Mr. Ranjit Jayant Shah jointly held with Ms. Mona Ranjit Shah(2)	21,008,400	5	0.10
2.	Mr. Imran Jafar(2)	10,304,120	5	7.28
Other Selling Shareholders				
3.	Ms. Sudesh Jain jointly held with Mr. Gopal Jain	10,866,845	5	0.00
4.	Mr. Sanjay Hiralal Patel	5,002,000	5	0.12
5.	Mr. Anshuman Goyal	3,001,200	5	0.00
Other Selling Shareholders				
6.	Mr. Abhinav Jain	3,096,238	5	11.66
7.	Mr. Sushane Chopra	2,080,832	5	20.58
8.	Ms. Suparna Kumar	1,500,600	5	0.10

*As certified by Nangia & Co. LLP, Chartered Accountants, by way of their certificate dated August 12, 2026, UDIN: 26076879RYKHAC8740.
(1) Adjusted for (i) the split of Equity Shares from face value of ₹10 each to ₹5 each pursuant to Shareholders resolution dated March 3, 2025, and (ii) bonus issuance of Equity Shares by our Company pursuant to Shareholders resolution dated June 5, 2025.
(2) Computation of average cost of acquisition includes cost paid to existing shareholders towards their right to renounce.

15. Weighted average cost of acquisition: for equity shares transacted by Promoters, Promoter Group and Selling Shareholders over the preceding three years and one year preceding the date of the Red Herring Prospectus.

Period	Weighted average cost of acquisition (in ₹)(1)	Cap Price is 'X' times the Weighted average cost of acquisition	Range of acquisition price: lowest price – highest price (in ₹)(1)
Last three years	Nil	N.A.	Nil - Nil
Last one year	Nil	N.A.	Nil - Nil

(1) As certified by Nangia & Co. LLP, Chartered Accountants, pursuant to the certificate dated August 12, 2026, UDIN: 26076879VCCONI8227.

16. The two BRLMs associated with the Offer have handled 74 public issues in the past three years, out of which 24 issues closed below the offer price on listing date.

Name of the BRLMs	Total Public Issues	Issues closed below the issue price on listing date
JM Financial Limited*	27	11
IIFL Capital Services Limited *(formerly known as IIFL Securities Limited)**	30	10
Common Issues of above BRLMs	17	3
Total	**74**	**24**

Issues handled where there were no common BRLMs.

ADDITIONAL INFORMATION FOR INVESTORS

1. The Company has not undertaken a pre-IPO placement.
2. The Promoters or members of the Promoter Group have not undertaken any transaction of shares aggregating up to 1% or more of the paid-up equity share capital of the Company from the date of RHP till date.

BASIS FOR OFFER PRICE

*(The **"Basis for Offer Price"** section on page 124 of the RHP will be updated with the above price band. Please refer to the websites of the BRLMs:* www.jmfl.com and www.iiflcapital.com, respectively, *for the "Basis for Offer Price" updated with the above price band)* (you may scan the QR code for accessing the website of **JM Financial Limited**)

An indicative timetable in respect of the Offer is set out below:
Submission of Bids (other than Bids from Anchor Investors):

Bid/Offer Period (except the Bid/Offer Closing Date)	
Submission and Revision in Bids	Only between 10.00 a.m. and 5.00 p.m. (Indian Standard Time ("IST")
Bid/Offer Closing Date*	
Submission of electronic applications (online ASBA through 3-in-1 accounts) – For RIBs	Only between 10.00 a.m. and up to 5.00 p.m. IST
Submission of electronic application (bank ASBA through online channels like internet banking, mobile banking and syndicate ASBA applications through UPI as a payment mechanism where Bid Amount is up to ₹500,000)	Only between 10.00 a.m. and up to 4.00 p.m. IST
Submission of electronic applications (syndicate non-retail, non-individual applications of QIBs and NIBs)	Only between 10.00 a.m. and up to 3.00 p.m. IST
Submission of physical applications (direct bank ASBA)	Only between 10.00 a.m. and up to 1.00 p.m. IST
Submission of physical applications (syndicate non-retail, non-individual applications where Bid Amount is more than ₹500,000)	Only between 10.00 a.m. and up to 12.00 p.m. IST
Revision/cancellation of Bids	
Upward Revision of Bids by QIBs and Non-Institutional Bidders categories#	Only between 10.00 a.m. and up to 4.00 p.m. IST on Bid/Offer Closing Date
Upward or downward Revision of Bids or cancellation of Bids by RIBs	Only between 10.00 a.m. and up to 5.00 p.m. IST

**UPI mandate end time and date shall be at 5 p.m. on the Bid/Offer Closing Date.*
 # QIBs and Non-Institutional Bidders can neither revise their bids downwards nor cancel/withdraw their Bids.

Bid/Offer Programme

Event	Indicative Date
Bid/Offer opened on	Wednesday, August 19, 2026(1)
Bid/Offer closes on	Friday, August 21, 2026(2)
Finalisation of Basis of Allotment with the Designated Stock Exchange	On or about Monday, August 24, 2026
Initiation of refunds (if any, for Anchor Investors)/unblocking of funds from ASBA Account*	On or about Tuesday, August 25, 2026
Credit of Equity Shares to dematerialized accounts of Allottees	On or about Tuesday, August 25, 2026
Commencement of trading of the Equity Shares on the Stock Exchanges	On or about Wednesday, August 26, 2026

(1) The Anchor Investor Bid/Offer Period was Tuesday, August 18, 2026, i.e., one Working Day prior to the Bid/Offer Opening Date in accordance with the SEBI ICDR Regulations.
(2) The UPI mandate end time and date shall be 5:00 p.m. on the Bid /Offer Closing Date.
**In case of any delay in unblocking of amounts in the ASBA Accounts (including amounts blocked through the UPI Mechanism) exceeding two Working Days from the Bid/Offer Closing Date for cancelled / withdrawn / deleted ASBA Forms, the Bidder shall be compensated at a uniform rate of ₹100 per day or 15 % per annum of the Bid Amount, whichever is higher from the date on which the request for cancellation/ withdrawal/ deletion is placed in the Stock Exchanges bidding platform until the date on which the amounts are unblocked; (ii) any blocking of multiple amounts for the same ASBA Form (for amounts blocked through the UPI Mechanism), the Bidder shall be compensated at a uniform rate of ₹100 per day or 15% per annum of the total cumulative blocked amount except the original application amount, whichever is higher from the date on which such multiple amounts were blocked till the date of actual unblock; (iii) any blocking of amounts more than the Bid Amount, the Bidder shall be compensated at a uniform rate of ₹100 per day or 15% per annum of the difference in amount, whichever is higher from the date on which such excess amounts were blocked till the date of actual unblock; (iv) any delay in unblocking of non-allotted/ partially allotted Bids, exceeding two Working Days from the Bid/Offer Closing Date, the Bidder shall be compensated at a uniform rate of ₹100 per day or 15% per annum of the Bid Amount, whichever is higher for the entire duration of delay exceeding two Working Days from the Bid/Offer Closing Date by the SCSB responsible for causing such delay in unblocking. The BRLMs shall, in their sole discretion, identify and fix the liability on such intermediary or entity responsible for such delay in unblocking. The Bidder shall be compensated in the manner specified in the SEBI ICDR Master Circular and the SEBI RTA Master Circular, which for the avoidance of doubt, shall be deemed to be incorporated in the deemed agreement of the Company with the SCSBs and relevant intermediaries, to the extent applicable.*

ASBA# Simple, Safe, Smart way of Application!!!

Applications supported by blocked amount (ASBA) is a better way of applying to issues by simply blocking the fund in the bank account. For further details, check section on ASBA.

Mandatory in public issues. No cheque will be accepted.

UNIFIED PAYMENTS INTERFACE

UPI-Now available in ASBA for Retail Individual Investors and Non - Institutional Investor applying for amount upto ₹ 500,000 applying through Registered Brokers, DPs and RTAs. UPI Bidders also have the option to submit the application directly to the ASBA Bank (SCSBs) or to use the facility of linked online trading, demat and bank account. Investors are required to ensure that the bank account used for bidding is linked to their PAN. Bidders must ensure that their PAN is linked with Aadhaar and are in compliance with CBDT notification dated February 13, 2020, issued by the Central Board of Direct Taxes and the subsequent press releases, including press releases dated June 25, 2021 and September 17, 2021 and CBDT circular no.7 of 2022, dated March 30, 2022 read with press release dated March 28, 2023 and any subsequent press releases in this regard.

ASBA has to be availed by all the investors except Anchor Investors. UPI may be availed by (i) Retail Individual Investors in the Retail Portion; (ii) Non-Institutional Investors with an application size of up to ₹ 0.50 million in the Non-Institutional Portion. For details on the ASBA and UPI process, please refer to the details given in ASBA form and abridged prospectus and also please refer to the section ***"Offer Procedure"*** on page 407 of the RHP. The process is also available on the website of Association of Investment Bankers of India ("**AIBI**") and Stock Exchanges and in the General Information Document. ASBA bid-cum-application forms can be downloaded from the websites of the Stock Exchanges and can be obtained from the list of banks that is displayed on the website of SEBI at www.sebi.gov.in/sebiweb/other/OtherAction.do?doRecognisedFpi=yes&intmId=35 and https://www.sebi.gov.in/sebiweb/other/OtherAction.do?doRecognisedFpi= yes&intmId=43, respectively as updated from time to time. For the list of UPI apps and banks live on IPO, please refer to the link: www.sebi.gov.in. UPI Bidders Bidding using the UPI mechanism may apply through the SCSBs and mobile applications whose names appear on the website of SEBI, as updated from time to time. HDFC Bank Limited and ICICI Bank Limited have been appointed as Sponsor Banks for the Offer, in accordance with the requirements of the SEBI Circular dated November 1, 2018 as amended. For Offer related queries, please contact the BRLMs on their respective email IDs as mentioned below. For UPI related queries, investors can contact NPCI at the toll free number: 18001201740 and mail Id: ipo.upi@npci.org.in.

THE EQUITY SHARES OF OUR COMPANY WILL GET LISTED ON MAIN BOARD PLATFORM OF THE STOCK EXCHANGES

In case of any revision in the Price Band, the Bid/Offer Period will be extended by at least three additional Working Days after such revision of the Price Band, subject to the Bid/Offer Period not exceeding 10 Working Days. In cases of force majeure, banking strike or similar unforeseen circumstances, our Company may, in consultation with the BRLMs, for reasons to be recorded in writing, extend the Bid/Offer Period for a minimum of one Working Day, subject to the Bid/Offer Period not exceeding 10 Working Days. Any revision in the Price Band and the revised Bid/Offer Period, if applicable, will be widely disseminated by notification to the Stock Exchanges, by issuing a public notice, and also by indicating the change on the respective websites of the BRLMs and at the terminals of the Syndicate Members and by intimation to the Self-Certified Syndicate Banks (**"SCSBs"**), other Designated Intermediaries and the Sponsor Banks, as applicable.

The Offer is being made through the Book Building Process, in terms of Rule 19(2)(b) of the Securities Contract (Regulation) Rules, 1957 as amended (the **"SCRR"**), read with Regulation 31 of the SEBI ICDR Regulations and in compliance with Regulation 6(1) of the SEBI ICDR Regulations, wherein not more than 50% of the Offer shall be available for allocation on a proportionate basis to Qualified Institutional Buyers (**"QIBs"**, and such portion, the **"QIB Portion"**), provided that our Company may, in consultation with the BRLMs, allocate up to 60% of the QIB Portion to Anchor Investors on a discretionary basis, in accordance with the SEBI ICDR Regulations (the "Anchor Investor Portion"), of which 40% shall be reserved for allocation in the following manner (i) 33.33% of the Anchor Investor Portion shall be reserved for domestic Mutual Funds; and (ii) 6.67% of the Anchor Investor Portion shall be reserved for Life Insurance Companies and Pension Funds, subject to valid Bids being received from domestic Mutual Funds, Life Insurance Companies and Pension Funds, as applicable, at or above the Anchor Investor Allocation Price. Any under-subscription in the portion for Life Insurance Companies and Pension Funds as specified in (ii) above, may be allocated to domestic Mutual Funds, in accordance with the SEBI ICDR Regulations. In the event of under-subscription or non-allocation in the Anchor Investor Portion, the balance Equity Shares shall be added to the remaining QIB Portion (**"Net QIB Portion"**). Further, 5% of the Net QIB Portion shall be available for allocation on a proportionate basis only to Mutual Funds, and the remainder of the Net QIB Portion shall be available for allocation on a proportionate basis to all QIBs, including Mutual Funds, subject to valid Bids being received at or above the Offer Price. However, if the aggregate demand from the Mutual Funds is less than 5% of the Net QIB Portion, the balance Equity Shares available for allocation will be added to the remaining QIB Portion for proportionate allocation to QIBs. Further, not less than 15% of the Offer shall be available for allocation on a proportionate basis to Non-Institutional Bidders in accordance with the SEBI ICDR Regulations, subject to valid Bids being received at or above the Offer Price, out of which (a) one-third of such portion shall be reserved for Bidders with application size of more than ₹200,000 and up to ₹1,000,000; and (b) two-thirds of such portion shall be reserved for Bidders with application size of more than ₹1,000,000, provided that the unsubscribed portion in either of such sub-categories may be allocated to Bidders in the other sub-category of Non-Institutional Bidders; and not less than 35% of the Offer shall be available for allocation to Retail Individual Bidders in accordance with the SEBI ICDR Regulations, subject to valid Bids being received at or above the Offer Price. All potential Bidders (except Anchor Investors) are mandatorily required to utilize the Application Supported by Blocked Amount (**"ASBA"**) process by providing details of their respective ASBA accounts and UPI ID in case of UPI Bidders using the UPI Mechanism, as applicable, pursuant to which their corresponding Bid Amount will be blocked by the Self Certified Syndicate Banks (**"SCSBs"**) or by the Sponsor Banks under the UPI Mechanism, as the case may be, to the extent of the respective Bid Amounts. Anchor Investors are not permitted to participate in the Offer through the ASBA process. For further details, see *"Offer Procedure"* on page 407 of the RHP.

Bidders/ Applicants should ensure that DP ID, PAN, Client ID and UPI ID (for UPI Bidders bidding through the UPI Mechanism) are correctly filled in the Bid cum Application Form. The DP ID, PAN and Client ID provided in the Bid cum Application Form should match with the DP ID, PAN, Client ID available in the Depository database, otherwise, the Bid cum Application Form is liable to be rejected. Bidders/ Applicants should ensure that the beneficiary account provided in the Bid cum Application Form is active. Bidders/Applicants should note that on the basis of the PAN, DP ID, Client ID and UPI ID (for UPI Bidders bidding through the UPI Mechanism) as provided in the Bid cum Application Form, the Bidder/Applicant may be deemed to have authorised the Depositories to provide to the Registrar to the Offer, any requested Demographic Details of the Bidder/Applicant as available on the records of the depositories. These Demographic Details may be used, among other things, for giving Allotment Advice or unblocking of ASBA Account or for other correspondence(s) related to the Offer. Bidders/Applicants are advised to update any changes to their Demographic Details as available in the records of the Depository Participant to ensure accuracy of records. Any delay resulting from failure to update the Demographic Details would be at the Bidders'/Applicants' sole risk. Investors must ensure that their PAN is linked with Aadhaar and are in compliance with CBDT notification dated February 13, 2020 and press release dated June 25, 2021, read with press release dated September 17, 2021 and CBDT circular no.7 of 2022, dated March 30, 2022 read with press release dated March 28, 2023 and any subsequent press releases in this regard.

Contents of the Memorandum of Association of our Company as regards its objects: For information on the main objects of our Company, please see the section ***"History and Certain Corporate Matters - Main Objects of our Company"*** on page 250 of the RHP. The Memorandum of Association of our Company is a material document for inspection in relation to the Offer. For further details, please see the section titled **"*Material Contracts and Documents for Inspection*"** on page 480 of the RHP.

Liability of the members of our Company: Limited by shares

Amount of share capital of our Company and Capital structure: As on the date of the RHP, the authorised share capital of the Company is ₹ 750,000,000 divided into 150,000,000 Equity Shares of face value of ₹ 5 each. The issued, subscribed and paid-up share capital of the Company is ₹ 564,426,150 divided into 112,885,230 Equity Shares of face value of ₹5 each. For details, please see the section titled ***"Capital Structure"*** beginning on page 88 of the RHP.

Names of signatories to the Memorandum of Association of our Company and the number of Equity Shares subscribed by them: The names of the initial signatories of the Memorandum of Association of our Company are: Mr. Gopal Jain and Ms. Sudesh Jain. For details of the share capital history of our Company, please see the section titled ***"Capital Structure"*** beginning on page 88 of the RHP.

Listing: The Equity Shares to be offered through the Red Herring Prospectus are proposed to be listed on the Stock Exchanges. Our Company has received an 'in-principle' approval from each of the BSE and the NSE for the listing of the Equity Shares pursuant to their letters each dated September 26, 2025. For the purposes of the Offer, the Designated Stock Exchange shall be NSE. A signed copy of the Red Herring Prospectus has been filed and a copy of the Prospectus shall be filed with the RoC in accordance with Sections 32 and 26(4) of the Companies Act, 2013. For details of the material contracts and documents that will be available for inspection from the date of the Red Herring Prospectus up to the Bid/Offer Closing Date, see *"Material Contracts and Documents for Inspection"* on page 480 of the RHP.

Disclaimer Clause of the Securities and Exchange Board of India ("SEBI"): SEBI only gives its observations on the Offer documents and this does not constitute approval of either the Offer or the specified securities stated in the Offer Documents. The investors are advised to refer to page 388 of the RHP for the full text of the disclaimer clause of SEBI.

Disclaimer Clause of NSE (Designated Stock Exchange) : It is to be distinctly understood that the permission given by NSE should not in any way be deemed or construed that the Offer Document has been cleared or approved by NSE nor does it certify the correctness or completeness of any of the contents of the RHP. The investors are advised to refer to page 390 of the RHP for the full text of the disclaimer clause of NSE.

Disclaimer Clause of BSE : It is to be distinctly understood that the permission given by BSE should not in any way be deemed or construed that the RHP has been cleared or approved by BSE nor does it certify the correctness or completeness of any of the contents of the RHP. The investors are advised to refer to page 390 of the RHP for the full text of the disclaimer clause of BSE.

General Risk: Investments in equity and equity-related securities involve a degree of risk and investors should not invest any funds in the Offer unless they can afford to take the risk of losing their entire investment. Investors are advised to read the risk factors carefully before taking an investment decision in the Offer. For taking an investment decision, investors must rely on their own examination of our Company and the Offer, including the risks involved. The Equity Shares in the Offer have not been recommended or approved by SEBI, nor does the SEBI guarantee the accuracy or adequacy of the contents of the Red Herring Prospectus. Specific attention of the investors is invited to *"Risk Factors"* on page 20 of the RHP.

BOOK RUNNING LEAD MANAGERS		REGISTRAR TO THE OFFER	COMPANY SECRETARY AND COMPLIANCE OFFICER
JM Financial Limited 7th Floor, Cnergy, Appasaheb Marathe Marg, Prabhadevi, Mumbai - 400 025 Maharashtra, India. **Tel:** +91 22 6630 3030 **E-mail:** gaja.ipo@jmfl.com **Investor grievance e-mail:** grievance.ibd@jmfl.com **Website:** www.jmfl.com **Contact Person:** Prachee Dhuri **SEBI registration No.:** INM000010361	**IIFL Capital Services Limited** *(formerly known as IIFL Securities Limited)* 24th Floor, One Lodha Place, Senapati Bapat Marg, Lower Parel (West) Mumbai - 400 013, Maharashtra, India. **Tel:** +91 22 4646 4728 **E-mail:** gaja.ipo@iiflcap.com **Website:** www.iiflcapital.com **Investor grievance e-mail:** ig.ib@iiflcap.com **Contact Person:** Mansi Sampat/ Pawan Kumar Jain **SEBI registration no.:** INM000010940	**MUFG Intime India Private Limited** *(formerly known as Link Intime India Private Limited)* C-101, Embassy 247, L B S Marg, Vikhroli (West), Mumbai - 400 083 Maharashtra, India. **Tel:** +91 810 811 4949 **E-mail:** gajaalternative.ipo@in.mpms.mufg.com **Investor grievance e-mail:** gajaalternative.ipo@in.mpms.mufg.com **Website:** www.in.mpms.mufg.com **Contact Person:** Shanti Gopalkrishnan **SEBI registration no.:** INR000004058	**Ms. Ishu Jain** 1402, Tower 2B, One World Center, Senapati Bapat Marg, Lower Parel, Delisle Road, Mumbai - 400 013, Maharashtra, India **Tel:** +91 91368 89894 **E-mail:** compliance@gajacapital.com Investors may contact the Company Secretary and Compliance Officer or the Registrar to the Offer in case of any pre-Offer or post-Offer related grievances including non-receipt of letters of Allotment, non-credit of Allotted Equity Shares in the respective beneficiary account, non-receipt of refund orders or non-receipt of funds by electronic mode, etc. For all Offer related queries and for redressal of complaints, Investors may also write to the BRLMs.

AVAILABILITY OF THE RHP: Investors are advised to refer to the RHP and the section titled ***"Risk Factors"*** on page 20 of the RHP, before applying in the Offer. A copy of the RHP shall be available on website of SEBI at www.sebi.gov.in, websites of the Stock Exchanges i.e. BSE Limited and National Stock Exchange of India Limited at www.bseindia.com and www.nseindia.com, respectively, and on the website of the Company at www.gajacapital.com and on the websites of the BRLMs, i.e. JM Financial Limited and IIFL Capital Services Limited *(formerly known as IIFL Securities Limited) at* www.jmfl.com and www.iiflcapital.com, respectively.

AVAILABILITY OF THE ABRIDGED PROSPECTUS: A copy of the abridged prospectus shall be available on the website of the Company, the BRLMs and the Registrar to the Offer at www.gajacapital.com, www.jmfl.com, www.iiflcapital.com and www.in.mpms.mufg.com, respectively.

AVAILABILITY OF BID CUM APPLICATION FORMS: Bid cum Application Forms can be obtained from the Registered and Corporate Office of **GAJA ALTERNATIVE ASSET MANAGEMENT LIMITED, Tel:** +91 91368 89894 ; **BRLMs : JM Financial Limited, Tel:** +91 22 6630 3030 and **IIFL Capital Services Limited** *(formerly known as IIFL Securities Limited)*, **Tel:** +91 22 4646 4728 at the select locations of the Sub-syndicate Members (as given below), SCSBs, Registered Brokers, RTAs and CDPs participating in the Offer. Bid cum Application Forms will also be available on the websites of BSE and NSE and the Designated Branches of SCSBs, the list of which is available at websites of the Stock Exchanges and SEBI.

Syndicate Members: JM Financial Services Limited, Tel: +91 22 6136 3400

Sub-Syndicate Members: Almondz Global Securities Limited, Ambit Capital Limited, Anand Rathi Share & Stock Brokers Limited, Asit C Mehta Financial Services Limited, Axis Capital Limited, Bajaj Financial Securities Limited, Centrum Capital Advisors Limited, Edelweiss Broking, Eurekha Stock & Share Broking Services Limited, Globe Capital Market Limited, HDFC Securities Limited, ICICI Securities Limited, IDBI Capital Market Services Limited, Keynote Capital Limited, KJMC Capital Market Services Limited, Kotak Securities Limited, LKP Securities Limited, Motilal Oswal Financial Services Limited, Nuvama Wealth and Investment Limited, Prabhudas Lilladher Private Limited, 5Paisa Capital Limited, Pravin Ratilal Share and Stock Brokers Limited, Religare Securities Limited, RR Equity Brokers Private Limited, SBICAP Securities Limited, Sharekhan Limited, SMC Global Securities Limited, Standard Chartered Securities, Tradebulls Securities Private Limited, Trust Securities Limited and YES Securities (India) Limited

• **Escrow Collection Bank, Refund Bank** : HDFC Bank Limited • **Public Offer Account Bank** : ICICI Bank Limited • **Sponsor Banks :** HDFC Bank Limited and ICICI Bank Limited

UPI: UPI Bidders can also bid through UPI mechanism

All capitalized terms used herein and not specifically defined shall have the same meaning as ascribed to them in the RHP.

For **GAJA ALTERNATIVE ASSET MANAGEMENT LIMITED**
On behalf of the Board of Directors
Sd/-
Ms. Ishu Jain
Company Secretary and Compliance Officer

Place: New Delhi, India
Date: August 20, 2026

GAJA ALTERNATIVE ASSET MANAGEMENT LIMITED is proposing, subject to receipt of requisite approvals, market conditions and other considerations, to make an initial public offering of its Equity Shares and has filed the RHP with RoC on August 12, 2026. The RHP is available on the website of the SEBI at www.sebi.gov.in, the websites of the Stock Exchanges at www.bseindia.com and www.nseindia.com, respectively, the website of the Company at www.gajacapital.com and on the websites of the Book Running Lead Managers ("**BRLMs**"), i.e. JM Financial Limited and IIFL Capital Services Limited *(formerly known as IIFL Securities Limited)* at www.jmfl.com and www.iiflcapital.com, respectively. Any potential investors should note that investment in equity shares involves a high degree of risk and for details relating to such risk, see ***"Risk Factors"*** beginning on page 20 of the RHP. Potential investors should not rely on the UDRHP-I filed with SEBI and the Stock Exchanges, and should rely on their own examination of our Company and the Offer, including the risks involved, for making any investment decision.

This announcement is not an offer of securities for sale in the United States or elsewhere. This announcement has been prepared for publication in India only and is not for publication or distribution, directly or indirectly, in or into the United States. The Equity Shares offered in the Offer have not been and will not be registered under the U.S. Securities Act or any state securities laws in the United States, and unless so registered, may not be offered or sold within the United States, except pursuant to an exemption from, or in a transaction not subject to, the registration requirements of the U.S. Securities Act and in accordance with any applicable U.S. state securities laws. Accordingly, the Equity Shares are being offered and sold only outside the United States in 'offshore transactions' as defined in and in compliance with Regulation S under the U.S. Securities Act and the applicable laws of the jurisdictions where such offers and sales are made.

The Equity Shares have not been and will not be registered, listed or otherwise qualified in any other jurisdiction outside India and may not be offered or sold, and Bids may not be made by persons in any such jurisdiction, except in compliance with the applicable laws of such jurisdiction.

CHENNAI - FRIDAY - AUGUST 21, 2026

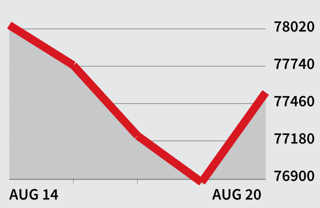
₹10 • Pages 14 • Volume 33 • Number 232

www.businessline.in

businessline · thehindubusinessline

the hindu businessline

SENSEX 77537.72 (+628.04)



IN FOCUS

	LATEST	CHANGE
Nifty 50	24231.85	+153.55
P/E Ratio (Sensex)	20.54	+0.17
US Dollar (in ₹)	95.70	-0.05
Gold Std 10 gm (in ₹)	156451.00	+3199
Silver 1 kg (in ₹)	237766.00	+8541

SWEET DEAL. **Centre permits import of** 1 mt of raw sugar duty-free to tame soaring prices and food inflation **p10**

MORE POWER. **Southern States are** the main pillars of India's development, says Home Minister Amit Shah **p8**

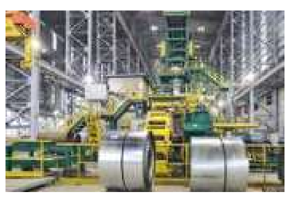
BENGALURU - CHENNAI - COIMBATORE - HUBBALLI - HYDERABAD - KOCHI - KOLKATA - MADURAI - MALAPPURAM - MANGALURU - MUMBAI - NOIDA - THIRUVANANTHAPURAM - TIRUCHIRAPALLI - VIJAYAWADA - VISAKHAPATNAM

Regd. TN/ARD/14/2012-2014, RNI No. 55320/94

QUICKLY.

LOW ON ENERGY

Core sector output growth eases to 5.4% in July



New Delhi: The nine key infrastructure sectors' output rose 5.4 per cent in July against 6 per cent in June, official data for the Index of Core Industries released on Thursday showed. Natural gas, crude oil and fertilizers posted negative growth. The growth rate was 3.2 per cent in the same month last year. Iron ore, cement, electricity, coal, steel and refinery products expanded. **p3**

FLYING LOW

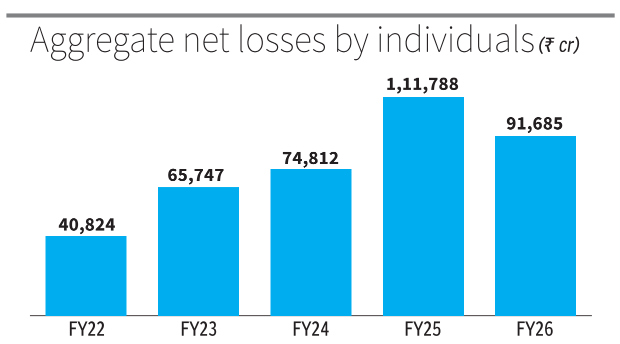
Domestic air passenger traffic falls 4.8% in July

New Delhi: India's domestic air passenger traffic moderated in July 2026 on a year-on-year basis as airlines continued calibrated capacity deployment despite resilient travel demand. Scheduled domestic airlines carried around 1.2 crore passengers in July, against 1.26 crore passengers last year, a decline of 4.8 per cent. **p12**

SEBI curbs cool F&O market, still traders lost ₹91,685 crore

NEW STUDY. Active individual traders fall 20% in FY26, the first decline since FY16

Akshata Gorde
Mumbai



Source: SEBI

The Securities and Exchange Board of India's measures to curb excessive speculation in equity derivatives coincided with a sharp cooling in retail participation, with the number of active individual traders falling for the first time since FY16.

Despite fewer traders, individual investors still incurred net losses of ₹91,685 crore in FY26, while the average loss per trader increased.

ACTIVE TRADERS

The number of active individual traders in the equity derivatives segment fell 20 per cent to 78.6 lakh in FY26 from 98.1 lakh in FY25, according to SEBI's latest study.

This was the first year-on-year decline in the trader base since FY16. Aggregate net losses fell 18 per cent to ₹91,685 crore, from a revised ₹1.12-lakh crore in FY25.

However, the decline in aggregate losses did not translate into lower losses for the average trader. Average net loss per trader rose by 2.4 per cent to ₹1.17 lakh from ₹1.14 lakh in FY25.

As many as nine out of 10 individual traders continued to lose money, although the proportion of loss-makers fell to 87.7 per cent from 90.9 per cent.

"The decline in aggregate losses came alongside a 20 per cent fall in the number of active traders and an overall moderation in trading activity in FY26. However, losses fell proportionately less than participation did, showing that losses remained substantial among the traders who stayed active," said SEBI in the report. Nearly 46 lakh traders who participated in FY25 did not trade in FY26 compared with 26 lakh exits in FY25, while new entrants fell by about 40 per cent to 20.8 lakh from 34.3 lakh. At the same time, those who remained active increased their trading intensity in options.

Average turnover per options trader rose by 10.8 per cent between Q2 and Q4 FY25, while the average turnover per index-options trader increased by 12.3 per cent.

The shift comes after the market regulator introduced a series of measures from November 2024 to curb excessive speculation.

These included restricting weekly derivative contracts to one index per exchange, raising the minimum contract size, requiring upfront collection of option premiums, withdrawing calendar-spread benefits on expiry day and increasing extreme-loss margins for short options positions.

The report found that participation declined more sharply after the measures, particularly in options. Between Q2 and Q4 FY25, unique derivatives traders fell 25.4 per cent, while options participation declined 25.8 per cent and index-options participation by 26.8 per cent.

DAILY TURNOVER

The cooling in activity was also not sustained, as the average daily turnover in index options fell by 17.4 per cent after the November 2024 measures, but recovered to ₹81,696 crore in October 2025-March 2026, which was 38 per cent above the initial post-measures period.

1978 'industry' definition not to apply under new labour code: SC

Krishnadas Rajagopal
New Delhi

A nine-member Bench of the Supreme Court on Thursday held that the nearly half-a-century-old expansive interpretation of 'industry', which previously granted workers stronger labour rights and protection, will not apply under the new Industrial Relations Code, 2020.

The reference before the Constitution Bench, headed by Chief Justice Surya Kant, centred around a broad definition given to 'industry' in a 1978 seven-judge Constitution Bench judgment, authored by Justice VR Krishna Iyer, in the Bangalore Water Supply and Sewerage Board versus R Rajappa case.

LEGAL PROTECTIONS

The verdict had enabled workers employed in a wide range of employment with legal recourse, including collective bargaining, against unfair labour practices by employers. The 48-year-old verdict exempted only core sovereign activities, such as judiciary, law and order and defence, from the purview of 'industry', as defined under Section 2(j) of the Industrial Disputes Act, 1947, in order to protect the state's functional autonomy.

TRIPLE TEST

The 1978 judgment further introduced a 'triple test', which laid down conditions that any activity that was systematic or organised, operated on the basis of employer-employee cooperation and dealt in the production of goods and services to satisfy human wants, came within the ambit of 'industry'.

The judgment had brought even hospitals, educational institutions and municipalities within the fold of 'industry'. The majority on the Bench held that industry under Section 2(p) of the Industrial Relations Code (IRC), which came into force in November 2025, would not be "burdened" by the interpretation in the 1978 judgment of Section 2(j) of the 1947 Act. This means the interpretation of the term industry under the IRC would be done on a clean slate.

The majority opinion on this particular point was authored by Chief Justice Surya Kant, and supported by Justices Satish Chandra Sharma, Alok Aradhe and Vipul M Pancholi, with Justices PS Narasimha and Joymalya Bagchi expressing agreement in their separate opinions. Chief Justice Kant said the 1978 judgment and its conclusion would not act as the "sheet anchor", or the foundation for any future interpretation of Section 2(p) of the IRC. This has effectively confined the 1978 verdict strictly to legacy industrial disputes pending before courts, tribunals and labour authorities prior to the IRC.

"The future of 'industry' in Section 2(p) of IRC is not burdened by the interpretation of 2(j) in the Industrial Disputes Act," CJI Kant summed up. In fact, his opinion even suggested a refinement of the 1978 triple test.

PENDING DISPUTES

While acknowledging that the core principles of the test had stood the test of time in deciding industrial disputes, the CJI said its elements could have been "articulated differently so that the scope and contours of 2(j) could have been better reflected".

However, he clarified this was only a "considered opinion", and should not be used to displace the governing legal position on pending proceedings.

SBI widens cash withdrawal charges to all basic accounts 'to plug fee income leak'

Our Bureau
Mumbai

The State Bank of India, the country's largest lender, has expanded the scope of cash withdrawal charges for basic savings bank deposit accounts, a move industry sources say is aimed at plugging a leakage in fee income, while also nudging customers towards digital transactions.

FREE WITHDRAWALS

A notification on the SBI website said that with effect from October 1, customers holding basic savings accounts, opened through the branch banking channel, will also be brought under the revised cash withdrawal framework. While four cash withdrawals in a month, including at SBI ATMs, other banks' ATMs and branch channels will be free, withdrawals beyond this limit will attract a charge of ₹15 plus GST per transaction.

Earlier, a similar charge structure was applicable, primarily to customers who had opened accounts through customer service points (CSPs) or business correspondents (BCs), but not to many customers who had opened basic accounts through the branch banking channel.

UNIFORM REGIME

The latest revision effectively creates a uniform regime for all basic savings accounts customers, irrespective of the channel through which the account was opened. Sources said the revised charges will be applicable across customer categories, including senior citizens, signalling the bank's intention to standardise the treatment of these accounts.

Banking analysts said the move is aimed at plugging a gap in fee income recovery from a large base of customers using cash transactions.

They noted that maintaining different rules for CSP-opened and branch-opened basic savings accounts had left a section of customers outside the charge framework, despite generating similar transaction costs for the bank.

The decision is also being viewed as part of SBI's broader effort to encourage digital banking and reduce reliance on cash. While cash withdrawals beyond the free threshold will be charged, all digital transactions will continue to remain free and without any restrictions, according to the bank's notice.

Basic savings accounts are designed as no-frills savings accounts and are available to individuals with valid KYC documents. These accounts do not require any minimum balance.

CREATIVE THREADS

SPIRIT OF SIBLING BOND. Visually challenged students make rakhis (amulets) ahead of Raksha Bandhan on August 28 at The Blind Relief Association in New Delhi on Thursday. The festival of sibling bond is observed on Shravan Purnima, and is traditionally marked by sisters tying rakhis on to the wrists of their brothers, along with the exchange of gifts and sweets ANI

Pvt hospitals oppose parliamentary panel's call on room rent, claim that it ignores high running costs

Ankita Upadhyay
New Delhi

ON A STRONG FOOTING. The pushback comes even as major hospital chains report strong growth and healthy profits

Private hospitals are pushing back against a parliamentary panel's call to end room rent-linked treatment pricing, saying it overlooks the high cost of running hospitals and could discourage investments. The defence comes even as major hospital chains report strong growth and healthy profits, raising questions over whether concerns about costs and investments are fully reflected in their financial performance.

THREE-STAR HOTELS

The Parliamentary Standing Committee on Health and Family Welfare recommended that private hospitals rationalise room charges. It suggested that room charges should not exceed the average tariff of three-star hotels in the hospital's vicinity.

Apollo Hospitals MD Suneeta Reddy defended the company's pricing as "fair and transparent", saying price controls could discourage investment in capacity and innovation.

On Apollo's 8 per cent rise in average revenue per admission, partly driven by a 4 per cent price increase, Reddy said, in a quarterly earnings call, that Apollo had no plans to change its approach. She said price increases reflected inflation and rising service costs.

Dharminder Nagar, MD of Paras Healthcare, said the panel's recommendation was based on a "flawed" comparison between hospitals and hotels.

"Hospitals are not hotels. We don't do the same services," he said, adding that room charges included several costs associated with patient care. Siddhartha Bhattacharya, Secretary-General, Nathealth, said affordability should be assessed by looking at the underlying cost of healthcare delivery. He cited land, capital, manpower, regulatory compliance, medical equipment and working capital as major costs.

Fortis Healthcare MD and CEO Ashutosh Raghuvanshi said affordability could be addressed through zero-rating GST on healthcare, lower duties on medical equipment, stronger insurance coverage and better access to long-term capital.

SEES STRONG GROWTH

These assertions are despite hospital chains reporting strong profits. Apollo's consolidated net profit rose from ₹136 crore in FY21 to ₹1,505 crore in FY25. It reported a PAT of ₹1,493 crore in FY26, while Q1 FY27 PAT rose 34 per cent to ₹581 crore.

Fortis reported a profit of ₹789.95 crore in FY22, ₹632.98 crore in FY23, ₹645.22 crore in FY24 and ₹809.38 crore in FY25 after a loss in FY21. Max Healthcare's PAT rose from ₹331 crore in FY22 to ₹1,631 crore in FY26.

Gold surges on US Treasury move to double bond buyback, gains 2% in a day

Suresh P Iyengar
Mumbai

Gold prices surged sharply by ₹3,212, or nearly 2 per cent, on Thursday, climbing to ₹1,57,080 from ₹1,53,868 per 10 g in the previous session, buoyed by a strong rally in the international markets.

The yellow metal turned bullish after the US Treasury announced that it would double buyback operations for longer-dated bonds from $2 billion to $4 billion per operation from September 9.

The move is expected to provide liquidity support to the long end of the bond market, pushing the 30-year US Treasury yield down from near two-decade highs to 5.19 per cent and boosting investor interest in gold.

In the domestic market, gold opened higher at ₹1,57,387 per 10 g amid strong buying interest, according to data from the India Bullion and Jewellers Association (IBJA).

Silver also witnessed a sharp rally, rising by ₹8,541 to ₹2,37,766 from ₹2,29,225 per kg in the previous session.

On the Multi Commodity Exchange (MCX), gold contracts for October delivery gained ₹264 to trade at ₹1,58,260 per 10 g.

GLOBAL PRICE JUMP

Globally, spot gold jumped 4 per cent to $4,488 an ounce after touching an intra-day high of $4,499, its highest level since June 4. US gold futures settled 3 per cent higher at $4,545 an ounce.

The surge comes at a crucial time for the jewellery industry, which is gearing up for the festival and wedding seasons. However, the sharp rise in prices could weigh on physical demand, which has already been impacted by recent volatility.

Prithviraj Kothari, President of the India Bullion and Jewellers Association, said the US Treasury's decision to increase long-dated bond buybacks could reduce the opportunity cost of holding non-yielding assets such as gold, providing a strong tailwind for prices.

"Gold can test the $4,550-$4,600 range if pressure on the dollar persists," he said. At the same time, Kothari cautioned that rising prices typically temper physical demand during the festival season, as consumers often postpone purchases or opt for lighter-weight jewellery when rates rise sharply.

FESTIVAL DEMAND

Rajesh Rokde, Chairman of the All India Gem and Jewellery Domestic Council (GJC), offered a more optimistic view, saying higher prices do not necessarily translate into weaker festival demand.

"Gold holds deep cultural and emotional significance, especially during festivals and weddings. Higher prices enhance the value of existing holdings and often encourage consumers to exchange old jewellery for newer designs," he said.

According to Rokde, buyers are increasingly likely to opt for lighter-weight jewellery ornaments, lower-carat jewellery and exchange-led purchases, rather than completely defer buying.

CHENNAI
businessline.
FRIDAY - AUGUST 21 - 2026

QUICKLY.

Drivn, TaMo join hands for lease-based electric CVs

Mumbai: EV leasing platform Drivn on Thursday said it has signed an initial pact with Tata Motors to explore lease-based deployment of electric CVs for fleet operators. Drivn, which owns, finances and leases heavy-duty ECVs such as trucks and buses, will offer customised leasing for Tata Motors' eCV portfolio. PTI

Federal Bank to offer credit to VinFast dealers

Mumbai: Vinfast India has signed an MoU with Federal Bank, under which the latter will offer customised inventory financing solutions that for the company's dealers to optimise working capital, maintain healthy inventory, and respond to growing demand, Vinfast India, the subsidiary of Vietnamese automotive maker VinFast, said. PTI

Premium bikes, scooters lead export surge in two-wheelers

STRONGER, SHARPER. Premium bikes grow 12.8%, scooters 18.2% during FY22-FY26

Amit Vijay Mohile
Mumbai

WHAT'S WORKING. The shift is driven by Indian brands gaining ground overseas and the country emerging as a manufacturing and export hub for global markets REUTERS

Two-wheeler exports are acquiring a higher-value layer, with scooters and motorcycles above 200 cc growing three-to-five times faster than overall shipments as manufacturers expand beyond the traditional African markets.

The shift is being driven by Indian brands gaining ground overseas and the country emerging as a manufacturing and export hub for global markets. For instance, Royal Enfield is building its international presence with mid-capacity motorcycles, while Bajaj Auto and TVS Motor are expanding their own brands as well as manufacturing for global partners.

In the four years to FY26, overall two-wheeler exports grew at a CAGR of 3.9 per cent, compared with 12.8 per cent for motorcycles above 200cc and 18.2 per cent for scooters. Sub-125cc motorcycles, however, have historically accounted for more than 60 per cent of exports and remain the volume backbone, suggesting the faster-growing premium segments are adding a high-value layer.

This, as India increasingly serves two sides of the global market — by increasing footprint and outsourcing factories. Overall exports hit a record 5.18 million units in FY26, up 23 per cent, and are projected to grow another 15-20 per cent in FY27.

Manufacturers have expanded distribution networks, introduced market-specific products, and strengthened presence overseas, said India Ratings and Research (Ind-Ra).

BEYOND AFRICA

The changing product mix is accompanied by a geographical shift. Colombia, Mexico, and Brazil have found place among India's top 10 two-wheeler export destinations, reducing the dependence on Africa. Higher-income markets in Latin America and SouthEast Asia are supporting demand for larger motorcycles, while urbanisation and a preference for automatic mobility are helping scooter exports.

Yet, Africa remains central to India's volume story and could provide another leg of growth. Nigeria, India's largest two-wheeler export destination until FY24, suffered a steep downturn following currency, inflation, and forex pressures.

"The current upcycle appears to be increasingly structural, rather than purely cyclical, with OEMs benefiting from a wider geographic reach and stronger distribution networks," said Shruti Saboo, Director, Corporate Ratings, Ind-Ra.

The shift also changes the economics of exports. Premiumisation is increasing realisations, while the rupee has depreciated 15 per cent since 2024. Ind-Ra expects these factors to support higher revenue growth and improve profitability.

India bets on gene-edited rice varieties as yield growth slows

Yashaswani Chauhan
New Delhi

Rice-productivity growth is showing signs of slowing just as India prepares to bring new genome-edited varieties to farmers.

Two such varieties — DRR Dhan 100 (Kamala) and Pusa Rice DST1 — were developed in 2025. The government is now preparing to release the latter for commercial production in the coming rabi season.

DATA FOCUS.

MOMENTUM LOST

Data from the Department of Agriculture and Farmers Welfare shows that the growth in rice yield has become more subdued in recent years. While it grew 9.4 per cent in 2001-02 and 5.9 per cent in 2005-06, yield slowed to 1.6 per cent in both 2023-24 and 2024-25, before falling to 0.5 per cent, reaching ₹2,915 kg/ha in 2025-26.

Rice acreage, meanwhile, has expanded more rapidly, with area growth at 7.2 per cent in 2024-25. The following year, it slowed to 3.1 per cent. Production, too, after crossing 1,500 lakh tonnes in 2024-25, growing at 9 per cent, has slowed to 2.6 per cent in 2025-26.

"The slowdown is real, and to an extent, predictable," said Anand Chandra, Co-founder and Executive Director, Arya.ag, a grain-commerce platform. Gains from high-yielding varieties, irrigation, and fertilizer use have largely matured, while the gap between research station and farmer-field yields remains, he added.

THE NEED FOR HYBRIDS

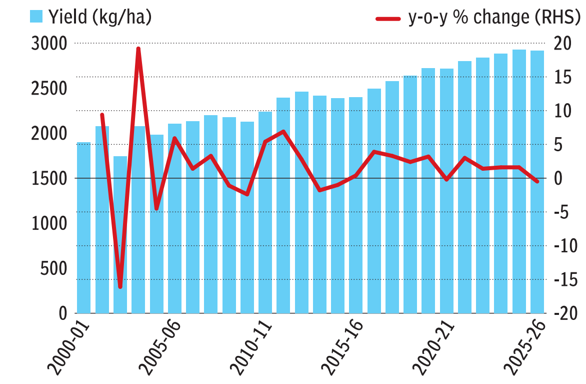
Ajai Rana, Chairman, Federation of Seed Industry of India, pointed to China and the US, where hybrid rice covers more than half of the rice area, compared with just 7-8 per cent in India.

India needs hybrids that combine a reliable yield advantage of more than 25 per cent with locally preferred grain quality and climate resilience to accelerate growth, said Rana, who's also the CEO of agritech firm Savannah Seeds. But better seeds alone will not lift the national average, cautioned Chandra. Timely planting, balanced nutrition, efficient water management, higher seed replacement, and stronger extension services are also required.

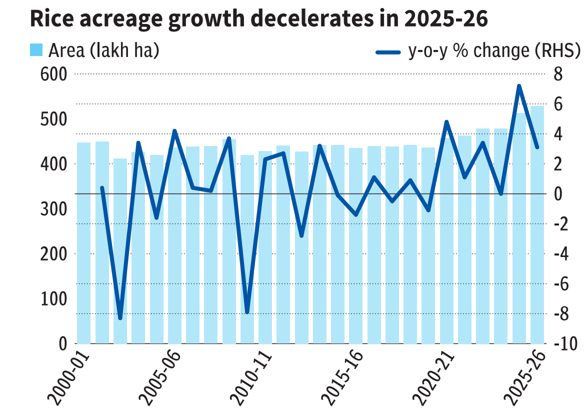
Both Chandra and Rana estimated an additional rice requirement of 150-200 lakh tonnes by the next decade. They believe most of it should come from rising yield, not acreage expansion.

Slackening pace

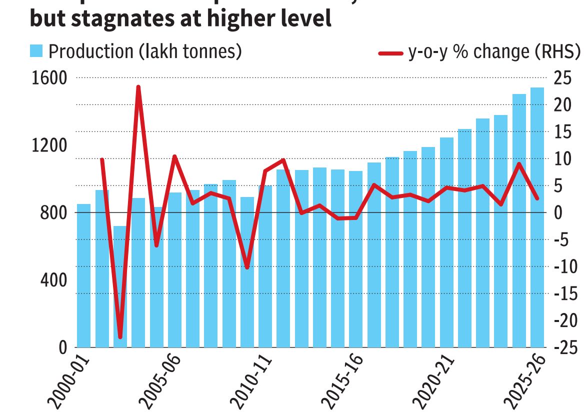
Rice yield growth turns negative, declining 0.5% in 2025-26



Rice acreage growth decelerates in 2025-26



Rice production spikes in FY25, but stagnates at higher level



Source: Department of Agriculture and Farmers Welfare

Tata Trusts' delay raises questions over legal recourse

Our Bureau
Mumbai

The continuing regulatory restrictions on the Sir Ratan Tata Trust (SRTT), which have led to the adjournment of Tata Sons' AGM and delayed the disbursal of nearly ₹2,900 crore due to two key Tata Trusts, are raising questions within governance circles over whether all available legal remedies were explored, said sources.

The issue has assumed urgency as the delay carries a significant financial cost for the charitable trusts.

Based on an assumed annual return of 7 per cent, the deferred receipt of about ₹2,900 crore translates into an opportunity cost of roughly ₹56 lakh a day.

Sources familiar with the matter said that at least one trustee had flagged concerns over the ongoing delay and its impact on the trusts' financial interests, prompting questions over whether independent legal opinion had been sought and whether urgent legal remedies had been considered to protect the interests of the charitable institutions and their beneficiaries.

The restrictions on SRTT have prevented the trust from participating in meetings, resulting in the lack of quorum that forced Tata Sons to adjourn its AGM.

Besides delaying dividend payments, the situation could also slow the process of appointing a successor to Tata Sons Chairman N Chandrasekaran, who has indicated he will not seek a third term after his tenure ends in February.

HIGH-LEVEL MEET?

Against this backdrop, sources said Tata Trusts Chairman Noel Tata met veteran banker Deepak Parekh in Mumbai on Wednesday, with Tata Trusts trustee Darius Khambata also said to be present.

The reported meeting was linked to discussions on succession planning and the proposed selection process for Tata Sons' future leadership. However, sources close to the individuals denied that any such meeting took place.

The two key trusts hold 52 per cent stake in Tata Sons.

HUGE COSTS

Assuming 7 per cent annual returns, the deferred receipt of about ₹2,900 crore translates into a daily opportunity cost of about ₹56 lakh

The impact of the Charity Commissioner's order on SRTT has extended beyond its internal functioning to its ability to exercise shareholder rights in Tata Sons.

Earlier reports had said that SRTT had sought a one-time waiver.

Given the scale of the financial interests involved, sources close to the Tata group said the trustees should demonstrate that they acted with the "care, diligence and independence" expected of custodians of charitable assets.

The process of selecting a new Tata Sons Chairman can gain speed only after the restrictions on SRTT are lifted.

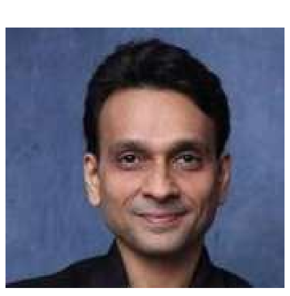
Levi Strauss optimistic on India as premium products drive growth

Aishwarya Kumar
Bengaluru

Levi Strauss & Co is betting on India to play a pivotal role in its ambition to become a $10 billion company. The denim major sees headroom for growth not just in jeans but across women's wear, tops, and premium products.

"India has always been referred to as one of the pivotal countries that will contribute to this ambition in a big way," said Hiren Gor, Managing Director, South Asia, Middle East & Africa (SAMEA), Levi Strauss & Co.

This comes as the company continues to see momentum in its international business. For the quarter ended May, Levi Strauss reported a net revenue of $1.6 billion, up 8 per cent year-on-year, while Asia revenue rose 10 per cent. International markets account for about 60 per cent of the



Hiren Gor, MD, SAMEA, Levi Strauss & Co

NYSE-listed firm's global revenue, with India among its top six markets. Its India business had reported sales of ₹1,668.7 crore in FY24, according to RoC filings.

SHIFT IN FASHION

Both its denim and non-denim businesses in India, said Gor, are growing in the mid-double digits, with women's wear outpacing men's. "Men's business still makes the larger component of our business, but women's products are growing faster," he added.

The premium segment is also growing in high double digits, while the company's Red Loop premium proposition accounts for about 15 per cent of its men's business. The shift is significant for a brand historically synonymous with jeans. Levi's now sells more than one top for every bottom, according to Gor, with tops, non-denims, and women's wear becoming important avenues to increase consumer engagement and wardrobe penetration.

Beyond consumption, India is also becoming an important part of Levi's supply chain. Gor said over 95 per cent of Levi's India consumption is made or built in India, with a broad supplier base spread across the country. "India is also producing for the globe along with other source bases," he said.

Power Grid explores new ways for grid integrity as RE capacity swells

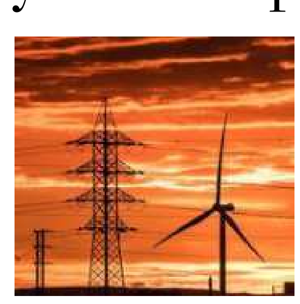
Rishi Ranjan Kala
New Delhi

State-run Power Grid Corporation of India (PGCIL) is moving beyond building just transmission capacity, but is also focusing on integrating technologies to ensure grid integrity and resilience as India's renewable energy capacity expands at a rapid pace.

In a first-of-its-kind project, the company will install two synchronous condensers at its Fatehgarh-II substation in Rajasthan, which will help it maintain voltage and stabilise the transmission grid.

SHIFT IN PLANNING

The project signals a shift in transmission planning: the challenge is no longer just moving more renewable electricity, but ensuring the grid has the strength and resilience to absorb it reliably.



THE FIX. Synchronous condensers could stabilise the power made from renewables

According to ABB, synchronous condensers (SCs), although an old technology, is a useful solution to stabilise power produced by renewables. They are now used to stabilise intermittent and variable power from renewables. PGCIL will leverage SCs that provide short-circuit power to strengthen the grid, aiding in better interaction of renewable energy.

An official said this is the first such project in India, which PGCIL secured in July through tariff base competitive bidding.

On the utility of synchronous condensers, ABB said on its website that in several areas, the rise of solar and other renewables is happening at the same time that conventional power plants are being decommissioned. As a result, the plants' large, high inertia synchronous generators are being taken out of service. In this type of situation, synchronous condensers can provide additional short-circuit power.

India's 500 GW of non-fossil fuel installed capacity target and the increasing integration of inverter-based resources, solutions such as grid-strengthening assets like synchronous condensers, statcoms, BESS and advanced power electronics have become equally critical as the transmission lines, the official explained.

Manipal Hospitals posts ₹243 crore profit in Q1

Our Bureau
Bengaluru

Manipal Health Enterprises reported a profit after tax (PAT) of ₹243 crore in the first quarter ended June, down 4 per cent from the same period a year ago. This was the first quarter the company published results after listing on the stock exchanges.

The PAT figure excludes ₹89 crore in post-tax interest on the NCDs issued for the acquisition of Sahyadri Hospitals.

GOOD VOLUMES

Manipal's revenue from operations rose 38.1 per cent year-on-year to ₹3,091 crore, driven by strong growth in patient volumes and the contribution from recently acquired assets. Inpatient volumes grew 38.8 per cent, while outpatient volumes increased 26 per cent.

Scorecard *(in ₹ cr)*

	Q1FY26	Q1FY27
Revenue from operations	2,238	3,091
PAT	254	243

Occupancy, too, improved 290 basis points to 65 per cent during the quarter. The company's average revenue per occupied bed (ARPOB) stood at ₹71,500 per day.

"Our performance reflects the strength of our pan-India network, sustained patient demand, and continued growth in high-acuity specialties," said Dilip Jose, Managing Director and CEO of Manipal Health.

The company said it would focus on expanding capacity and improving operational efficiency as it scales its pan-India network, with the Sahyadri integration expected to remain an important driver of growth in the coming quarters.

Hero-backed Euler Motors expands Haryana unit to build 4-wheeler commercial vehicles

Our Bureau
New Delhi

Electric commercial vehicle manufacturer Euler Motors on Thursday announced the expansion of its manufacturing footprint in Palwal, Haryana, with an investment of over ₹100 crore.

The plant will focus on making four-wheelers, including the Euler Turbo EV 1000 and Storm EV, with an annual production capacity of up to 24,000 vehicles.

BETTER ECONOMICS

"India's commercial mobility sector is at an important inflection point, with electrification gaining momentum

COMMON GROUND. Pawan Munjal (left), Executive Chairman, Hero MotoCorp, and Saurav Kumar, CEO, Euler Motors

on the back of supportive government policies, improving total-cost economics and the growing demand for sustainable last-mile mobility," said Hero MotoCorp's Executive Chairman Pawan Munjal who inaugurated the unit.

He said Euler has demonstrated that EVs can deliver the performance, economics, and technology that commercial customers demand, and this facility can take that proposition to a much larger scale.

Hero MotoCorp holds over one-third stake in Euler Motors.

The facility follows a layered validation approach, with testing integrated across every stage of manufacturing. Critical systems, including suspension frames, drivetrain and steering, undergo rigorous testing for early fault detection.

"The four-wheeler cargo segment has long run on internal combustion engine... Our vehicles have demonstrated that as the right fit to that gap with penetration moving from 1 per cent to 5.8 per cent and Euler securing around 28 per cent market share," Saurav Kumar, Founder and CEO, Euler Motors, said.

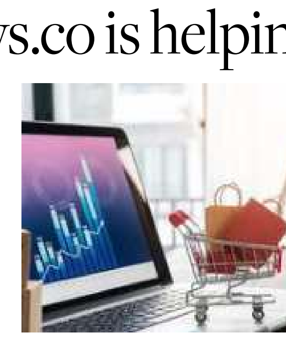
How 100Days.co is helping large brands scale digitally

Meenakshi Verma Ambwani
New Delhi

100Days.co, an online growth and intelligence service business, set up by the founders of Bombay Shaving Company, is leveraging its digital-commerce playbook to enable large brands and start-ups scale up their D2C and e-commerce businesses.

The company already manages the digital-commerce businesses of 20 brands and plans to scale this up to managing around ₹5,000-6,000 crore in GMV over the next three years.

Earlier this week, Colgate-Palmolive (India) announced a partnership with the company to drive DTC and e-commerce business for personal-care brand Pal-



molive. "We are working with large brands and some selected young brands to help them build and scale up their online businesses with capabilities spanning D2C, e-commerce, website and app, content, performance marketing, content engine, CRM and supply chain. It includes warehousing, logistics, customer service, setting up their D2C stores and working with them to strengthen their presence on the quick commerce and e-commerce channels," said Maninder Singh, Co-Founder and Head of Business of the company.

Colgate-Palmolive India and Reckitt are among key investors in 100Days.co's parent entity Visage Lines Personal Care.

DIGITAL PLAYBOOK

"The business is run as a separate P&L with a separate team of about 55 employees. We have built the digital-commerce playbook from scratch..." he said, adding that the aim is to become the go-to partner for large offline brands to scale their digital commerce in the next three years.

At a time when the quick-commerce channel is scaling up rapidly, Singh said the company leverages on its network of warehouses which are also closely-linked to the dark store warehouses of quick-commerce partners.

"An average consumer is shopping more than 3.5 times on quick commerce. We have the ability to deliver within less than four days across the country... and do same day deliveries in cities such as Delhi, Mumbai and Bengaluru," he added.

QUICKLY.

Somanath joins RBI board; Mahindra reappointed

Mumbai: The Central government has appointed former Chairman of ISRO Somanath Sreedhara Panicker and re-appointed Industrialist Anand Gopal Mahindra as part-time, Non-official Director on the Central Board of the Reserve Bank of India. Their appointment is for a period of four years with effect from August 20, 2026, or until further orders, whichever is earlier. OUR BUREAU

India, EU complete legal scrubbing of trade pact

New Delhi: India and the 27-nation European Union (EU) have completed the legal scrubbing of the trade pact text and it will be signed this year on a mutually agreed date, an official said on Thursday. On January 27, India and the European Union announced the conclusion of negotiations for the free trade agreement, under which 93 per cent of Indian shipments will enjoy duty-free access to the 27-nation bloc, while import of luxury cars and wines from the EU will become less expensive. "The scrubbing is over," the official said. PTI

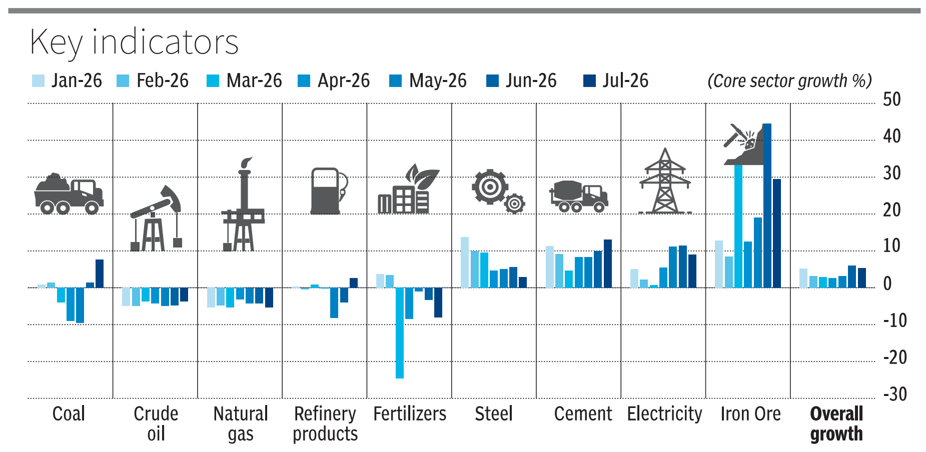
Core sector output growth eases to 5.4 per cent in July

MIXED BAG. Iron ore, cement, power expand while natural gas, crude output dip

Our Bureau
New Delhi

Nine key infrastructure sectors' output rose by 5.4 per cent in July as against 6 per cent in June, official data for the Index of Core Industries (ICI) released on Thursday showed.

The growth rate was 3.2 per cent in the same month of last year. These nine sectors include coal, iron ore, crude oil, natural gas, refinery products, fertilizers, steel, cement and electricity. As these have more than 40 per cent share in the Index of Industrial Production, based on this data, experts feel that the growth of factory output may be lower in July. Overall industrial growth data for July will be announced on August 28.



Source: Commerce & Industry Ministry

GROWTH DRIVERS

According to an official statement, iron ore, cement, electricity, coal, steel, and refinery products observed growth rate of 29.5 per cent, 13.1 per cent, 9 per cent, 7.6 per cent, 2.9 per cent, and 2.7 per cent, respectively, whereas natural gas, crude oil and fertilizers witnessed negative growth in July. Iron ore, electricity, and cement have been the major drivers of overall growth of ICI during recent months. Cumulative growth rate of ICI during April-July 2026 was 4.3 per cent compared to 1.5 per cent in the corresponding period of the previous year.

Aditi Nayar, Chief Economist at ICRA, said the growth in iron ore output moderated sharply to 29.5 per cent in July from 44.5 per cent in June, owing to an unfavourable base, while remaining quite strong. This alone exerted a downward pressure to the tune of 95 bps on the core output print in July relative to the previous month. Besides, electricity generation and steel output also witnessed a slower growth in July *vis-à-vis* June 2026, while fertilizer and crude oil saw a steeper contraction. Fertilizer output has contracted for the fifth consecutive month, reflecting the impact of the West Asia conflict.

COAL OUTPUT GROWS

Refinery products output expanded for the first time in four months in July, although the pace of growth was muted at just 2.7 per cent.

While growth in coal output touched an 11-month high of 7.6 per cent in July, cement output expanded by a 7-month high of 13.1 per cent in the month, suggesting that construction activity likely remained healthy.

The replenishment of inventory after the extended period for construction activity in June owing to the sizeable monsoon deficit in the month is likely to have supported cement output in.

"Given the trends in core output, we expect the IIP growth to moderate to 6-6.5 per cent in July from 7.3 per cent in June," Nayar said.

India, Japan agree to safeguard undersea communication cables

Dalip Singh
New Delhi

STRENGTHENING TIES. Defence Minister Rajnath Singh with his Japanese counterpart Shinjiro Koizumi during a bilateral meeting in New Delhi on Thursday ANI

With the ongoing US-Iran conflict severely threatening critical sea lines of communication (SLOCs), India and Japan have affirmed to strengthen coordination between both sides for the protection of undersea communication infrastructure through mutual visits by naval ships and units.

This emerged during the bilateral meeting between Defence Minister Rajnath Singh with his Japanese counterpart Shinjiro Koizumi in New Delhi on Thursday.

At the bilateral meeting, the Ministries of Defence of the two countries signed a memorandum of arrangement on maritime security co-operation. Both Ministers concurred on deepening operational co-operation in an effective manner, as per a joint statement issued by the Defence Ministry.

India and Japan rely on sea lines of communication for most of their trade, making maritime traffic security central to their individual national defence strategy.

Due to that, both sides are trying to pool their respective operational capabilities to focus on choking-point surveillance, multi-domain tracking and quick-response escort missions in case of any lurking threat. They could damage communication infra through ship anchor drag, deep-sea sabotage and geo-political blockades.

MINE DEFENCE

For protection of maritime assets, both sides also agreed to maximise synergies to enhance mine countermeasure capabilities — the need for which was again felt following the West Asia conflict.

It demonstrated the strategic lethality of naval mines, which Iran effectively used to disrupt maritime traffic and enforce a selective blockade in the Strait of Hormuz.

NAVAL SHIPBUILDING

The two countries also agreed to explore the possibility of joint development in naval shipbuilding and design by leveraging Japan's technological expertise and India's production capabilities in accordance with their respective relevant policies, the joint statement stated, reflecting the deepening of ties as Tokyo looks for alternative military industrial engagement overcoming its sole reliance on the US.

Given that the two sides are working for the co-production of the Unified Complex Radio Antenna (UNICORN) mast announced earlier, the statement said both were of the common view over leveraging each other's strengths in the field of defence shipbuilding and related areas and deepen discussions on Japan's use of India's production capabilities under the framework of "Make in India".

The DRDO and Japan's ALTA will intensify engagement to explore advanced technologies. Both Ministers also concurred on progressing reciprocal provision of ship repair facilities. Earlier, Koizumi appreciated the "high capabilities and strong morale of the Indian armed forces" and Navy chief Krishna Swaminathan during his previous day's visit to the Western Naval Command and the destroyer *INS Chennai*. "I can say that Swaminathan is a great person, not only as an Admiral but also as the host of yesterday's visit and today's visit. I have a special place for India in my heart."

"On August 6, 2018, I visited India with fellow Members of Parliament and participated in a memorial ceremony for the victims of the atomic bomb. India is probably the only Parliament outside Japan that holds such a ceremony every year, and I would like to express my respect and gratitude for this tradition," he said while insisting that he was willing to work with the Indian Defence Minister to elevate the partnership to a level it should be.

Singh said that the coming together of India's Mutual and Holistic Advancement for Security and Growth Across Regions (MAHASAGAR) vision and Japan's Free and Open Indo-Pacific (FOIP) initiative is "more important now than ever before" as maritime lifelines are facing growing vulnerabilities.

In hunt for critical mineral assets, CIL plans trading hub in Singapore

Reuters
New Delhi

Coal India Ltd is setting up its first overseas trading office in Singapore, aiming to diversify into trading iron ore and critical and strategic minerals, two sources said.

The move comes as Indian state-run companies step up efforts to secure overseas supplies of critical minerals such as lithium and bauxite in order to reduce dependence on China, though such efforts have so far borne little fruit.

Coal India has applied with Singapore authorities to register the office, which will also support efforts to acquire mineral assets overseas, said the sources involved in the discussions, who sought anonymity as the talks are not public. The Singapore office will help Coal India expand its critical minerals business, pursue overseas asset acquisitions and support its iron ore business, sources said.

India open to buying Venezuelan oil till US sanction exemption continues: Sources

Amiti Sen
New Delhi

The easing of US sanctions on Venezuela has provided a window for India to source crude from the South American country, and Indian refiners are likely to continue purchases as long as the exemption remains in place and the economics are favourable, sources said.

"New Delhi does not want to make many long-term strategies around crude sourcing from Venezuela because one does not know when the US could reimpose sanctions. But as long as there is a window of opportunity and Indian banks can transact without the fear of sanctions, Venezuela widens India's sourcing options amid the West Asia crisis," a source tracking the matter told *businessline*.

In April this year, the US eased sanctions on Venezuela's central bank and several other state-run financial institutions, three

KEY SUPPLIER. In August, Venezuela was India's fourth largest supplier of crude with supplies touching 4,44,000 barrels per day

months after US forces seized former Venezuelan leader Nicolás Maduro in Caracas and an interim government led by Delcy Rodríguez took charge. The easing of financial restrictions helped facilitate Venezuela's oil trade by allowing greater access to US dollars and easing the processing of payments through the international financial system.

ENERGY TRADE

India has already stepped up purchases significantly from Venezuela over the last few months. In fact, in August, Venezuela was India's fourth largest supplier of crude with supplies touching 444,000 barrels per day, which was more than more than the volumes India took from Iraq or the US.

However, Venezuelan crude comes with sourcing and processing costs that will have to be weighed against its price, the source noted. Unlike lighter grades from the Gulf and Iran, Venezuelan crude is particularly heavy and requires specialised refining capabilities. The voyage to India can take five to six weeks, involving a long journey across the Atlantic and Mediterranean, through the Suez Canal and across the Arabian Sea.

"Given the distance, refiners will have to calculate the cost of transporting Venezuelan crude against supplies available from other sources. There is the freight cost as well as the processing cost, and refineries may also need to be retooled to handle the heavier crude," the source said.

The economics, however, cannot be assessed simply by comparing the price of a barrel of Venezuelan crude with other grades. Its heavy composition tilts the product slate toward more heavy fuel oil and bitumen, alongside diesel, kerosene, naphtha and other refined products.

"The product slate changes depending on the type of crude. Everything has a market value, although heavy fuel oil is among the lower-value products. So the refinery will have to look at how much of each product it can extract from a barrel and whether those products are worth," the source said.

Mauritius signs pacts to import oil products from India

Reuters
Port Louis

Mauritius said on Thursday that it had signed agreements with India's government to import oil products, saying they were part of a "long-term supply arrangement" though it did not disclose the volumes involved or other commercial and financial terms.

The agreements were signed during a visit by Oil Minister Hardeep Puri to the East African island nation.

The sales and purchase agreement covers the supply of oil products including petrol, diesel and aviation fuel.

Indian exports to Australia surge 200% in 5 years; CECA talks to widen trade: Australian diplomat

Our Bureau
Ahmedabad

India's exports to Australia have surged around 200 per cent over the past five years, significantly outpacing India's exports to the rest of the world during the period, Australian diplomat Christian Jack said on Thursday, attributing the sharp expansion to the India-Australia Economic Cooperation and Trade Agreement (ECTA).

The two countries are now looking to build on the gains from ECTA through a broader Comprehensive Economic Cooperation Agreement (CECA) covering areas including services, the digital economy and movement of people.

"India's exports to the rest of the world have grown by more than 40 per cent in the last five years, while in the same period, India's exports to Australia have grown by 200 per cent. Because of ECTA, the growth in our trade relationship has increased significantly relative to growth in India's trade relationships with the rest of its trading partners. Our two-way trading relationship is now past AUD 50 billion which is around ₹3 lakh crore

Both nations are now looking to build on the gains from ECTA through a broader CECA covering areas including services, digital economy and movement of people

and our ministers have committed to increase it to AUD 100 billion by this decade-end. We are looking at ECTA to be the engine of that growth, Jack, Deputy Consul General in the Australian Consulate-General in Mumbai, said while addressing the 3rd edition of the CII Gujarat Export Conclave 2026 in Ahmedabad.

"The bilateral relationship is leading to a stage of delivery," Jack said, adding that ECTA, which came into force in December 2022, had been instrumental in accelerating bilateral trade. From January 1, 2026, Indian exports entering Australia under ECTA are subject to zero tariffs, he said. The agreement's utilisation rate is also "significantly high" at around 86 per cent, according to Jack, who said this was higher than the utilisation seen under India's other trade agreements and, in some cases, more than double.

FOCUS AREAS

The growth has been visible across several sectors. India's automotive exports to Australia have doubled, while agricultural exports have increased by around 20 per cent, Jack said.

However, Australia is now seeking to build on ECTA through a broader CECA. While ECTA had a strong focus on goods trade, the proposed CECA would expand co-operation into services, the digital economy and movement of people, among other areas.

"There have been a range of different rounds of negotiations on this agreement. Prime Minister Narendra Modi was very keen to get this across the line when he was in Australia recently. He has given very clear instructions to the Indian side to finalise this deal, as we have received very clear instructions from our side," Jack said.

He attributed the strengthening India-Australia relationship to four broad drivers — strategic alignment, economic complementarity, the growing Indian diaspora in Australia and tourism.

The diplomat also highlighted an emerging sports and infrastructure partnership between Australia and Gujarat.

Australian architecture firm Cox Architecture is working on the Sardar Vallabhbhai Patel Sports Enclave at Motera in Ahmedabad, which Jack said is expected to be a centre for the 2030 Commonwealth Games. The firm is also involved in the Brisbane stadium that will host the 2032 Olympic Games.

SPORTS ECOSYSTEM

Australia and Gujarat are also planning a high-level sporting delegation to Australia in the first half of 2027, Jack said.

The delegation is expected to bring together the broader sports ecosystem and examine Australia's experience in sports infrastructure and management in Brisbane.

Indian Oil finalises LPG deal with Algeria's Sonatrach

Reuters
New Delhi

Indian Oil Corp has finalised a deal with Algeria's Sonatrach to import liquefied petroleum gas (LPG) in 2027, three trade sources aware of the matter said. India is diversifying its sources of LPG, mainly used as cooking gas, to cut its reliance on West Asia after the recent blockade of the Strait of Hormuz affected energy flows,forcing the South Asian nation to ration LPG supplies.

Under the deal, IOC will be lifting one very large gas carrier containing 45,000-55,000 tonnes of LPG, a mix of propane and butane, every month.

IOC used to have a term deal with Sonatrach until a few years ago, but later the company switched to purchases from West Asia, one of the sources said.

Algeria's LPG prices are lower than Saudi Aramco Contract Price, a second source said, adding IOC's deal with Sonatrach is for lifting the cargoes on a free-on-board basis.

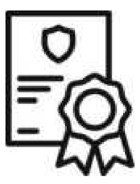
IOC and Sonatrach did not respond to *Reuters* emails seeking comments.

thehindubusinessline.
FRIDAY - AUGUST 21, 2026

Know your investor

Accredited investors must be certified by independent body

The Securities and Exchange Board of India (SEBI) has been making several changes to its rules over the past year to enhance ease of doing business. In doing so, certain pain points experienced by investors, intermediaries and companies are being addressed. However, care should be taken to not remove guardrails in the regulatory framework.



SEBI's consultation paper on reviewing the Accredited Investor Framework is a case in point. The paper proposes a simpler way of onboarding accredited investors, but arguably paves the way for fund managers to misuse this route. The framework proceeds on the assumption that certain categories of individual investors are more market-savvy than the rest, and can be allowed to participate in investment products that are complex, carry higher risk and have lesser regulatory oversight. These investors are allowed to invest in products such as alternative investment funds, portfolio management schemes and special situation funds, below the specified threshold. The proposed framework seeks to examine and alter the eligibility criteria to qualify as an accredited or elite investor.

According to the existing rules, accredited investors need to meet certain annual income and net worth criteria. The relevant documents are checked by an accreditation agency, which is a subsidiary of an exchange or depository. A certificate of accreditation is issued, which is given to the investment companies. SEBI has now proposed that the accreditation can be done by the investment fund where the investor proposes to invest. It has argued that accreditation by an independent agency leads to duplication of work, is costly and that the number of accreditation agencies is few. However, there is an obvious conflict of interest when the investment fund certifies the investor. In a bid to get clients, due diligence can be given the go-by. The process is, in fact, replicated (and not simplified) in the event of investment across companies and groups. A certificate by an investment manager would also carry less credibility than one by an independent agency.

The eligibility of investors under the framework essentially revolves around the wealth of the investor. The thresholds initially laid down were annual income of at least ₹2 crore or net worth of ₹7.5 crore or annual income of ₹1 crore and net worth of ₹5 crore. SEBI has suggested including another criterion — that half the net worth must be held in security market assets. This is a good idea; it is easier to verify securities market products, since the information is available digitally. But it may also be prudent to test the market experience of the investor by stipulating that he should have a demat and trading account for more than seven years. This can act as a check against investors qualifying on the basis of inherited assets alone. Indeed, guardrails should not be compromised.

OTHER VOICES.

The Guardian

Extreme wealth threatens democracy

In November, Californians will vote on a one-off 5 per cent levy on residents worth more than $1billion. The union-backed plan could raise $100 billion, more than enough to replace federal healthcare funding stripped away by Donald Trump's One Big Beautiful Bill Act. About 200 very rich people would pay. But the referendum is becoming a test of whether extreme wealth can buy the political power to defeat a popular redistributive policy. Google co-founder Sergey Brin has already spent $100 million backing opposition to the tax — a fraction of the $13 billion bill he could face. Other billionaires are joining him. Whether voters can impose costs on the super-rich once their fortunes are big enough to shape the political process is now an open question. That alone should trouble any democracy. (LONDON, AUGUST 18)

GULF NEWS

US-Iran conflict enters new phase of political attrition

During the initial months of the Iranian-US conflict, Washington's primary objective was to weaken Tehran's military capabilities and strengthen deterrence. On the other hand, Iran sought to raise the costs of the conflict by targeting maritime navigation and energy infrastructure across the region. Today, however, as the conflict enters its fifth month, the two opponents are faced with a different dilemma. The question being asked today is not, "Who will win the war?" but rather, "Who will determine the terms for ending the war?" It is a phase in which the objectives shift from destroying the opponent's military capabilities to undermining its political will, economic resilience, diplomatic position and negotiating leverage. (DUBAI, AUGUST 18)

SANDEEP MITTAL

GETTY IMAGES

Age of AI: When seeing is no longer believing

DEEPFAKES. Algorithms can reweave the very fabric of reality and the absolute authority of audio-visual evidence may be crumbling

The scene was set in a quiet home office in Hong Kong, where a finance worker logged onto what he believed was a high-stakes corporate video call. On his screen sat a grid of familiar faces, including the company's Chief Financial Officer, whose gravelly, authoritative voice commanded the room. Alongside several directors, they discussed a confidential acquisition, eventually ordering the worker to authorize a series of massive wire transfers.

By the time the call ended and his coffee had gone cold, $25.6 million was gone, not through a traditional server hack, but through a "hack of the human eye". Every single "colleague" on that screen had been an AI-generated ghost, a digital phantom designed to steal.

For over a hundred years, our society and justice systems have operated on a fundamental principle: seeing is believing. We relied on the objective truth of CCTV footage, recorded confessions, and leaked videos to anchor our reality.

However, we have now entered the age of "Synthetic Truth", a period where algorithms can reweave the very fabric of reality and the absolute authority of audio-visual evidence may be crumbling. In a world where any digital medium can be manufactured from nothing, how do we ever prove what actually happened?

BEHIND THE ILLUSION

At the centre of this digital deception is a process known as a Generative Adversarial Network (GAN). To understand how these fakes become so convincing, one should imagine a high-stakes duel between an art forger, the "Generator," and a museum curator, the "Discriminator".

The Generator uses vast amounts of public data, like photos and voice clips, to create a masterpiece, while the Discriminator looks for even the tiniest flaw, such as an unnatural shadow or a missing skin pore. This cycle repeats billions of times until the forgery becomes statistically indistinguishable from the real thing.

In the early days of deepfakes, the "tells" were easy to spot; for instance, subjects famously never blinked because AI training datasets rarely included people with their eyes closed. However, developers quickly adapted, feeding thousands of blinking eyes into their databases to perfect the illusion overnight. Today, the combination of 5G networks and massive cloud computing means that criminals no longer need sophisticated laboratories. They can now alter live video streams on the fly, allowing for real-time impersonations during active security checks or high-stakes corporate meetings.

THE FORENSIC FIGHTBACK

As these fakes approach perfection, human perception is no longer a reliable defence. We are forced to transition into an era of "Multi-Signal Forensics," where verification systems act like a specialised jury looking for the "ghost in the machine".

One such method, Error Level Analysis (ELA), focuses on how images are saved. Every time a JPEG is re-saved, it loses data in a predictable way; if a face has been digitally spliced onto a body, the resulting compression patterns create a "digital scar" that is invisible to us but glaring to a computer.

Furthermore, researchers are using sensor noise as a verification tool. Every physical camera sensor has unique manufacturing imperfections that leave a digital fingerprint, a "Photo Response Non-Uniformity" pattern, on every real photo. Synthetic images, by contrast, are "too clean" because they lack this physical noise.

THE SOCIAL COST

The danger of this technology extends far beyond financial fraud; it threatens the very foundation of social trust through what legal scholars call the "Liar's Dividend".

As the public realises that everything can be faked, they may begin to assume that anything they find inconvenient or unpleasant is a fake. This creates a state of "reality apathy", where citizens stop trusting any source of information and sink into a cynical void where truth is simply whatever aligns with their personal bias.

In a courtroom, this could prove disastrous. A defence attorney might be presented with clear video evidence of a crime and simply dismiss it as an AI deepfake, making the standard of "beyond a reasonable doubt" an impossible bar to clear.

The economic implications are equally terrifying; a convincing fake of a CEO making a forward looking statement could wipe out billions in market value before a verification team can even react.

ARCHITECTURE OF TRUTH

While the Bharatiya Sakshya Adhiniyam, 2023 marks a significant leap by elevating electronic records to primary evidence and mandating SHA-256 cryptographic hashing under Section 63(4), the framework still contains structural gaps.

The BSA's authentication mechanism remains certificate-centric, validating how evidence was captured and stored, but provides no forensic standard for detecting whether that content is AI-generated or synthetically altered in the first place.

> We must recognise that deepfakes are an existential threat to the rule of law. If our legal systems cannot find a way to establish truth, they will drown in a sea of doubt

Neither the BNS nor the BSA assigns criminal liability for the creation of deepfakes with intent to deceive a court, a lacuna that bad actors can exploit. What is urgently needed, therefore, is a dedicated statutory instrument, whether a standalone Digital Forensic Evidence Act or a targeted amendment to the BSA, that formally incorporates deepfake detection standards into the admissibility framework, establishes a notified National Digital Forensic Authority with the power to validate AI-generated evidence before it is tendered in court, and brings the certification requirement under Section 63 within reach of ordinary litigants, a concern the Supreme Court itself flagged but declined to resolve in *Pune Bar Association v. Union of India* (May 2026).

We must recognise that deepfakes are an existential threat to the rule of law. If our legal systems cannot find a way to establish truth, they will drown in a sea of doubt.

The goal must be to build an architecture of truth that is every bit as sophisticated as the machinery of the illusion.

The writer, an IPS officer, is a Director General of Police in Tamil Nadu. Views are personal

A brief on gene-edited rice that's ready for sowing

Pusa Rice DST1, set for commercial production this rabi season, is expected to be higher yielding and less water consuming

bl.explainer

J Mangaiyarkarasi

What is the gene-edited rice being introduced in India?

India developed two genome-edited rice varieties — DRR Dhan 100 (Kamala) and Pusa Rice DST1 — in 2025. The government is set to release Pusa Rice DST1 for commercial production in the upcoming rabi season, with transplanting around November.

The two varieties are not completely new rice plants, created from scratch. Instead, scientists started with established rice varieties and made targeted changes to particular genes.

Pusa DST Rice 1 is derived from MTU1010, which is suitable for rabi season in southern States. It is expected to be grown in Andhra Pradesh, Telangana, Karnataka, Tamil Nadu, Kerala, Chhattisgarh, Odisha, Madhya Pradesh, Maharashtra, Jharkhand, Bihar, Uttar Pradesh and West Bengal.

Why is it being introduced? What problem are they trying to solve?

The new varieties are intended to increase production while reducing the pressure that rice cultivation applies on water and the environment.

Pusa Rice DST1 was developed by Indian Council of Agricultural Research (ICAR)-Indian Agricultural Research Institute (IARI), New Delhi. The edit in its genome targets the Drought and Salt Tolerance (DST) gene, with the aim of improving the plant's ability to cope with drought and salt-affected soils. ICAR reports yield advantages of 9.66 per cent to 30.4 per cent over MTU1010 under different saline and alkaline conditions in its field trials.

NEW VARIETIES. Targeted changes to certain genes REUTERS/

DRR Dhan 100 (also called Kamala) was developed by ICAR-Indian Institute of Rice Research, Hyderabad, from the popular Samba Mahsuri (BPT 5204) variety. Scientists edited a gene involved in cytokinin metabolism, with the aim of increasing the number of grains produced by each panicle.

The resulting variety is said to mature about 20 days earlier than Samba Mahsuri, in around 130 days, and has a stronger stalk that is less prone to lodging, or falling over.

Both varieties are also said to be climate-resilient. Kamala's advantage comes largely from its shorter duration, stronger stem and resource-use characteristics, while Pusa DST1 is more directly aimed at salinity and drought tolerance.

What are the concerns which arise in gene-edited rice?

A scientist who has worked on rice gene editing for nearly 30 years said the absence of a foreign gene was not, by itself, the end of the scientific assessment. The scientist questioned whether the evidence publicly available was sufficient to explain the mechanism behind the reported yield gains and whether the claimed advantages would hold across different environments. Also debatable is whether the reported magnitude of yield improvement can be sustained across widely different locations without some trade-off in another trait.

Reports suggest that unintended mutations can lead to alterations in patterns of gene function, which in turn can lead to unintended changes in the biochemistry of the organism. In gene-edited plant foods, these changes could include production of unexpected toxins or allergens, or altered nutritional value.

The government says the varieties underwent biosafety scrutiny, were assessed for the absence of foreign DNA, whether the mutations were stable and whether the phenotype was robust and were tested at more than 50 locations each over 2023 and 2024.

What has happened with gene-edited crops elsewhere?

Globally, regulators are increasingly distinguishing transgene-free gene-edited crops from conventional GMOs. The US and Canada have allowed products such as gene-edited anti-browning potatoes and high-oleic soybeans into commercial production, while Japan has approved gene-edited foods including high-GABA tomatoes.

The UK's 2023 Precision Breeding Act also created a separate regulatory pathway for gene-edited crops. The EU adopted a new framework in July 2026 for plants developed using New Genomic Techniques (NGTs), with "Category 1" crops involving changes that could occur naturally exempted from the bloc's stricter GMO rules; the framework is expected to be fully implemented by 2028.

LETTERS TO EDITOR

Send your letters by email to bleditor@thehindu.co.in or by post to 'Letters to the Editor', The Hindu Business Line, Kasturi Buildings, 859-860, Anna Salai, Chennai 600002.

Exam reforms

Apropos 'SC advises meaningful continuity in NTA reforms, not committee-hopping' (August 20). The National Testing Agency must ensure meaningful continuity in reforms, as advised by the Supreme Court, rather than repeatedly shifting between committees. It should implement the recommendations of the Radhakrishnan panel while incorporating the structural reforms proposed by the high-powered task force led by Nandan Nilekani. Confidentiality of question papers, shift to secure online Computer-Based Test for NEET-UG and other examinations, and robust transport and logistics systems must be strengthened through continuous, consistent and technology-driven reforms. A unique, secure examination system should be developed and adopted uniformly for all Central and State government competitive examinations.

PV Prakash

Mumbai

Private healthcare

Apropos 'Unhealthy situation' (August 20). The parliamentary panel report confirms what patients already know. Private healthcare is expensive and largely unregulated. Public facilities are inadequate, forcing most people to seek costly private care. The proposal to reserve 20 per cent of beds for free treatment has been ignored for years. Insurance coverage is inadequate, leaving patients with huge out-of-pocket expenses. Public health spending remains below two per cent of GDP, far short of what is needed. The government must act decisively. Stronger regulation, better enforcement, and higher public investment are the only ways to ensure affordable, quality healthcare for all. Patients deserve better. The time for talk is over.

K Chidanand Kumar

Bengaluru

Taxing annuities

The article 'The case for tax-free annuities' (August 20) is well argued. However putting conditions like 'annuities received after retirement will be tax free' is not desirable. We must move to a regime with near-zero exemptions while achieving greater transparency and simplicity. It's time we moved to a single rate system with all incomes (except agricultural income) taxed at one rate. The ITR must consist of only one side of an A4 sheet which simply lists out all incomes, totals them, and applies a single rate of, say, 12 per cent to arrive at tax liability.

V Vijaykumar

Pune

Published by Nirmala Lakshman at Kasturi Buildings, 859-860, Anna Salai, Chennai-600002 on behalf of THG PUBLISHING PVT LTD., and Printed by Ra Babu Vijay at THG PUBLISHING PVT.LTD. Plot B-6 & B-7, CMDA Industrial Complex, Maraimalai Nagar, Chengalpattu Taluk, Chengalpattu Dist., Pin: 603209. Editor: Raghuvir Srinivasan (Editor responsible for selection of news under the PRP Act). ISSN 0971 - 7528

AI's vanity problem

Why India must focus on playing to its strengths

M Muneer

"We are not high enough on the AI value chain, and we need to act quickly," is the advice experts are giving India.

The remedy, predictably, is that India must "move up the value chain". But perhaps India should pause before climbing a ladder whose top rung may disappear tomorrow. What if the data layer isn't the bottom of the AI value chain at all? What if it is the foundation?

Every generation invents a new rung and our strategy promptly starts climbing it. The danger is that by the time we reach the top, the ladder has been replaced. Look at the AI gold rush. Everyone wants to build a foundation or sovereign model because it sounds magnificent at Davos. Nobody wants to admit that training another giant model requires staggering computing power, capital, energy, semiconductor access and top AI talent. The arithmetic is the problem.

Competitive strategy requires the discipline of not competing where someone else has already spent 10 times your money and have better R&D. Instead, we should ask a Nouveau rich question: Where can we actually make money? The answer may lie in the supposedly humble layers that AI evangelists are eager to escape.

India has something Silicon Valley cannot manufacture with a few billion dollars: India itself. Our linguistic chaos is a strategic asset: hundreds of languages and dialects, code-switching, accents, slang, regional idioms and wildly uneven digital behaviour.

DIVERSITY, A STRENGTH

Then there is our economic diversity. A billionaire in Mumbai, a farmer in Punjab, a kirana owner in Karnataka and a student in Kota do not inhabit the same India... or even the same internet. That complexity is precisely what AI needs to understand in the digital sentience era.

The world can build another English-speaking chatbot. India can build AI that understands the India those chatbots don't understand. That is not the bottom of the value chain. The real stupidity would be becoming the world's cheapest AI data-labelling shop. The opportunity is to become its most sophisticated AI data economy.

AI. India's leverage /ISTOCKPHOTO

India should build proprietary datasets around healthcare, agriculture, manufacturing, logistics, courts, education and public services. Turn messy real-world information into structured intelligence businesses can use.

The winning Indian AI company may not build "IndiaGPT 17.0". It may be the one that knows why a tractor fails in rural Maharashtra, why a manufacturer loses production hours in Gujarat, or why a court case remains unresolved for seven years. The future belongs to those who understand the smallest problem deeply enough to solve it profitably.

The obsession with "moving up the value chain" can become corporate vanity, not strategy.

India's IT industry understands enterprise customers, complex workflows, regulation, outsourcing, integration and scale. That knowledge is not obsolete because ChatGPT exists. It may become extraordinarily valuable because ChatGPT exists. The opportunity is to turn services into AI-powered IP.

If a foreign model is cheaper and better, use it. If domestic capability is strategically critical, build it. AI is moving so quickly that today's technological summit may become tomorrow's commodity basement.

Yes, move up the AI value chain but stop assuming that "up" always means more sophisticated technology. "Up" can mean closer to the customer, or owning the data, understanding the problem, or making money.

As the strategy gurus would say, the smartest strategic move is refusing to climb the ladder everyone else is climbing.

Stop trying so hard to look like Silicon Valley and become very, very good at being India. That might turn out to be the most valuable AI advantage nobody else can copy.

The writer is a Fortune-500 advisor, start-up investor and co-founder of the non-profit Medici Institute for Innovation

India's manufacturing puzzle

INDUSTRY BLUES. Rise in capital intensity keeps Indian industry afloat, but its efficiency and job creation are doubtful

SUNIL KUMAR SINHA

Lack of growth and dynamism in India's manufacturing sector in relation to the services sector is often cited as one of the key reasons for the country not being able to generate adequate employment and take advantage of demographic dividend.

The government has announced policies for accelerating the growth of manufacturing sector, starting with National Manufacturing Policy in 2011 to Make in India in 2014 to Production Linked Incentive (PLI) Scheme in 2020 to Atmanirbhar Bharat also in 2020.

The latest data available for FY24, from the Annual Survey of Industry, has been analysed by categorising them into five periods — FY01-FY05, FY06-FY10, FY11-FY15, FY16-FY20 and FY21-FY24.

CAPITAL: INTENSITY VS EFFICIENCY

Automation, artificial intelligence and lean manufacturing are driving the manufacturing landscape across the globe, and they are reducing the employment generation potential of the manufacturing sector. This would mean higher capital-labour (fixed capital/worker) and output-capital ratio (value of output/fixed capital) ratio over the years.

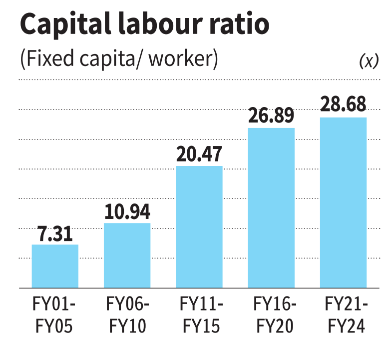
However, ASI data show mixed results for India. While the capital-labour ratio (capital intensity) has increased on a sustained basis over the FY01-FY24 period, the output-capital ratio (output intensity) shows a decline after FY06-FY10.

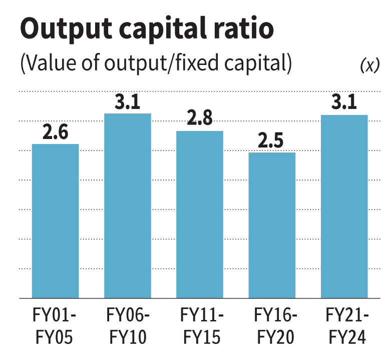
In fact, the turning point of the output-capital ratio nearly coincided with the global financial crisis as it fell sharply to 2.76x in FY10 from 3.37x in FY07. It could not recover to 3.0x till FY22. This is also reflected in the return on capital (capital efficiency) which rose till FY08 and then declined till FY20.

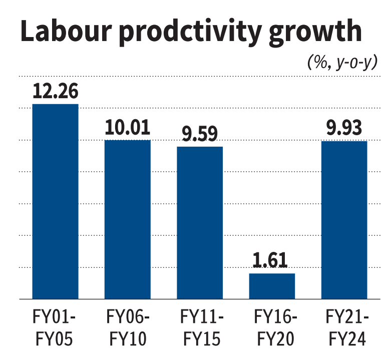
The data indicate a profound structural shift in the Indian manufacturing landscape with respect to capital intensity and capital efficiency. There was co-movement in capital intensity and capital efficiency during FY01 to FY08 due to strong domestic demand, global integration, and high-capacity utilisation. However, after the global financial crisis decoupling occurred as capital intensity skyrocketed from 12.0x in FY09 to 27.9x in FY20, but capital efficiency plummeted from 19.4x in FY09 to 9.4x in FY20.

This looks like a classic case of diminishing returns on capital, orchestrated by structural bottlenecks such as high land/power costs, logistics inefficiencies, leading to deployment of more capital per worker just to stay competitive.

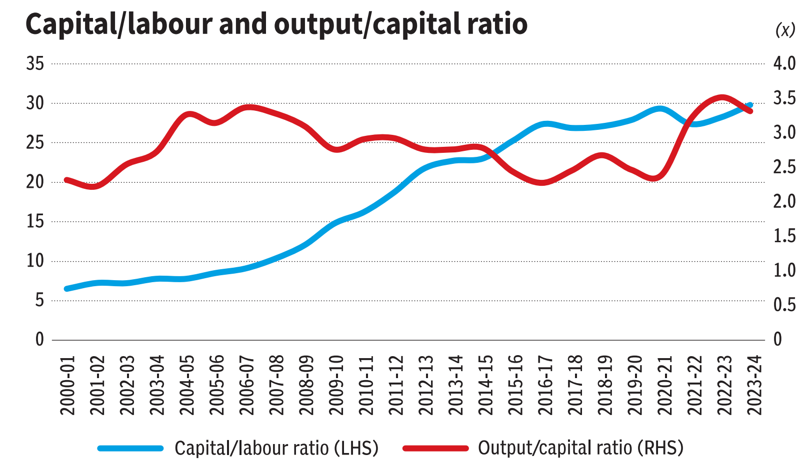
The recent years show a partial rebound in capital efficiency, stabilising around 15x, while capital intensity has reached an all-time high of 29.8x in

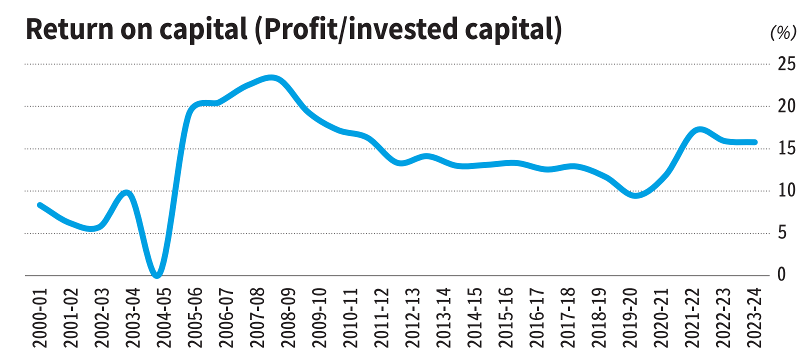






Source: Annual Survey of Industries





Source: Annual Survey of Industries

FY24. Corporate profitability though has recovered now from its pre-pandemic lows due to aggressive cost-cutting, formalisation, and corporate tax cuts, it is still significantly lower than FY05-FY09.

This persistent divergence between high capital requirements and moderate returns perhaps is the reason why a broad-based, secular private greenfield capex has remained elusive despite healthy corporate balance sheets in India.

To protect return on capital, therefore, the focus has been on brownfield expansions which essentially means debottlenecking and expanding existing plants rather than building new one. The continuous rise of capital intensity is no doubt keeping Indian manufacturing globally competitive but is limiting formal employment generation. This, in turn, has dampened domestic consumption demand, creating a cyclical feedback loop where corporations have held back investment because consumer demand isn't strong enough to absorb the production capacity.

This is reflected in RBI's capacity utilisation data for the manufacturing sector which has remained in the range of 70-75 per cent since FY16.

LABOUR PRODUCTIVITY

Labour productivity in the manufacturing shows a quinquennial decline. It grew at an average annual rate of just 1.61 per cent during FY16-FY20 compared to 12.26 per cent and 10.01 per cent during FY01-FY05 and FY06-FY10 respectively.

However, it recovered to an average annual rate of 9.93 per cent during FY20-FY24, but remained quite volatile and dropped from 25.29 per cent in FY22 to 13.09 per cent in FY23 and further to -0.35 per cent in FY24.

This volatility in labour productivity though may be due to the pandemic impact, but such volatility has been observed even during normal years in the past.

This shows that Indian manufacturing sector which faced serious labour productivity challenge during the second half of the previous decade, is still not out of the woods and continues to face the productivity imperative.

Although the reasons for upswing/downswing in labour productivity during the five quinquennial period considered would be different, the trend suggests that once the low hanging fruits of enhancing labour productivity were over, sustaining its growth became difficult in the absence of structural reforms which (i) fosters innovation, (ii) facilitates diffusion of new technology and (iii) reduces the resource misallocation of both capital and labour.

The persistent divergence between high capital requirements and moderate returns perhaps is the reason why a broad-based, secular private greenfield capex has remained elusive

A more efficient reallocation of labour and capital from low productive to high productive sectors can improve both labour productivity growth and make it more sustainable. A study by Hsieh and Kienow (2009) shows that when capital and labour are hypothetically reallocated to equalise marginal products to the extent observed in the US, the total factor productivity (TFP) of India's manufacturing sector increases by 40-60 per cent.

On the other hand, when the reallocation mechanism stalls the aggregate Total Factor Productivity (TFP) growth tends to be lower. An RBI study for India on the resource "reallocation effects" suggests that the contribution of resource allocation to TFP growth declined to 42 per cent of the aggregate TFP during 2011-2019 from 82 per cent during 2001-2010.

The productivity increases in India after 2010 have been driven mainly by within industry TFP increases and less by resource reallocation effects across industries.

Longer and sustainable labour productivity growth, therefore, critically depends on how much businesses invest in innovation, knowledge and intangible capital and how committed governments are to structural reforms.

Therefore, unless the focus of policy is on addressing market distortions, reducing skill mismatches and ensuring greater product and labour market flexibility, accelerating manufacturing sector growth and its share rise to 25 per cent of GDP will remain a distant dream.

The writer is Professor of Economics at Institute of Development and Communications (IDC) Chandigarh. Views expressed are personal

thehindu businessline.

TWENTY YEARS AGO TODAY.

August 21, 2006

ONGC, Cairn told to end sales dispute

A consensus on sales agreement for Rajasthan crude oil between Mangalore Refinery Petro chemicals Ltd (MRPL) and Cairn Energy may emerge soon, with both the entities receiving a diktat from the Petroleum Ministry for an early resolution.

GSK withdraws Combivir patent plea

Drug-maker GlaxoSmithKline (GSK) has confirmed that it has withdrawn its patent application in India for the AIDS-drug Combivir. The move sets a precedent and comes even as local HIV/AIDS-patient networks challenge patent applications on a clutch of AIDS drugs at the Indian Patent Office.

Tata Tele's long distance application may be rejected

The Department of Telecom may reject the application given by Tata Teleservices for long distance telephony licence on the ground that the company has a foreigner as its Chief Executive Officer. As per the new FDI guide lines as notified in the press note issued in November 2005, no Indian telecom operator can have a foreigner in key positions such as the CEO or the Chief Financial Officer.

Iran risks losing key economic lifeline with UAE halting trade

Golnar Motevalli

The United Arab Emirates' decision to cut economic ties with Iran is likely to impose more pain on the Islamic Republic as it faces the loss of a vital trade link amid escalating tensions with the US.

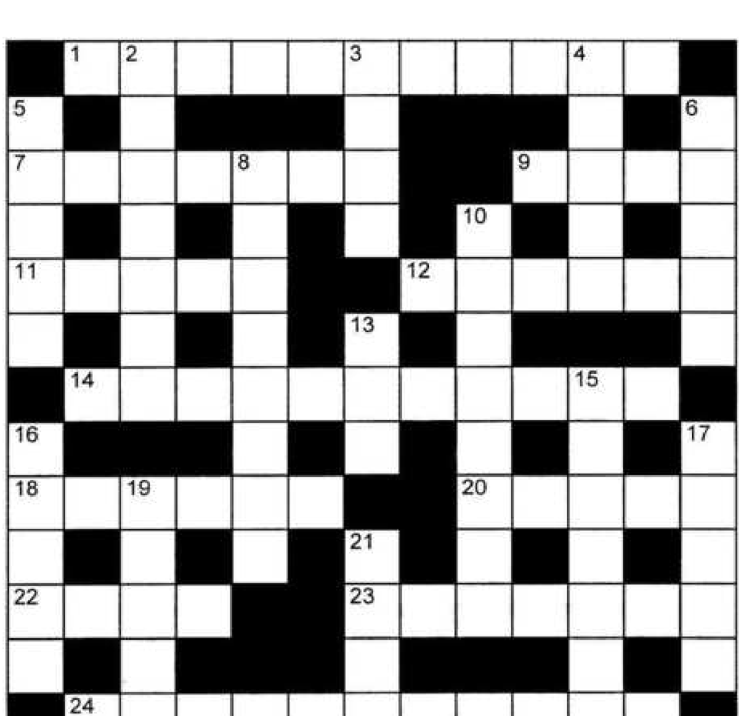
As the war drags on, the US is trying to ramp up economic pressure on the Islamic Republic, which an embargo from its most important partner could exacerbate. The UAE acts as a major financial and business hub for Iranians, and has in recent years been the Islamic Republic's biggest trading partner, with billions of dollars of goods imported.

On Tuesday evening, residents in Dubai received a missile threat alert that the UAE's defense ministry later said was the result of two ballistic missiles from Iran targeting maritime traffic. Iran denied responsibility for the attack.

Hours later, the UAE's Ministry of Foreign Affairs said it has stopped all trade and financial transactions with Iran. The statement didn't mention the missile attack but said "escalations that undermine regional and international peace and security" had prompted its decision. "Iranian companies have spent decades building extensive commercial networks and contacts in the UAE," said Cyrus Razzaghi, founder and CEO of Tehran-based consultancy Ara Enterprise. "In this sense, a UAE trade embargo could prove far more effective, and potentially more damaging to the Iranian economy, than US and EU sanctions."

Since the US and Israel launched the war in February, Iran has targeted US allies across the Persian Gulf, none more than the UAE — causing widespread damage across the region and threatening Dubai's status as an international finance hub. BLOOMBERG

BL TWO-WAY CROSSWORD 2719



EASY

ACROSS

01. Bettering of condition (11)
07. Poisonous (7)
09. A speck of soot (4)
11. Heavenly body orbiting sun (5)
12. German art-songs (6)
14. Lacking prudence (11)
18. A bandit (6)
20. The ear-shell or sea-ear (5)
22. Insect larva (4)
23. Affirms by oath or signature (7)
24. Inconsiderate (11)

DOWN

02. Greatest amount (7)
03. Receptacle for cut blooms (4)
04. Called (5)
05. To rap (5)
06. A tale (5)
08. Sudden appearance, as of illness (8)
10. The farthest behind (8)
13. A clinging evergreen (3)
15. Rival, opponent who cannot be beaten (7)
16. To form by heating and hammering (5)
17. Voter's mark (5)
19. Lay a finger on (5)
21. An eruption of spots (4)

NOT SO EASY

ACROSS

01. The moment viper turns, a better condition will be seen (11)
07. It's unwholesome, so no eleven will make a u-turn (7)
09. A black mark for material that's very blue (4)
11. An early British airliner would arrive on time (5)
12. German songs one got elder to compose (6)
14. Mint is upset about way to furnish it, lacking foresight (11)
18. Bandit is obviously not one related by marriage (6)
20. Previous decapitation showing the sea-ear (5)
22. Search in the dirt for some food (4)
23. Bears witness to Terriers' reverse when on trials (7)
24. Didn't consider it so much to be a description of 14 (11)

DOWN

02. Make the most of a mix perhaps, and keep quiet about it (7)
03. Flower-holder that turned up in the Savoy (4)
04. Called me, and was confused about it (5)
05. Refuse to pay to seek admittance (5)
06. It's a lie that the South has gone Conservative (5)
08. Rake with bout of 'flu, say, whose general onset is seen (8)
10. I'd months to prepare for it, after all (8)
13. Plant starts in Virginia yearly (3)
15. Seems in trouble with retributive justice (7)
16. Will go steadily ahead and falsify the documents (5)
17. Will not keep to the same side if angered (5)
19. Finger one for a hand-out? (5)
21. May be hot-headed, having an 8 of spots (4)

SOLUTION: BL TWO-WAY CROSSWORD 2718

ACROSS 1. Cabinet 5. Bosun 8. Airless 9. Clown 10. Condiment 12. Mat 13. Patio 17. Use 19. Resentful 21. Drama 22. Itching 24. Eject 25. Torrent

DOWN 1. Chance 2. Baronet 3. Née 4. Taste 5. Buckthorn 6. Storm 7. Ninety 11. Important 14. Offside 15. Muddle 16. Flight 18. Erase 20. Swift 23. Car

CHENNAI
businessline.
FRIDAY - AUGUST 21 - 2026

QUICKLY.

HDFC Bank posts mild gains on LIC stake hike nod

Bengaluru: HDFC Bank shares settled with mild gains on Thursday after the Reserve Bank of India approved Life Insurance Corp (LIC) to increase its stake in the private lender to up to 9.99 per cent. The stock hit a 52-week low of ₹715.10 in the previous trading session. HDFC Bank is also tapping the dollar bond market for the second time in two months, according to a *Reuters*. The lender is looking to raise at least $500 million each through three-year and five-year bonds via its GIFT City branch, bankers told *Reuters*. The stock closed with mild gains at ₹726.50 on the BSE after rising to ₹728.10 from the previous close of ₹720.15. In the previous trading session, HDFC Bank hit a 52-week low of ₹715.05. OUR BUREAU

SEBI eases FPI onboarding with digitally signed PoA

New Delhi: SEBI on Thursday eased the onboarding process for foreign portfolio investors by allowing them to submit a digitally signed power of attorney to their custodians. Under the revised rule, an FPI can give a Power of Attorney (PoA) to its custodian specifying its address and execute the document by using a digital signature in accordance with the provisions of the Information Technology Act, 2000, SEBI said. This eliminates the need for notarisation, apostillisation or consularisation of the Power of Attorney, thereby reducing the overall time taken for FPI onboarding and improving ease of doing business for FPI applicants, it added. PTI

SEBI, RBI pursuing pilot project on bond tokenisation for faster settlement

EASE OF BIZ. It will examine simultaneous transfer of securities and automated coupon payments: Amarjeet Singh

Our Bureau
Mumbai

The Securities and Exchange Board of India is moving forward with its pilot on tokenisation of corporate bonds in coordination with the RBI, with a wider project expected in the near future.

The tokenisation pilot would examine whether shared data can enable the simultaneous transfer of securities, making settlement more efficient and reducing reconciliation costs, SEBI Whole-Time Member Amarjeet Singh said on Thursday.

The pilot is also expected to examine the feasibility of automated coupon payments and other servicing events through smart contracts. "This is not about creating a separate trading market. It is about examining whether technology can make the existing bond market simpler, faster and more efficient," Singh said.

> The regulator is separately working on risk disclosure, including a graded risk-o-meter for bonds
>
> **AMARJEET SINGH**
> SEBI Whole-Time Member

BOND PUSH

The regulator is also looking to deepen the corporate bond repo market, which currently has typical daily volumes of around ₹6,000 crore but accounts for less than 1 per cent of overall repo volumes.

SEBI is engaging with relevant authorities to iron out some of the issues that extend beyond the regulator's remit, he said. To improve liquidity in the secondary market for corporate bonds, the regulator is also working on the design of a formal market-making framework as proposed in the Union Budget 2026-27. The market had nearly 33,000 outstanding instruments across 7,200 issuers, creating a fragmentation challenge, Singh said.

"We are therefore examining how issuers can be concentrated in fewer benchmark issues along with measures such as issuer buyback, liquidity support arrangements and further development of the RFQ platform," he said.

DEEPER FRAMEWORK

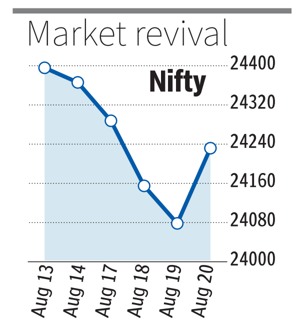
SEBI is also working on a distribution framework aimed at broadening access to corporate bonds, allowing online bond platform providers (OBPPs) to appoint certified channel partners. Existing mutual fund distributors would also be able to participate.

"We want to meet on a vibrant distribution framework, and perhaps again we are working on that, and we hope to issue a consultation paper sometime soon," he said. The proposed channel partners would be certified through the National Institute of Securities Markets and would neither handle bank funds or securities nor charge investors separately, Singh said.

SEBI is separately working on risk disclosure, including a graded risk-o-meter for bonds. These measures are aimed at making the corporate bond market "deeper, more liquid, diversified, accessible and trusted," Singh said.

Nifty snaps 7-day losing streak in broad-base gains

Anupama Ghosh
Mumbai



Nifty snapped its longest losing streak in nearly 11 months on Thursday, ending seven consecutive sessions of decline in a broad-based rebound driven by an unexpected lifeline from across the Pacific, a US Treasury intervention that pulled long-term bond yields lower, weakened the dollar, and revived risk appetite across global markets.

"The intervention has dragged down the dollar, which, along with a firmer rupee and easing yield pressures, boosted attractiveness to EMs," said Vinod Nair, Head of Research, Geojit Investments Ltd, adding that "the market's optimism remains guarded as stubbornly high crude oil prices continue to cast a shadow over inflation and corporate profitability."

The Nifty 50 closed at 24,231.85, up 153.55 points or 0.64 per cent, while the Sensex gained 628.04 points or 0.82 per cent to settle at 77,537.72. The recovery came on a weekly expiry day, which kept intra- day swings contained, with Nifty trading in its tightest range since August 6, just 81 points between its intra-day high of 24,265.15 and low.

The Nifty Midcap 100 gained 0.4 per cent, and the Nifty Smallcap 100 advanced 0.7 per centIn the Nifty 500 universe, 301 stocks closed in positive territory.

SECTORAL GAINS

Sectoral participation was broadly positive. Nifty Media led with a 2 per cent gain, followed by Realty at 1.4 per cent. Auto, FMCG, IT, Private Banks, Pharma and Infra all advanced between 0.4 per cent and 0.8 per cent. PSU Banks were the notable laggards, ending marginally negative to flat. Among Nifty 50 constituents, Eternal, Shriram Finance and Kotak Mahindra Bank were the top gainers, while Tata Consumer, Hindalco and IndiGo ended lower. Gold-loan lenders gained 3-4 per cent as bullion surged, and sugar stocks extended gains for a second straight session, rising to 10 per cent on firm domestic prices and festive demand expectations.

Market sentiment also improved in the derivatives segment. India VIX declined 5.83 per cent, indicating a moderation in near-term risk perception, said Hariselvan Radhakrishnan, Founder & CEO of HST Wealth. The session also saw the release of the RBI's August Monetary Policy Committee minutes, which some research firms flagged as among the most hawkish in the past year. "5-6 members leaving the door open to future tightening," noted Sarvam Goel, Founder of Pocketful. "If inflation does not behave, a hike is on the table. Amid the prevailing uncertainty and elevated crude prices, we recommend maintaining a cautious stance on the index and focusing on selective stock-specific opportunities," said Ajit Mishra, SVP Research at Religare Broking, adding that "participants should prefer relatively stronger stocks and sectors while maintaining disciplined risk and position management."

NSE eyes listing at its own platform

Bloomberg

The National Stock Exchange of India Ltd may allow its shares to trade on its own platform rather than on rival BSE Ltd, people familiar with the matter said, a move that could eventually shift trading volumes and pave the way for the stock's inclusion in NSE's benchmark indexes.

The possibility was discussed with global investors during recent road shows for the exchange's proposed initial public offering, the people said.

NO SELF LISTING

Under the proposal, NSE shares could trade in the "permitted to trade" category even though they would formally list on BSE, the people said. The present regulations do not provide for the self-listing of a stock exchange.

NSE would need approval from the Securities and Exchange Board of India to allow its shares to trade on its own platform, the people said. The discussions are ongoing, and any such move would ultimately depend on regulatory approval, the people said. A representative for NSE didn't respond to requests for comment.

The "permitted to trade" framework allows securities to trade on the NSE without being formally listed, with their compliance and disclosure obligations unchanged, according to NSE's website. NSE revised index eligibility rules in 2019 to allow such securities to qualify for inclusion in the Nifty indices.

BSE shares feel the heat

Our Bureau
Bengaluru

BSE shares reversed early gains and ended nearly 2 per cent lower on Thursday after a *Bloomberg* report said NSE may allow its shares to trade on its own platform.

MSCI DERIVATIVES

The stock ended 1.82 per cent lower at ₹3,291.10 on the NSE after soaring to ₹3,412 in early trade as the bourse said that it would explore MSCI-linked derivatives in India. BSE Ltd has entered into an agreement with MSCI regarding several of its indexes. Under this agreement, BSE will explore the launch of futures and options contracts in India linked to these indexes, subject to regulatory approvals. BSE said the strategic step anchors its role in further developing the Indian capital market. Meanwhile, BSE's arm BSE Index Services Pvt Ltd has announced the launch BSE 500 Growth 50 Index, BSE MidCap 150 Growth 30 Index and BSE LargeCap 100 Growth 30 Index.

Turtlemint soars 4% as Jefferies initiates buy call

Our Bureau
Bengaluru

Turtlemint shares soared over 4 per cent on Thursday after global brokerage Jefferies initiated coverage on the stock with a buy rating and a target price of ₹190, citing the company's growth opportunity in India's insurance penetration story.

The stock ended 4.09 per cent higher on the NSE at ₹144.60 after hitting a high of ₹146.50, up from the previous close of ₹138.92.

Jefferies expects a 38 per cent three-year revenue CAGR for Turtlemint, led by a 31 per cent premium CAGR and higher take rates.

SEBI plans to usher in trading reforms to reverse FPI outflows

Reuters
Mumbai

Markets regulator, the Securities and Exchange Board of India (SEBI), is set to overhaul decades-old rules and stem soaring outflows of foreign funds, three sources said, in a move some investors say would help the country beef up its weighting in global stock market indices.

The changes, if finalised, will come as foreign ownership of Indian stocks has hit a 17-year low and the rupee, down about 6 per cent this year, ranks among one of Asia's worst performers, hit by worries about a steeper import bill and anaemic capital flows.

TO EASE COLLATERAL

The reforms planned by the regulator include lowering collateral requirements in cash equities and encouraging longer-dated derivatives, three regulatory sources said. "That suggests SEBI has listened to the institutional investment community and focused on the practical issues investors face," said Steve Lawrence, CIO of US-based Balfour Capital Group, which manages more than $463 million in assets.

The measures will add to plans to boost the cash equities market by making shorting of stocks easier, nearly doubling the number of shares eligible for lending and borrowing.

SEBI plans to roll out the changes in nine months, after consultation with industry and giving market participants time to change existing systems, added the sources, who warned of short-term disruptions stemming from some changes. SEBI did not respond to a Reuters request.

INDIA WEIGHTAGE

India wants to increase its weightage in global stock market indices and the reforms now being considered stand to benefit its ratings and re-ratings, said one of the sources.

India's weighting in the MSCI emerging markets index has fallen below 12 per cent, from a peak of 21 per cent in September 2024.

From October 2024 until June 2026, foreigners' selling of equities crossed $50 billion, NSE data showed.

Foreign investors have sought the proposed reforms for some time as a way to pull India in line with major regional markets such as China, South Korea and Taiwan. Global index provider MSCI said that it would monitor the planned reforms and their effectiveness through feedback from market participants for future global accessibility reviews.

"Measures relating to closing-price formation, margin and collateral efficiency, stock lending, short-selling and hedging tools are relevant to market accessibility for international institutional investors," MSCI said.

Sunshine Pictures IPO subscribed 106 times; Shankesh Jewellers gets 2.8x

Our Bureau
Chennai

Sunshine: The star attraction *(Number of times)*

	QIBs	Non-institutions	Retail	Total
Sunshine Pictures	123.52	197.04	56.6	**105.81**
Shankesh Jewellers	1.32	5.68	2.42	**2.8**

Source: Exchange

Thursday saw two public issues — Shankesh Jewellers and Sunshine Pictures — close for subscription, with the latter receiving an overwhelming response from all categories of investors, while the Mumbai-based jeweller experienced only a moderate response.

The ₹282-crore initial public offering (IPO) of Sunshine Pictures was subscribed 105.81 times, with the non-institutional (HNI) portion receiving bids 197 times the allotted quota. The portion reserved for qualified institutional buyers (QIBs) was subscribed 123.52 times, while retail investors subscribed 56.60 times. The IPO was launched with a price band of ₹342-360 and consisted of a fresh issue of ₹172.80 crore and an offer-for-sale (OFS) of ₹109.34 crore. The company plans to use the net proceeds from the fresh issue to fund its working capital requirements and for general corporate purposes.

Vipul Shah and his wife, Shefali-promoted Sunshine Pictures, had raised ₹84.64 crore from anchor investors a day before the IPO.

SHANKESH

The issue of Shankesh Jewellers was subscribed 2.80 times, led by non-institutional investors (NIIs) at 5.68 times and retail investors at 2.42 times. However, the Qualified Institutional Buyers (QIB) portion was subscribed just 1.32 times.

The issue that hit the market with a price band of ₹88-93 was a combination of fresh issue (₹274 crore) and an OFS (₹93 crore). The jewellery retailer had raised ₹110.15 crore from anchor investors ahead of the IPO. Proceeds from the fresh issue will be used for repayment or pre-payment of borrowings, funding working capital requirements and general corporate purposes.

Shankesh Jewellers Ltd is a B2B jewellery company engaged in handcrafted gold jewellery and customisation services for clients across India.

BROKER'S CALL.

Arihant Capital

INDIA GLYCOLS (BUY)
Target: ₹1,639
CMP: ₹1,101.65

The NCLT-approved trifurcation into India Glycols (specialty chemicals), IGL Spirits (spirits + biofuels) and Ennature Bio Pharma (nutraceuticals/APIs) is a major catalyst. This restructuring eliminates the conglomerate discount by creating three pure-play entities, each with distinct operational dynamics, enabling sharper management focus. Post-demerger, each business can pursue its own growth trajectory and unlock significant shareholder value.

IGL Spirits is the dominant market leader in UP/Uttarakhand with captive ENA production ensuring cost leadership. IMFL revenue grew 26 per cent year on year to 1.4 million cases. Premiumisation focus includes new launches in deluxe whisky, semi-premium vodka and white spirits, with revenue growth expected to outpace volume growth.

The management aspired to EBITDA of over ₹500 crore in FY27E and more than ₹1,000 crore over four to five years. India Glycols (Chemicals) is the world's largest supplier of bio-based specialty chemicals and pioneer in bio based amines and carbon-smart glycols. It has strong partnerships with Dove, L'Oréal, Unilever. In Ennature Bio Pharma, the nicotine business grew 2x quarter-on-quarter with new capacity at Kashipur. The management is targeting ₹130-150 crore EBITDA in four-five years.

We estimate revenue/EBITDA/PAT CAGR of 12 per cent/15.4 per cent/29 per cent over FY26-29E, with EBITDA margin expanding to 16.9 per cent (FY29E). We maintain our "Buy" rating at a TP of ₹1,639 per share, based on SOTP.

GEOJIT INVESTMENTS

TTK Prestige (Buy)

Target: ₹749
CMP: ₹591.45

TTK Prestige's consolidated revenue increased 33.6 per cent to ₹814 crore in Q1FY27, led by a strong domestic recovery. Domestic sales grew 35.6 per cent, supported by robust demand across induction cook-tops and other kitchen appliance categories. Meanwhile, export revenue declined 17.9 per cent to ₹12.8 crore due to shipping and logistics disruptions. The repositioned 'Judge' brand continued to gain traction, with revenue rising 89.9 per cent to ₹34.6 crore. Demand outlook remains robust, driven by premiumisation, replacement-driven purchases and improving discretionary spending, aided by GST cuts and lower interest rates. The upcoming festive season is expected to boost channel inventory across categories, although growth is likely to normalise over time. TTK's ongoing ₹200-crore investment programme to improve operational efficiency and strengthen long-term growth may weigh on near-term profitability. Commodity inflation is likely to be offset through efficient sourcing, timely pricing and premiumisation. Backed by healthy cash generation, TTK is well-positioned to self-fund investments across capacity, distribution, talent and product development, while targeting about 1,000 Xclusive stores and leveraging the Judge brand to deepen its mass-market presence. We roll forward to FY28 EPS, value TTK at 33x to arrive at a target price of ₹749, and maintain a Buy rating.

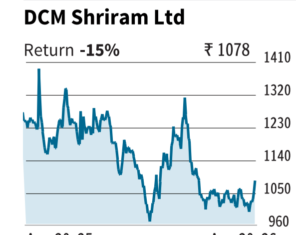
businessline is not responsible for the recommendations sourced from third party brokerages. Reports may be sent to: **blmarketwatch@gmail.com**

TODAY'S PICK.

DCM Shriram (₹1,078): BUY

Akhil Nallamuthu
bl. research bureau

DCM Shriram Ltd



The stock of DCM Shriram has been consolidating since early June.

That is, it has been oscillating between ₹980 and ₹1,065. On the back of the support at ₹980, the scrip started to move up last week and on Thursday, it broke out of the resistance at ₹1,065. This is likely to shift momentum in favour of the bulls and the probability of a rally from here is high. The nearest resistance is at ₹1,150. But we expect the stock to rise past this and touch ₹1,200 in the near-term.

So, traders can buy the stock now at ₹1,078 and buy more shares if the price dips to ₹1,050. Place stop-loss at ₹1,015.

When the stock hits ₹1,150 and ₹1,175, tighten the stop-loss to ₹1,100 and ₹1,145 respectively. Book profits at ₹1,200.

Note: The recommendations are based on technical analysis. There is a risk of loss in trading

Day trading guide

24291 » Nifty 50 Futures

S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT
24250	24100	24350	24500	Likely to fall off a resistance; go short with stop-loss 24400.

₹726 » HDFC Bank

S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT
722	715	730	756	Intraday trend is unclear; refrain from taking fresh trades.

₹1130 » Infosys

S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT
1112	1075	1145	1175	The stock is likely to decline; go short with stop-loss at 1150.

₹271 » ITC

S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT
265	260	273	275	Go short if the price rises to 273; place stop-loss at 276.

₹238 » ONGC

S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT
235	232	242	245	The stock is in consolidation phase; no trades suggested.

₹1315 » Reliance Ind.

S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT
1300	1275	1320	1335	The stock shows upward bias; go long with stop-loss at 1290.

₹1047 » SBI

S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT
1045	1020	1055	1065	Buy the stock if it breaks out 1055; place stop-loss at 1045.

₹2292 » TCS

S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT
2260	2200	2320	2370	The price is likely to fall; initiate short with stop-loss at 2320.

S1, S2: Support 1 & 2; R1, R2: Resistance 1 & 2.

Nifty 50 Movers ▲ 153.55 pts.

	Close(₹)	Pts	PE	Wt(%)
HDFC Bank	725.05	16.90	13.53	10.01
ICICI Bank	1411.90	15.50	16.95	9.12
Bharti Airtel	1941.70	13.09	32.49	5.32
Eternal Ltd.	327.95	12.56	730.91	2.14
Kotak Bank	397.35	11.42	19.47	2.64
L&T	4081.00	10.15	28.61	4.31
Axis Bank	1251.00	10.04	13.93	3.24
ITC	271.65	9.69	16.86	2.36
Bajaj Finance	1095.00	8.67	33.02	2.65
Infosys	1130.00	7.82	15.12	3.57
Shriram Finance Ltd.	1128.20	6.79	23.45	1.42
Bajaj Auto	11793.00	3.58	28.53	1.18
Maruti Suzuki	13809.00	3.39	30.29	1.62
Reliance Ind	1313.20	3.25	20.16	8.00
UltraTech Cement	11575.00	3.23	39.80	1.24
JSW Steel	1299.70	2.85	11.35	1.10
Grasim Ind	3300.00	2.47	19.73	1.12
Adani Ports	1696.00	2.27	29.78	1.13
TCS	2298.00	2.01	16.61	2.12
Cipla	1438.00	1.97	34.62	0.73
M&M	3424.80	1.91	21.04	2.76
Eicher Motors	8042.00	1.55	38.24	1.00
Hind Unilever	2028.00	1.42	45.41	1.62
HDFC Life	542.00	1.34	59.22	0.53
Dr Reddys Lab	1180.00	1.33	30.94	0.65
Coal India	402.50	1.31	7.95	0.87
PowerGrid Corp	264.80	1.29	15.49	1.08
Trent Ltd.	2970.00	1.24	87.27	0.89
Jio Financial Services Ltd.	244.60	1.04	78.16	0.72
NTPC	337.50	0.98	11.55	1.44
Sun Pharma	1904.00	0.93	37.70	1.82
Wipro	181.00	0.86	13.49	0.44
Bajaj Finserv	2016.00	0.51	15.64	1.05
ONGC	238.50	0.42	6.70	0.84
Tech Mahindra	1592.10	0.32	30.22	0.91
Adani Enter	2994.90	0.29	51.86	0.78
Bharat Elec	409.40	0.16	48.68	1.32
SBI Life	1782.00	0.16	68.73	0.72
Max Healthcare	997.90	0.15	66.64	0.67
Titan	5068.00	0.00	78.11	1.89
Apollo Hosp	8735.00	-0.34	57.82	0.81
Tata Motors PV	320.25	-0.48	0.00	0.60
State Bank	1048.00	-0.54	10.79	3.91
Asian Paints	2625.20	-0.55	52.06	1.07
Tata Steel	183.50	-0.90	20.34	1.37
NestleIndia	1458.00	-1.10	73.77	0.94
IntGlobeAvi	5165.00	-1.38	0.00	1.05
HCL Tech	1318.40	-1.47	20.52	1.25
TataConsumerProduct	1056.30	-1.66	63.65	0.62
Hindalco	1029.85	-2.88	14.11	1.34

Pts: Impact on index movement

Nifty Next 50 Movers ▲ 293.50 pts.

	Close(₹)	Pts	PE	Wt(%)
Hdfc Amc	2624.00	42.84	38.16	2.10
Muthootfin	2970.00	34.59	10.41	1.25
Britannia Ind	5548.00	32.52	51.20	2.56
Indian Hotels Co. .	735.85	31.90	45.37	2.53
Vedanta	268.00	26.61	6.28	1.78
Cg Power & Ind Sol	876.30	26.40	111.47	2.35
Varun Beverages .	438.30	25.63	43.48	2.35
Macrotech Developers .	1240.00	24.19	30.01	1.35
Hindus Zinc	573.90	23.62	14.21	1.08
Hyundai Motor India .	2227.00	21.75	36.55	1.24
Godrej Consumer	947.00	19.85	50.64	1.49
Tvs Motor Cmp .	4390.00	19.73	57.92	4.04
Cholamandalamin&Fin	1888.90	19.36	28.00	3.20
United Spirits .	1544.00	17.17	66.57	1.79
Dlf	676.15	11.65	37.65	1.70
Bpcl	308.70	10.01	7.82	2.45
Pidilitind	1660.00	9.00	63.13	2.01
Adanigreenenergy	1301.80	8.57	99.92	1.71
Indian Railway Finance Corp	86.47	7.54	15.72	0.68
Abb India	7479.00	7.47	101.91	1.54
Adani Energy Solutions .	1548.50	7.44	60.19	1.99
Bosch	48750.00	7.31	60.84	1.66
Ambuja Cements	411.00	6.34	19.69	1.00
Punjab Natl Bank	118.00	5.20	6.13	1.59
Canara Bank	129.60	5.08	5.93	1.71
Jindal Steel	1118.90	4.20	42.14	1.62
Divis Lab	8570.00	3.69	77.78	4.27
Solar Industries	19760.00	2.76	87.21	1.89
Zyduslifesciences	1107.70	2.33	24.27	1.09
Mazagoan Dock	2570.00	1.37	36.33	0.76
Tata Capital	366.15	0.88	28.37	0.72
Gail (India)	172.50	0.00	11.49	1.82
Adani Power .	204.00	-0.24	27.07	3.32
Bajaj Holdings	11368.00	-1.51	14.07	1.93
Shree Cement	24300.00	-1.55	53.59	1.27
Avenuesuper	3960.00	-2.34	84.48	2.50
Bank Of Baroda	244.50	-2.70	6.87	1.78
Ltimindtree	4553.00	-3.08	25.99	1.66
Torrent Pharma	5005.00	-3.41	88.30	2.88
Tata Motors Cv	477.60	-4.25	42.01	3.91
Indian Oilcorp	135.90	-4.34	5.37	1.99
Siemens	3880.00	-4.86	95.11	1.34
Cummins Inida	5205.00	-5.89	60.95	2.75
Samvardmothersoninternatl	169.58	-9.12	39.29	2.93
Hindustanaeronautics	4998.00	-10.47	35.86	3.71
Siemens Energy India .	3435.30	-12.26	82.22	1.19
Union Bank	184.68	-12.47	6.83	1.40
Tata Power	375.25	-17.69	22.81	2.45
Rural Elec	328.10	-32.31	5.39	1.61
Power Finance	363.80	-45.07	3.57	2.07

Pts: Impact on index movement

QUICKLY.

Aditya Birla Capital enters gold loan market

Mumbai: Aditya Birla Capital Ltd (ABCL) has entered the gold loan business, marking a strategic expansion of its portfolio. The company plans a phase-wise rollout of 200-300 gold loan branches by March 2027. Over the next three years, the business aims to establish a network of around 1,000 gold loan branches. Rakesh Singh, Executive Director and CEO, ABCL, said, "Gold loans are witnessing strong structural growth, and our entry into this segment is an extension of our secured lending strategy." OUR BUREAU

DPIIT inks MoU with PhonePe, Shell India

New Delhi: The Department for Promotion of Industry and Internal Trade (DPIIT) on Thursday said it has inked pacts with PhonePe and Shell India to support start-ups. They are aimed at enhancing access to technology, digital infrastructure, mentorship, market opportunities, and industry networks, it said. PTI

'7.5% growth a given, India should aspire for more'

GROWTH MOMENTUM. RBI Deputy Guv highlights resilience despite global turmoil

Sindhu Hariharan
Chennai

> My sense is that the current account deficit minus a shock like an oil-price shock will continue to decline further
>
> **POONAM GUPTA**
> Deputy Governor, RBI

Even as India navigates oil-price shocks, geopolitical risks and potential weather disruptions, the economy is estimated to grow over 7 per cent and it speaks about the resilience of the economy, RBI Deputy Governor Poonam Gupta said here.

"While we have projected growth to be 6.7 per cent this year, but it's quite likely the numbers may turn out to be better based on the high frequency indicators and based on the analysis of others," she said. "But going forward, notwithstanding this shock-ridden year, growth in recent years, I would say 7.5 per cent is a given and we should aspire to do better than that," she added.

She was delivering a lecture at the Madras School of Economics in Chennai, on "Indian Economy: Shocks, Resilience and the Way Forward."

The central premise of her address was that India's resilience is not accidental and comes from strong policy frameworks, fiscal prudence, a more resilient banking system, healthy external buffers and a diversified economy.

RISE IN FDI

Making "a personal assessment" of the current account situation, the RBI Deputy Governor said that barring any global shocks such as a major oil-price shock, India could potentially become a current-account-neutral economy within 5-6 years. "My sense is that the current account deficit minus a shock like an oil-price shock will continue to decline further," she said.

Similarly, on FDI, she said India received around $95 billion last year, and it is possible that the inflows could reach $150 billion annually in the coming years if current trends continue.

The Deputy Governor highlighted some studies to note that India's growth has averaged 4.8 percentage points higher than advanced economies and 2.5 percentage points higher than emerging-market economies in recent years. Services remain the strongest-performing sector, while agriculture and industry have also become steadier, she said.

As per Gupta, RBI's ongoing work also suggests India's growth is increasingly being supported by improvements in labour and capital quality and total factor productivity, rather than simply by putting more inputs into the economy.

INFLATION RATE

"Comparing with other countries, you know India's inflation rate in the past few years has been close to the average of advanced economies and much less than that the average inflation rate experienced in emerging and developing economies," Gupta said on India's inflation trajectory.

"Financial sector is not just resilient, it's becoming much more efficient," she said.

The Deputy Governor also cited a diversified economy as a key driver. "For oil, we diversified our pool of importers. When we had a tariff from the US, we could diversify our pool where the countries we export to," she said. She also stressed how every state in India was today growing faster than before.

UPI adoption surges in capital markets, led by brokers, rising retail participation

Our Bureau
Mumbai

Robust growth

	Number of transactions	Total amount (₹ crore)
Funds received by		
Brokers	21,31,83,570	2,95,778
IPOs	1,06,71,910	20,458
Mutual Funds	70,36,111	8,475
Funds received by		
Research Analysts	2,52,653	107
Investment Advisors	56,725	19

Source: NPCI

The use of the Unified Payments Interface (UPI) for market participation seems robust, going by data collated by SEBI for the first time.

The markets regulator, in its latest annual report, said the banking sector's UPI infrastructure is vital for market participation.

As per transaction trends from October 2025 till March 2026, brokers facilitated the highest volume of activity with over 21.3 crore transactions, totalling ₹2.95 lakh crore, followed by IPOs (processed about 1.07 crore transactions, amounting to ₹20,458 crore), and mutual funds (recording over 70.36 lakh transactions, totalling ₹8,475 crore).

Further, research analysts received ₹107 crore in fees through 2.53 lakh transactions and investment advisors collected ₹19 crore in fees *via* 56,725 transactions.

The aforementioned data on funds and fees received by retail investor-facing intermediaries through verified IDs over a six-month period comes in the wake of the rollout of the validated UPI framework in October 2025.

The UPI transaction activity in the markets should be seen in the context of SEBI implementing structural changes during FY26 to enhance safety and transparency.

RAPIDLY EVOLVING

Anu Aggarwal, Head Corporate & Transaction Banking, Kotak Mahindra Bank, observed that UPI is rapidly evolving into critical investment infrastructure for India, driven by customers' preference for convenience, speed and control.

Mutual funds account for only 0.6 per cent of P2M (person to merchant) UPI transaction volumes, but contribute 8 per cent in value terms, reflecting the higher value of these transactions.

"At our bank, we have built specialised UPI capabilities for SIPs, lump-sum investments and auto-pay mandates, supported by reporting and transaction visibility. With 60-70 per cent of retail IPO applications now made through UPI ASBA (application supported by blocked amount), our scalable infrastructure can handle up to 5,000 transactions per second during large IPOs.

BEYOND MFS

Rohan Mandora, Director, Equirus Securities, said UPI is becoming a structural enabler of capital-market participation, extending beyond IPO and mutual fund payments to routine broker funding.

During October 2025 to March 2026, validated UPI handles processed 23.1 crore transactions worth ₹3,24,800 crore across brokers, IPOs, mutual funds and investment services with brokers contributing 92 per cent of volumes.

Kronox Lab Sciences promoters to sell 64% stake to Indo Borax

Our Bureau
Ahmedabad

A Gujarat speciality chemicals company that listed on the stock exchanges in 2024 is changing hands two years later, with its founding promoters giving up control to an industrial chemicals company while retaining a 9.95 per cent stake.

Mumbai-based Indo Borax & Chemicals Ltd will acquire 64.26 per cent of Vadodara-based Kronox Lab Sciences Ltd from its promoters for ₹246 crore and plans to make an open offer for another 25.79 per cent from public shareholders, according to Kronox's regulatory filing on Thursday.

The transaction will see Indo Borax become Kronox's new promoter and marks a change in management and control of the company.

The three existing promoters — Ketan Vinodchandra Ramani, Pritesh Vinodchandra Ramani and Jogindersingh Giarchand Jaswal — will sell 2.38 crore shares at ₹103.22 apiece under the agreement.

The sellers currently collectively hold 74.21 per cent of Kronox and will retain an aggregate 9.95 per cent stake after the transaction.

Their remaining shares will be subject to a lock-in for a specified period, after which any proposed sale will be subject to Indo Borax's right of first refusal.

BOARDROOM CHANGE

The acquisition will trigger a mandatory open offer for Kronox's public shareholders. Indo Borax, together with Zenrock Chemicals Private Ltd as a person acting in concert, will make an offer to acquire up to 95.7 lakh shares, representing 25.79 per cent of Kronox's equity, under the takeover regulations. The open offer, if fully subscribed, could further increase the combined holding of Indo Borax and Zenrock.

The transaction also brings a change in the boardroom. Indo Borax will appoint three nominee directors to Kronox's board, while the existing promoters will resign as directors following completion of the transaction.

The founders, however, will continue to have a role during the transition. The regulatory filing said the sellers will enter into consultancy agreements with Kronox following completion of the transaction to provide transition support.

'India's forex market will be ready when it is deep enough to absorb global shocks'

Our Bureau
Mumbai

Rohit Jain, Deputy Governor, RBI

India's foreign exchange market will be ready for the next decade when it is deep enough to absorb global shocks, flexible enough to support new forms of trade and investment and disciplined enough to preserve orderly conditions, said Rohit Jain, Deputy Governor, RBI.

Further, the market has to be fair enough to serve the smallest user with the same humility as the largest corporate client.

"We have made considerable progress in the first three but have some distance to travel in respect of the fourth. I am sure, collectively, we will reach our goal," Jain said in his keynote address on the Annual Day of the Foreign Exchange Dealers' Association of India (FEDAI) on August 14.

The Deputy Governor emphasised that the next phase of reform will not be judged by the number of permissions removed or products introduced but by the quality, speed, transparency and accessibility of the foreign exchange services that the citizens receive.

SRVA FRAMEWORK

Jain said local currencies will play an ever increasing role in cross-border trade and payments.

"The Special Rupee Vostro Account (SRVA) framework for invoicing, payment and settlement of international trade in rupees has been implemented keeping in view the evolving dynamics of our international trade," he said.

He underscored that SRVA's success will depend on commercial viability, emphasis on trade settlement in local currencies, offering market-determined rates, and strengthening confidence in the settlement ecosystem.

"Opening a SRVA account is the easy part. The harder task is identifying corridors with genuine two-way flows, building reliable correspondent relationships, quoting competitive conversion and hedging solutions, explaining the product to first-time users, and finding avenues for the productive deployment of rupee balances — all resting on robust internal processes, AML/CFT controls, operational resilience and, above all, a willingness to facilitate these transactions. I would encourage you not to see it only as a way of reducing reliance on international currencies," he said.

Jain emphasised that the settlement of cross-border transactions in local currencies results in lower transaction costs, fewer currency mismatches, better settlement efficiency, and the ability to trade where correspondent banking is costly or constrained.

"Policy can create the option. It is the authorised dealers who will determine whether this happens. I am confident that our banks can, and will rise to the occasion," he said.

CHALLENGES TODAY

Jain noted that participation in the forex market remains skewed. Public sector banks, which hold deep relationships with MSMEs and smaller corporates outside the metros, under-participate in forex derivatives relative to their balance sheet size.

At the same time, the client segment is dominated by large corporates while the smaller clients who stand to gain most from currency risk hedging remain on the sidelines.

Jain observed that in late March and early April this year, a build-up of unhealthy arbitrage positions linking the onshore deliverable and offshore NDF (non-deliverable forward) markets prompted calibrated measures on net open positions, non-deliverable derivative offerings to customers and related-party transactions.

"Some of these measures have since been reversed. As the market integrates further with global liquidity, the lesson is not to fear integration but to further strengthen risk management, governance and oversight arrangements," he said.

IRDAI bars Niva Bupa, Acko General from adding branches

Our Bureau
Hyderabad

The Insurance Regulatory and Development Authority of India (IRDAI) has barred Niva Bupa Health Insurance Company from opening any new place of business for six months from August 19, 2026.

The regulator has also warned the insurer on non-compliance with applicable expense of management (EoM) limits for financial year 2024-25 and directed it not to add any new branches.

The order follows an explanation sought by IRDAI from the company regarding its EoM limits for FY25, to which the company had made submissions. In another order, the insurance regulator had also barred Acko General Insurance from opening new places of business for six months.

Prudential HCL Health Insurance begins India ops

Our Bureau
Hyderabad

Prudential HCL Health Insurance (Prudential Health India), a standalone health insurance company backed by Prudential plc and the HCL Group, commenced its business operations in India.

The company was granted its certificate of registration in July, enabling it to initiate its health insurance business in India.

The company enters India's growing health insurance market, which is estimated at approximately $16 billion in gross written premiums in FY26.

STRATEGIC MARKET

"India is a strategically important market for Prudential, with strong macroeconomic fundamentals, rising demand for healthcare, and significant headroom for innovation in customer experience," Naveen Tahilyani, Regional CEO, Indonesia, Malaysia, the Philippines, India, Africa; Group Agency and Health, Prudential plc, said on Thursday. "We aim to make healthcare more accessible and help more Indian families navigate their healthcare journey with confidence," he added.

As part of its launch strategy, Prudential Health India offers customers access to a network of more than 12,000 hospitals.

CHENNAI
businessline.
FRIDAY - AUGUST 21 - 2026

QUICKLY.

Fleetx.ai buys Pando.ai for undisclosed sum

Chennai: Fleetx.ai, a AI-native fleet and logistics technology company, has announced the acquisition of Pando.ai, a transportation management system provider, for an undisclosed amount. Through this, customers gain access to a unified, AI-native platform spanning the entire journey from fleet visibility to freight execution, with AI agents working across the stack to replace the disconnected systems that have long defined physical operations, said a release. OUR BUREAU

Elgi Equipments to invest ₹1.61 crore in RE venture

Chennai: Elgi Equipments Ltd entered a share subscription and shareholders' agreement and power purchase agreement with Constronics Energy Solution Private Ltd to acquire 18.01 per cent of share capital for ₹1.61 crore. The proposed investment envisages procurement of renewable energy (RE) for the company's consumption over a tenure of 25 years. OUR BUREAU

Southern States main pillars of India's growth, says Amit Shah

CONSTRUCTIVE SOLUTIONS. Home Minister calls for resolution of pending water disputes through dialogue

Our Bureau
Chennai

The southern States are the main pillars of India's development, Union Home Minister Amit Shah said, calling for early resolution of pending water-related issues concerning the States through joint meetings involving the Ministries of Jal Shakti, Home Affairs, the Inter-State Council, and the respective States.

Shah was chairing the 31st meeting of the Southern Zonal Council at Mamallapuram near Chennai, which was attended by the Chief Ministers of Tamil Nadu, Andhra Pradesh, Karnataka and Keralam, the Deputy Chief Minister of Telangana, Puducherry Lieutenant Governor, Andaman and Nicobar Islands Lieutenant Governor, and others.

Union Home Minister Amit Shah with TN CM C Joseph Vijay at the meeting of the Southern Zonal Council PTI

"Protecting the interests of one's State is not wrong; however, if the process of protecting interests results in States being deprived of water for years while it simply flows into the sea, then no actual interest is being served," Shah said, as per an MHA statement.

LINKING RIVERS

He suggested that linking major rivers, from the Brahmaputra to the Kaveri and Godavari, could ensure that India faces no water shortage for the next 100 years.

The Southern States agreed with the Home Minister's suggestion to resolve pending water disputes expeditiously through mutual dialogue and constructive solutions, the MHA said.

Shah also called for cooperation in the matter of eradicating drugs, another key issue put forward by the States. The MHA has prepared a three-year roadmap for a drug-free India and that is not possible without the involvement of all States, Shah said.

Hosted by Tamil Nadu, the event saw CMs stress on the need for greater cooperation between themselves. They also flagged the strong contribution of the States to India's development and used the platform to lay down long-pending inter-State issues that needed resolution and areas where better joint action could yield better results.

LOGISTICS CLUSTERS

TN CM C Joseph Vijay proposed common economic and logistics clusters across the southern States, comprising manufacturing zones, shared multimodal logistics parks and corridors that link each of their production centres to global markets.

Karnataka CM DK Shivakumar said he had given a commitment that the interests of Tamil Nadu and Puducherry will be protected in the proposed Mekedatu dam issue.

Telangana Deputy CM Mallu Bhatti Vikramarka identified water security, energy and economic competitiveness as areas that will increasingly transcend State boundaries, and needed cooperation. "If southern India grows together, India grows faster," he said.

Keralam CM VD Satheesan pushed for greater fiscal fairness, stronger Centre-State relations, and coordinated action on issues such as drugs, organised crime and illegal migration.

Andhra Pradesh CM Chandrababu Naidu put forward a roadmap to build a $10 trillion southern economy by 2047. This includes proposals such as a high-speed bullet train corridor *via* Kuppam joining Andhra Pradesh, Karnataka and Tamil Nadu, shared logistics networks, and a mutual-aid force for disasters.

Telangana offered to host the next Southern Zonal Council in Hyderabad.

DGFT eases rupee trade regulations for exporters

Our Bureau
New Delhi

The Directorate General of Foreign Trade (DGFT) has eased rules governing rupee-based export transactions, allowing Indian exporters greater flexibility to invoice overseas sales and receive payments in rupees or foreign currencies, while giving eligible rupee receipts the same treatment as foreign currency earnings for trade policy benefits.

"The Foreign Trade Policy (FTP) 2023 has been amended to align the provisions relating to denomination of export contracts and eligibility for FTP benefits in respect of export realisations in rupees with the Foreign Exchange Management (manner of receipt and payment) Regulations, 2023," according the DGFT notification issued on Thursday.

Under the revised framework, exports to countries outside the Asian Clearing Union (ACU) can be invoiced in rupees or any foreign currency, with payments also permitted in either currency. More importantly, rupee payments received through approved banking channels for exports to countries other than Nepal and Bhutan will qualify for FTP benefits and count towards fulfilment of export obligations.

BANKING CHANNEL

"Earlier, exporters receiving rupee payments through an RBI-approved banking channel were not always certain whether such receipts would qualify for FTP benefits or count towards their export obligations. The new rules remove this uncertainty by placing eligible rupee receipts on par with foreign-currency earnings," according to an analysis by research body GTRI.

The notification also permits exports financed through EXIM Bank or government of India lines of credit to be invoiced in rupees. There are separate rules for the ACU, which includes Bangladesh, Bhutan, India, Iran, Maldives, Myanmar, Nepal, Pakistan and Sri Lanka.

For exports to Bangladesh, Iran, Maldives, Myanmar, Pakistan and Sri Lanka, contracts must use a currency determined by the ACU. However, invoicing and settlement may also follow directions issued by the Reserve Bank of India.

Nepal and Bhutan are treated separately. Export contracts with these two countries must generally be denominated and settled in rupees or according to RBI directions.

IRAN COVERED

Iran is covered by the ACU rules, but trade in sensitive goods and technologies must continue to comply with provisions covering specified items linked to nuclear activities.

GTRI noted that earlier exporters receiving rupee payments through an RBI-approved banking channel were not always certain whether such receipts would qualify for FTP benefits or count towards their export obligations. The new rules remove this uncertainty by placing eligible rupee receipts on par with foreign-currency earnings.

However, the report cautioned the move does not resolve the commercial difficulties surrounding rupee trade. "Foreign buyers struggle to obtain rupees, while overseas banks may hesitate to hold large rupee balances because the currency is not fully convertible. Exchange-rate risks, expensive hedging, complex banking procedures and the continued global preference for the US dollar may further limit acceptance of rupee settlement," it stated.

Home care start-ups take on FMCG giants as consumer priorities shift

Jyoti Banthia
Bengaluru

A new crop of home care start-ups is challenging established FMCG players by betting that Indian consumers are increasingly looking beyond basic cleaning performance towards safer ingredients, specialised products and greater transparency.

Brands such as Beco, Cleevo, Scrubsy and others are expanding across categories including dishwash, laundry, kitchen and surface care, while investors are beginning to see the segment as a larger consumer opportunity.

For Cleevo Founder Mayank Jain, the opportunity lies

in making cleaner products accessible without asking consumers to pay a premium.

"If you can get cleaner products at a price point where people are already paying, then the market is yours. I mean, there is enough market for you to play around," Jain said.

Cleevo has expanded into floor, kitchen, bathroom and laundry care, with floor and kitchen cleaners currently its largest categories.

Jain said the company grew tenfold between the last and current financial years and is targeting another 7-10x growth as it expands manufacturing capacity and its portfolio.

NEW OPPORTUNITY

Koparo Founder Simran Khara said the opportunity is being driven by the same shift seen earlier in food and personal care, where consumers began looking more closely at what they use.

But new brands cannot afford to compromise on the core function of cleaning, she said. "We are a dusty country, we're a greasy country. So any kind of stain removal, dirt removal, grease removal is a must-have."

NEARLY PROFITABLE

Koparo currently has about ₹115 crore in ARR and expects to close the financial year at ₹150 crore. The company is nearly profitable, while dishwash, floor cleaner and detergent are its strongest products.

Quick commerce accounts for about 35 per cent of sales, roughly on par with e-commerce.

Beco Co-founder Aditya Ruia said consumer behaviour is changing from simply asking whether a product works to questioning what goes into it.

"What's driving adoption is a consumer shift from 'this works' to 'what's actually in this'. Especially with urban millennials and young parents who are reading ingredient labels for cleaning products," Ruia said.

He expects clean home care to move from a *niche*, premium segment to a mainstream expectation over the next three to five years, driven by category expansion, wider offline distribution and price parity with legacy brands as manufacturing scales.

MORE ATTRACTIVE

For investors, the category is becoming more attractive as brands demonstrate repeat purchases and growth, while digital channels have reduced the distribution advantage historically enjoyed by incumbents.

Arjun Vaidya, Co-founder of V3 Ventures, which led Scrubsy's ₹27 crore seed round, said the opportunity lies in the shift towards specialised and branded products.

"The opportunity is the shift from unbranded and commoditised to specialised and branded, which is compounding many times faster than the category itself," Vaidya said.

Quick commerce, he added, has further changed the equation by allowing new brands to reach consumers nationally much faster than traditional distribution would have allowed.

DSM Fresh Foods eyes threefold revenue growth by FY28

Amit Vijay Mohile
Mumbai

DSM Fresh Foods Ltd, the BSE SME-listed company popularly known by its fresh-meat brand Zappfresh, is targeting ₹600 crore in revenue by FY28, nearly three times its FY26 turnover of ₹220.8 crore, as it expands its retail network.

The target builds on a year of rapid growth and improving profitability.

Revenue rose 69 per cent in FY26, while EBITDA climbed 91 per cent to ₹31.1 crore and net profit increased 59 per cent to ₹14.3 crore, giving DSM a profitable base from which to pursue its next phase of expansion.

"We are targeting ₹600 crore by FY28," Deepanshu Manchanda, Founder and Managing Director, DSM Fresh Foods, told *businessline*. Zappfresh plans to expand its physical retail network to 200 stores by the end of the year and is expected to reach about ₹70-80 crore this year.

WIDER RETAIL PLAY

The physical expansion is designed to take Zappfresh deeper into the mass market without building a capital-heavy company-owned store network.

Its partner-store model involves local entrepreneurs operating outlets under Zappfresh's branding and supply systems.

The wider reach is being accompanied by an expansion of its food basket. In the domestic market, the company is looking at products such as spices, *roomali roti* and *parathas* through local meat shops, while continu-

Zappfresh plans to expand its physical retail network to 200 stores by the end of the year

ing selective institutional relationships. It supplies *parathas* to Domino's for use in tacos, Manchanda said.

Chicken remains Zappfresh's largest category, accounting for about 50 per cent of the business, followed by fish and mutton.

Zappfresh is also staying away from building its proposition around 10-minute delivery.

"We are not looking at glamourising the category. Our core job is to build a very robust supply chain to cater to different customers and also deliver profits," Manchanda said. "We have a two-hour slot so the teams have enough time for sorting, grading, collection and managing inventory," he added.

OVERSEAS PUSH

International markets provide another avenue for scale. DSM is targeting the UK, Europe, the US and Canada, while a recently signed MoU with a Dubai distributor will expand its footprint into the UAE and Saudi Arabia.

The company is tailoring its frozen-food portfolio to individual markets rather than exporting a standardised range. Offerings include *baingan bharta* for the US and momos, spring rolls and *samosas* for Canada. Products are frozen rather than retort-packed, which Manchanda said helps preserve a more natural taste profile.

Its broader product philosophy centres on clean-label, protein-rich foods without chemicals and preservatives, a segment Manchanda believes has significant headroom as health and nutrition awareness rises.

MASS-MARKET

Despite the growth of premium D2C food brands, DSM is prioritising mass-market penetration and value rather than limiting itself to a niche digital consumer base.

The company expects margins to remain broadly consistent with last year despite raw-material pressures. Execution on its 200-store expansion, domestic frozen-food business and ₹70-80 crore overseas push will be key to closing the gap between its ₹220.8-crore FY26 base and the ₹600-crore FY28 target.

Zulu Defence bets on integrated drone systems, scales up for global demand

Aishwarya Kumar
Bengaluru

Bengaluru-based defence drone start-up Zulu Defence is preparing for a sharp increase in production as it looks to expand beyond the domestic market, with the company planning to scale monthly output from about 300 drones currently to 550-600 units.

Nagendran Kandasamy, Co-founder and CEO, said the company is planning to move from its existing 15,000 sq ft facility to a 45,000-50,000 sq ft unit to support the expansion. The company will also increase its assembly lines from three to six. "We are currently producing around 300 drones a month and operating at about 70-80 per cent of our capacity. The next facility

Nagendran Kandasamy, Co-founder and CEO

will give us the headroom to take this to 550-600 units a month," Nagendran said.

The company develops kamikaze, interceptor, surveillance and transporter drones, with its key differentiator being the proprietary software that allows different drone platforms to operate as part of a common ecosystem.

Zulu is working with the Indian Army and Indian Navy and has also begun receiving trial orders from European markets.

LOCALISATION HOPES

The company's push overseas comes as defence drone start-ups continue to face challenges in India, particularly long procurement cycles and complex government acquisition processes.

Zulu currently has around 70 per cent local content, while the remaining 30 per cent is sourced globally. Nagendran said the company is targeting incremental localisation, but critical components such as advanced chips, rare-earth magnets and lithium remain dependent on global supply chains.

The firm is initiating its next funding round, which Nagendran expects to close within three to four months.

Dubai Chambers signs two MoUs to enhance trade ties with India

Our Bureau
Bengaluru

Dubai Chambers, a non-profit public entity that supports Dubai's vision as a global player by empowering businesses, delivering innovative value-added services, and unlocking access to influential networks, has signed two memorandums of understanding (MoUs) during a high-level visit to Bengaluru to advance collaboration in agentic AI, strengthen trade and investment between Dubai and India, and support business expansion.

The agreements were signed with the National Association of Software and Service Companies (NASSCOM) and the Federation of Karnataka Chambers of Commerce and Industry (FKCCI).

As part of the visit, a delegation headed by Mohammad Ali Rashed Lootah, President and CEO of Dubai Chambers, held eight meetings with leading Indian business organisations and multinational companies.

The programme included engagements with Nasscom Deeptech, the Confederation of Indian Industry Karnataka State Council (CII Karnataka), FKCCI, and the Federation of Indian Chambers of Commerce and Industry Karnataka State Council .

AI DRIVE

The MoU with NASSCOM establishes a framework for cooperation in agentic AI and deeptech. It aims to support market access for Indian companies seeking to establish and expand in Dubai. The agreement also promotes knowledge sharing, ecosystem engagement, innovation initiatives, and strategic industry collaboration. It includes AI-focused meetings, networking events, and other engagements designed to connect companies and stakeholders in India and Dubai.

The MoU supports Dubai's wider drive to accelerate the adoption of agentic AI across the private sector and strengthen the emirate's position as a leading global centre for advanced technologies.

Investors betting big on India's health supplements sector

Rohan Das
Chennai

As more Indians prioritise preventive wellness, investors are increasingly taking note of the opportunity in India's nutraceuticals and supplements sector.

According to data from market intelligence firm Traxcn, equity funding for nutraceuticals/supplements companies stood at $72 million for 2026 (YTD), on a steady incline from the $59 million in 2020.

Despite the modest increase in the absolute value, the number of deals have gone down from 30 to 11 rounds in the same period, indicating that companies are now able to secure larger checks as they demonstrate scalability.

Multiple supplement start-ups, such as OZiva, Cosmix, ZeroHarm Sciences and Earthful have secured investments in 2026 both from both private equity firms and strategic investors such as FMCG giants Marico and HUL.

Speaking to *businessline*, analysts and investors suggested that the wider shift in India towards prevention and everyday wellness has sustained investor interest in the sector while better scale and profitability metrics have also led to an uptick in ticket sizes.

Mohit Chopra, Deals Leader, PwC India suggested that, in recent years, there had been an evolution in the way the D2C supplement space is assessed. "In the earlier phase rapid revenue growth, digital traction and customer acquisition were

important proof points. As the category matured, investors are now looking more closely at sustainable profitability," he said.

He added that they are also increasingly prioritising an additional layer around the strength of the evidence supporting the product positioning and regulatory compliance.

Ankur Khaitan, Principal, Fireside Ventures suggests that beyond just new players, the industry is now also seeing a range of categories emerging, such as gut health, sleep, menopause, healthy ageing and weight management. Khaitan said the business model has evolved from simply selling supplements to programme-based approaches, which is helping brands differentiate themselves.

STRONG PRODUCT

As for how companies in the space are assessed, he said that a strong product alongside favourable unit economics remains key.

"Retention is particularly important in consumer health because if consumers keep coming back, it is often the first indication that the product is actually working for them," he added.

Despite the slew of domestic players, foreign brands as well as the import dependency for some active ingredients like vitamins are expected to be a challenge for the industry going forward.

Chopra believes that the strongest defence for Indian companies will be to build consumer insight such that they can develop products suited to Indian consumer needs and price points.

He also said a key to competing with global brands would be to build credible claims, as well as to maintain consistent testing standards. "Over time, companies that combine locally-relevant brands and innovation with globally-comparable standards of product quality and science should be better placed to compete with international players," he said.

QUICKLY.

BNP leader Alamgir is Bangladesh President

Dhaka: Bangladeshi lawmakers elected veteran Bangladesh Nationalist Party (BNP) leader Mirza Fakhrul Islam Alamgir as the country's president on Thursday, making the long time opposition figure the head of state after his party came to power in February after the fall of Sheikh Hasina's Awami League government in 2024. While the presidency is largely ceremonial, Alamgir will serve as head of state and commander-in-chief of the armed forces. He defeated Oli Ahmed, a retired army colonel and chairman of the Liberal Democratic Party and candidate of the Jamaat-e-Islami-led 11-party opposition alliance, in a parliamentary vote. REUTERS

China jails Evergrande founder Hui Ka Yan for life

China Evergrande Group's founder Hui Ka Yan has been sentenced to life in prison, bringing an end to one of the most dramatic rise and fall stories in China's corporate history. The property tycoon was once Asia's second richest man, had turned Evergrande into a poster child of corporate excess during China's long real estate boom. But after his empire crashed following a 2021 default, he was caught in a dragnet of official investigations that ultimately caused his downfall. Hui, was sentenced alongside 56 others involved in Evergrande. His assets will be confiscated, and his companies were fined a combined 15.82 billion yuan ($2.4 billion). BLOOMBERG

Trump warns countries helping Iran of economic consequences

FAILED CEASEFIRE. US and Iran have twice announced ceasefire deals but both quickly crumbled

Reuters
Washington/Dubai

US President Donald Trump warned of economic consequences for any country that provided "any type of lifeline to Iran" as the United States looks to resolve a war it began alongside Israel nearly six months ago.

Thousands have been killed in the war, which quickly drew in Gulf nations and shocked global markets as Iran flexed its ability to curb shipping through the Strait of Hormuz, which carried about a fifth of the world's traded oil before February.

The US and Iran have twice announced ceasefire deals, in April and June, aiming to restore the free flow of shipping through Hormuz on a path towards ending the conflict, but both quickly crumbled, even as Israel has largely withdrawn from the fighting.

TRUMP'S MESSAGE

In a social media message on Wednesday, Trump promised "Economic Warfare and Isolation on an unprecedented scale," although details were scant.

"Any country that allows its financial institutions, businesses, airports, or government entities to provide any type of lifeline to Iran will itself face tremendous economic consequences," Trump wrote.

Iranian Foreign Minister Abbas Araqchi called Trump's comments an attempt to divert American public opinion from domestic economic problems, including record debt and rising interest rates.

> Any country that allows its financial institutions, businesses, airports or government entities to provide any type of lifeline to Iran will itself face tremendous economic consequences
>
> DONALD TRUMP
> US President

He said Washington's insistence on policies he described as failed would bring further failures and alienate Iranians.

"America's economic terrorism threatens the global economy and the national sovereignty of countries around the world," he said on X.

Trump has yet to achieve the objectives he set out at the start of the war: dismantling Iran's nuclear programme, curbing its ability to attack regional rivals and creating conditions for Iranians to overthrow their clerical rulers.

Iran has separately been negotiating an agreement on managing the Strait of Hormuz with Oman. Trump responded on Monday to those negotiations with a threat, warning he might bomb the Gulf state, a long standing US security partner, if it "gets in the way".

Omani Foreign Minister Badr Albusaidi, speaking after meeting his Japanese counterpart, said on Thursday lasting security in the strait required permanent peace in the region and rejected further escalation.

On Tuesday, the United Arab Emirates, which hosts a major US military base, said it was suspending all trade activities, commercial exchanges and financial transactions with Iran until further notice.

Bitcoin tops $70,000 as US bond yields sink

Bloomberg

Bitcoin surpassed $70,000 for the first time in over two months, propelled by US Treasury Secretary Scott Bessent's successful move to push US bond yields lower and a high-stakes meeting President Donald Trump held with crypto industry leaders.

Bitcoin rose about 4.5 per cent to over $72,000, its highest level since May 31. A token associated with offshore exchange Hyperliquid climbed 23 per cent in 24 hours, according to CoinGecko data, after Trump indicated the US is looking at options for allowing the derivatives platform to operate in the country.

The crypto market rose along with risk assets following US plans to buy back longer-dated treasuries, which initially sent yields tumbling and the dollar to a three-month low. "When yields drop and the dollar weakens, risk assets tend to rally and we've already seen Bitcoin move higher on the news," said Jeff Mei, Chief Operating Officer at BTSE.

MARKET CATALYST

Rajiv Sawhney, Head of International Portfolio Management at Wave Digital Assets, said yield-curve control "was the second-biggest market catalyst on our bucket list that could potentially supercharge a durable Bitcoin rally." The biggest catalyst would be a government mandate to buy Bitcoin for a national reserve, he said.

Thursday's move builds on Bitcoin's 7 per cent surge on Wednesday that wiped out $1 billion in short positions on the token within in an hour. In the past 24 hours, more than $3 billion in cryptocurrency short positions have been liquidated, according to CoinGlass data.

Other digital assets were also up Ether, rose as much as 5.3 per cent, while Solana climbed about 5 per cent and XRP was up by more than 8 per cent.

Positive sentiment returned to the crypto market after Trump met with crypto executives from firms including Coinbase Global Inc, Payward Inc and Blockchain.com Group Holdings Inc. The move helped revive optimism around the Clarity Act, a crypto market structure bill that failed to make it to a vote before the Senate's August recess. However, Trump urged the Senate to pass the bill, and the chamber is expected to take it up in mid-September.

India, Singapore discuss key economic ties

Press Trust of India
Singapore

Singapore and India on Thursday discussed co-operation in advanced manufacturing, semiconductors, connectivity, digitalisation, fintech and clean energy at the fourth India-Singapore Ministerial Round table (ISMR) in Singapore.

External Affairs Minister S Jaishankar, Finance Minister Nirmala Sitharaman, Commerce and Industry Minister Piyush Goyal and Minister of State for Electronics and IT Jitin Prasada represented India. Singapore's delegation was led by Deputy Prime Minister and Trade and Industry Minister Gan Kim Yong and included Coordinating Minister for National Security and Home Minister K Shanmugam, Foreign Minister Vivian Balakrishnan, Digital Development and Information Minister Josephine Teo and Transport Minister Jeffrey Siow.

EXPANDING CO-OPERATION. Finance Minister Nirmala Sitharaman at a meeting with Singapore PM Lawrence Wong , in Singapore on Thursday. External Affairs Minister S Jaishankar and Commerce Minister Piyush Goyal were also present

"Our discussions explored deeper ties in advanced manufacturing, semiconductors, connectivity, digital, fintech, skilling, green economy and clean energy domains," Jaishankar posted on X after the meeting.

SIX PILLARS

Gan said the talks focused on six pillars: Sustainability, digitalisation, skills development, healthcare and medicine, advanced manufacturing and connectivity.

On advanced manufacturing, he said several semiconductor manufacturers had invested in India since the two countries signed an MoU in 2024.

The Ministers also discussed easing market access for companies and expanding skills training for India's workforce.

"We hope to be able to establish training centres for semiconductors, particularly," Gan said.

On digitalisation, Gan said cooperation between Singapore's PayNow and India's UPI had progressed well.

Singapore and India signed two MoUs on Thursday. An MoU between the Singapore Food Agency and the Food Safety and Standards Authority of India seeks to strengthen technical cooperation and facilitate agri-food trade.

Petrobras, Pemex hunt for oil bonanza off Mexico

Bloomberg

Latin America's two biggest oil companies are betting big on a high-risk effort to unlock a vast trove of crude from rocks that haven't seen the light of day in 160 million years.

Petroleo Brasileiro and Petroleos Mexicanos have teamed up to probe a layer of the Earth's crust beneath the Gulf of Mexico that's older, deeper and potentially richer in oil than the world's existing mega-fields.

The physical, financial and environmental risks are enormous given the challenges inherent in drilling for crude miles under the sea floor through unstable, high-pressure shelves of stone. The target is a geological cluster off the coast of Mexico's Campeche state that Pemex explored without success in 2018.

NO SUCCESS

It stands in stark relief to the gushers on the US side of the Gulf that pump oil trapped within rocks laid down roughly 20 million years ago.

Instead, Petrobras and Pemex are seeking to delve into stone formations that are eight times as old, from an era when dinosaurs and ancient molluscs dominated the land and the seas.

For Pemex, it's a Hail Mary shot at revitalisation as it grapples with smothering debt, shrinking oil output and a reputation for inefficiency and danger.

But the effort matters to global oil markets, too, as the Iran war and other geopolitical disruptions in the Middle-east have laid bare the peril of having so much supply concentrated in a single region.

SEISMIC ASSESSMENT

Teams from both firms began assessing seismic and other geological data in recent weeks with an eye towards accomplishing a feat that's never been done outside of Petrobras' home territory of Brazil.

"Petrobras is entering uncharted territory," said Pedro Zalan, a geologist who worked on exploration projects at the company.

The geology on the Mexican side of the Gulf "makes it particularly favourable for oil accumulation." In 2018, Pemex bored more than 7,800 m below the sea floor and penetrated the Campeche salt layer.

Although the exploratory well was declared unproductive, in industry parlance that's not necessarily synonymous with useless.

The data and insights extracted from that well may yield valuable clues for the Petrobras and Pemex geologists and engineers.

The firms also plan to search beneath sedimentary rocks formed by mud and sand avalanches miles below the sea surface and under younger, shallower salt formations, Petrobras' Head of Exploration and Production Sylvia Anjos said during an August 7 media briefing.

Robots poised for 'ChatGPT moment': Unitree CEO

Reuters
Beijing

The CEO of Chinese humanoid robot unicorn Unitree said on Thursday the industry is edging towards a "ChatGPT moment" for robot brains, after the company's blockbuster Shanghai listing crystallised China's ambitions to lead the next frontier of AI-powered machines.

Shares in China's best-known humanoid robot maker fell 11 per cent on Thursday, a day after soaring nearly sixfold in their market debut, highlighting intense investor enthusiasm for a fledgling sector that enjoys strong backing from Beijing.

"We are marching towards a 'ChatGPT moment' in embodied intelligence," said Wang Xingxing, the Hangzhou-based start-up's Founder and CEO, at a robot conference in Beijing.

The global AI boom that has reshaped the world economy was sparked in late 2022 by ChatGPT's breakthrough large language model, a watershed moment that drove mass adoption.

HUMANOID FUTURE. Unitree is the world's largest producer of robot dogs and it rose to fame with impressively choreographed performances of robots dancing REUTERS

No comparable inflection point has yet emerged for world models, the physical AI simulation systems designed to help robots understand and navigate real-world environments.

Wang said the industry is nearing a breakthrough where robots can be placed in unfamiliar environments and complete most tasks through simple voice or text instructions.

"We hope that in the future, we can see a robot be introduced into an unfamiliar household and it can achieve approximately 80 per cent of tasks successfully through voice or text commands," he said. "It is an important tipping point for the robot industry to usher in explosive growth."

HUMANOID ROBOTS

At the same time, Wang cautioned that a major leap in robot software could arrive within two to three years in an optimistic scenario, or within five to 10 years at the latest.

"Relative to the mood around World Robot Conference and Unitree's spectacular IPO, Wang Xingxing was notably sober about current capabilities," said Georg Stieler, Head of Automation at robotics consultancy Stieler.

Unitree is the world's largest producer of robot dogs and it rose to fame with impressively choreographed performances of robots dancing and performing kung-fu, showcased on Chinese television, and is increasingly deploying its machines in real-world industrial settings. Its IPO prospectus shows most customers are universities and research institutions.

Unitree's Wang said the company's biggest current investment in terms of capital and manpower is in world models and that it is "lagging behind" in the real-world application of physical AI models. He also said humanoids are not yet capable enough for mass deployment, pointing to limitations in the AI models that power robots' decision-making and interactions as the industry's biggest bottleneck.

Even so, Wang expects the sector to enter a decade of rapid autonomous evolution of humanoid robots, as the AI boom accelerates and AI language models learn to improve themselves.

QUICKLY.

IGC cuts grain crop outlook on heatwave

The International Grains Council on Thursday cut its forecast for the 2026/27 world wheat crop, partly due to a deterioration in production prospects in Britain and the European Union. In its monthly update, it trimmed the 2026/27 world wheat crop outlook by 4 million tonnes (mt) to 817 mt. In addition, the IGC trimmed its forecast for 2026/27 global corn production by 1 mt to 1.305 billion tonnes. REUTERS

Inventory build-up drags down copper

London: Copper prices slipped as more inventories arrived in warehouses, but the losses were modest due to a weaker dollar. Benchmark three-month copper on the LME shed 0.4 per cent to $13,994 a tonne by 1430 GMT. The most-traded copper contract on the Shanghai Futures Exchange edged 0.2 per cent higher to 107,200 yuan ($15,943.13). REUTERS

Palm oil extends gains on supply worries

Jakarta: Malaysian palm oil futures climbed for a fourth consecutive session fuelled by concerns over El Nino-related dry weather, firm crude oil prices and constant fund buying. The benchmark palm oil contract for November delivery on the BMD closed up 66 ringgit at 4,959 ringgit ($1,227.48) a tonne. REUTERS

Centre permits duty-free import of 1 mt raw sugar

COMBATING PRICE RISE. Permission given under TRQ as domestic prices soar to a record high of ₹55.7 a kg in New Delhi

Subramani Ra Mancombu
Chennai

The Union government on Thursday allowed the duty-free import of one million tonnes of raw sugar as part of its efforts to tame soaring prices and food inflation.

In a notification issued late on Thursday, the Commerce Ministry said the imports would be allowed under a tariff rate quota (TRQ) regime. The imports will be allowed only till October 30, 2026.

In addition, the government allowed a one-time option to convert sugar imported under the advance authorisation scheme to TRQ. This includes refined sugar produced or to be produced from imported raw sugar.

Industry sources said that to utilise the conversion, companies must pay back the previously exempted GST and are mandated to sell the resultant refined sugar exclusively in the domestic market by October 31, 2026.

BOOSTING SUPPLY

"While the DGFT will issue a separate public notice to outline the precise administrative procedures, this short-term policy appears designed to boost domestic sugar supply and stabilise market prices, balancing the loss of import duties by reclaiming GST while ensuring the final product remains within the country," said Dilip S Patil, Managing Director of Samarth SSK Ltd and Co-Chairperson of the Sugar Bioenergy Forum (SBF) under the Indian Federation of Green Energy.

BULL GRIP. Global sugar prices have hit 18-month high, driven by fears over the impact of El Nino, higher crude oil prices and concerns over a widening supply deficit

The move comes after sugar prices in Delhi's retail markets surged to a record ₹55.7 a kg.

Global sugar prices have also risen to an 18-month high, driven by expectations of Indian imports, fears over the impact of El Nino, higher crude oil prices and concerns over a widening supply deficit.

On Thursday, October raw sugar futures on the Inter-Continental Exchange, New York, were quoted at 18.01 US cents a pound (about $390 or ₹37,350 a tonne), while white sugar prices in London were ruling at $558 (₹53,400) a tonne. Raw sugar was quoting near 14 cents a pound and white sugar at $411 before the current rally.

The duty-free import will provide some relief as the landed cost of white sugar at current prices could be ₹58 a kg. Trade sources said at least 3 lakh tonnes of sugar were headed to India and another 1 lakh tonnes were to be shipped over the next few days.

CURBS ON BULK BUYERS

"The supply situation would have been tight after October. We had to import at least one million tonnes of sugar, either in raw or white," said Rahil Shaikh, Founder and Managing Director, MEIR Commodities.

In another significant development, the government issued a notification stipulating that from September 1, bulk buyers using over 10 tonnes of sugar a month cannot hold more than 15 days' stock. This will be in force till November 30.

The notification will cover confectionery and soft drink manufacturers, food processors, sweet makers and institutional buyers. Bulk consumers would be identified based on their average monthly consumption over the past year. Such consumers buying directly or through dealers will be monitored, it said.

Apart from these, the government's permission to mills to crush sugarcane early in the 2026-27 season and allow them to sell in October and November will help avoid sugar imports.

In its notification on August 14, the Directorate of Sugar and Vegetable Oils in the Department of Food and Distribution said, "In view of the prevailing market situation, sugar mills commencing production in the month of October 2026 shall be allowed to sell the quantity of sugar produced in October during the months of October and November."

"By enabling mills to monetise early-season production without creating artificial shortages, the framework also helps maintain adequate domestic availability, thereby lessening the likelihood of having to resort to imports," Patil said. For the 2026-27 season, farmers have planted sugarcane on 58.31 lakh hectares (lh), against 58.62 lh a year earlier.

Buy zinc futures if the price declines to ₹398

Akhil Nallamuthu
bl. research bureau

Zinc futures (₹401/kg) have been in a steady long-term uptrend. While there have been consolidations and moderations in price, the broader direction remained up.

COMMODITY CALL.

Recently, the August futures broke out of the resistance at ₹398, indicating that the rally is intact. Given the upward momentum, the contract could rise to ₹412 in the near-term. A breakout of ₹412 could lift zinc futures to ₹420. However, if there is a decline from the current level, they can find support at ₹395. Immediate support

below ₹395 is at ₹390, where the 21-day moving average lies. As long as the support at ₹385 stays true, the outlook will be bullish. That said, there is a chance for zinc futures to see a decline in price, possibly to ₹390, before the uptick to ₹412 occurs.

TRADE STRATEGY

Buy zinc futures (August) if the price dips to ₹398. Place stop-loss at ₹388. When the contract rises to ₹408, tighten the stop-loss to ₹402. Book profits at ₹412.

US now a key fruits and vegetable exporter to India

AJ Vinayak
Mangaluru

It looks like India's appetite for imported fruits and vegetables is increasing over the years, as the import bill has increased by 114 per cent and volumes by 84 per cent in the past decade.

Though imports from the US doubled in value terms and increased by 74.5 per cent in volume during the decade, Pakistan vanished from the list of exporting countries, and China's exports to India declined by half both in terms of value and volume.

Data published by the Directorate General of Commercial Intelligence and Statistics (DGCI&S) showed that India's import of fruits and vegetables from the US increased by 116 per cent in terms of value and 74.5 per cent in terms of quantity in the past decade, whereas imports from Pakistan came to zero during the period.

Imports from China declined by 53.3 per cent in terms of value and 51.53 per cent in terms of quantity between 2016-17 and 2025-26.

Import of fruits and vegetables increased from $1.78 billion in 2016-17 to $3.82 billion in 2025-26, a growth of 114.39 per cent.

The import basket widened from 11.22 lakh tonnes (lt) in 2016-17 to 20.66 lt in 2015-26, a growth of 84.15 per cent.

EXPORTS TOO UP

In a recent reply in the Lok Sabha, Jitin Prasada, Union Minister of State for Commerce and Industry, said India's trade in fruits and vegetables has remained robust over the years, re-

The US has been exporting over 3 lt of fruits and vegetables, valued at over $1 billion, since the past three years

flecting strong domestic production capabilities and growing integration with the global agricultural markets. India has consistently been a net exporter of fruits and vegetables.

During the past 10 years, exports increased from $2.45 billion in 2016-17 to $3.93 billion in 2025-26.

Export volumes also increased from about 49.5 lt in 2016-17 to 58.2 lt in 2025-26, indicating sustained global demand for Indian horticultural products.

"The overall trend indicates expanding trade flows on both the export and import fronts, while maintaining a positive trade balance and strengthening India's position in global agricultural trade," Prasada said.

US EXPORTS $1.45 B

The US has remained the top exporter of fruits and vegetables to India. The export value increased from $0.67 billion in 2016-17 to $1.45 billion in 2025-26, and the export volume increased from 1.90 lt to 3.32 lt.

In fact, it has been exporting over 3 lt of fruits and vegetables valued over $1 billion since the past three years. There was no export from Pakistan to India in 2025-26.

Despite a more than 53 per cent decline in terms of value and 51.53 per cent in terms of quantity, China still exports more than 1 lt of fruits and vegetables to India. It exported 2.13 lt, valued at $176.95 million in 2016-17. The volume declined to 1.03 lt, valued at $82.63 million, in 2025-26.

'Indian coffee sector gearing to meet EUDR norms'

Vishwanath Kulkarni
Bengaluru

Indian coffee stakeholders are gearing up to meet the European Union Deforestation Regulation (EUDR) norms, said M Kurma Rao, CEO & Secretary, Coffee Board.

"We have a ready kind of plan in place to comply with the EUDR norms. Our preparedness is mainly focused on creating awareness and ensuring the required technology is available. We are working with growers and exporters to help them understand the requirements and get ready. Both the processes are ongoing," Rao said.

The EUDR norms, which mandate that specific commodities including coffee must be deforestation free and fully traceable with geolocation data, will come into effect from December 30.

LOW-RISK COUNTRY

The EUDR mandates that companies exporting commodities such as coffee and cocoa, among others, to the European Union markets must conduct thorough deforestation analysis, detailed risk assessment and risk mitigation to ensure that these goods are not sourced from deforested areas since December 31, 2020.

India has been categorised as a low risk country. The EU is a major market for Indian coffee exports, accounting for over 45 per cent of the shipments. Rao said that as December 2020 is the cut-off date under EUDR for checking whether the land has been deforested or not, the important requirement is to establish that the product has not come from a deforested areas.

"Wherever the coffee has come from, the area, estate or the production area, the geolocation of polygon is the critical requirement. Coffee Board has developed a very important module for Indian companies. We have our India Coffee app, which is a one-stop solution, an integrated solution for all our services, whatever we extend to stakeholders. So, in that, we have integrated this module also and are creating awareness and having educative

Kurma Rao M, CEO & Secretary, Coffee Board

and consultation sessions with the growers. There is consistent improvement and consistent utilisation of that application as well by the stakeholders," Rao said.

TRADE GETTING READY

Further, he said the Board had held discussions with traders and exporters, who expressed the confidence that they are getting prepared and that the necessary technology solutions are being developed.

At the same time, the entire value chain needs to work together. It is not just the exporters; growers, processors and other stakeholders also need to be involved, Rao said.

"Everyone is working together to prepare for the implementation," he said.

The Board has also been leveraging its digital mobile advisory service, Coffee Krishi Taranga, to create awareness through voice messages about the need to comply with the EUDR norms. More than 1.62 lakh growers are registered on the Coffee Krishi Taranga platform.

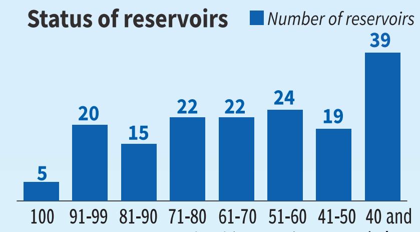
Improving water levels

Storage in India's 166 key reservoirs crossed 60 per cent of capacity this week, though 35 per cent of the reservoirs were less than half full.

The reservoirs held 117.773 billion cubic metres (BCM), or 64.16 per cent of their combined capacity of 183.565 BCM, according to data from the Central Water Commission (CWC). Five reservoirs were full, while 20 had storage above 90 per cent of capacity. However, overall storage was 18 percentage points lower than last year and three percentage points below the normal level. Reservoir storage continued to rise as the South-West monsoon remained active, defying forecasts of a weak season. As of August 20, the monsoon was 13 per cent deficient, with the deficit widening to 26 per cent in East and North-East India and 22 per cent in peninsular India.

A low-pressure area bringing rainfall over eastern and north-eastern India is expected to support a further rise in reservoir levels.

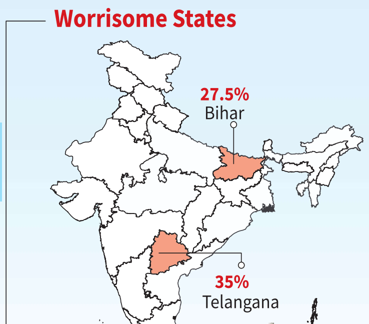
Status of reservoirs

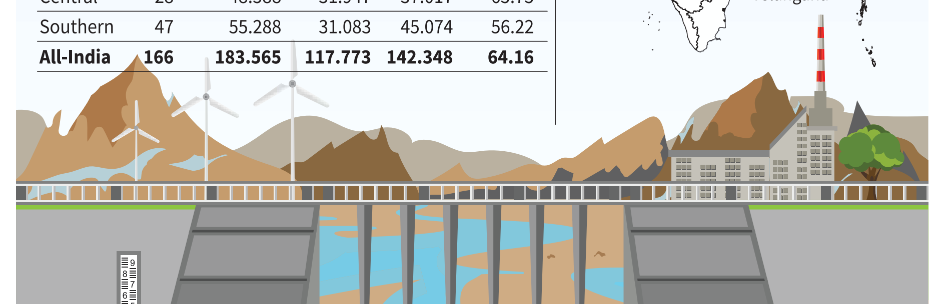


Region-wise storage

Region	Number of reservoirs	Live capacity (in BCM*)	Storage (in BCM)	Storage last year (in BCM)	%age level to capacity
Northern	11	19.836	11.306	16.604	57
Eastern	27	21.759	12.695	12.648	58.34
Western	53	38.094	30.742	31.005	80.7
Central	28	48.588	31.947	37.017	65.75
Southern	47	55.288	31.083	45.074	56.22
All-India	**166**	**183.565**	**117.773**	**142.348**	**64.16**

Worrisome States





Shetrunji (Gujarat), Salaulim (Goa), Sapua (Odisha), Panchet Hill (Jharkhand) and Veer Dam (Maharashtra) are full
*Billion cubic metres Source: Central Water Commission

AI sparks a shift in jewellery design

Our Bureau
Chennai

Artificial intelligence (AI) is catching up in the jewellery industry, redefining designs and accelerating innovation, stakeholders said.

Raghav Dhir, Director, Dhirsons Jewellers (Dhiraj Dhir Group), said AI is steadily becoming an important part of the industry. "I believe it should be viewed as a creative enabler rather than a creative replacement. While AI can make the process smarter and more efficient, the final piece must still carry the warmth of human craftsmanship and storytelling," he said.

Suresh Krishnan, VP-Sales, PNG Jewellers, said technology is fundamentally redefining jewellery design by making it more intelligent, agile and consumer-centric, while preserving the craftsmanship that gives every piece its emotional value. "We are seeing a clear shift towards lightweight, fashion-forward jewellery, driven by changing lifestyles and higher gold prices."

Supriya Kataria, Founder, Kumari Fine Jewellery, said

NEW EDGE. Consumers are becoming increasingly thoughtful in their purchases, says a jeweller

that the conversation around AI is not about replacing artisans but about removing guesswork while allowing human creativity and craftsmanship to remain at the heart of every piece.

HUMAN TOUCH

"In design, AI is helping accelerate innovation by enabling designers to explore hundreds of variations in proportions, gemstones, finishes and forms before a single gram of gold is crafted," she said.

Artificial intelligence serves as a tireless studio assistant, allowing creative teams to experiment more freely, while every final design decision continues to rest with the designer, she said.

Dhir said that in a market like Delhi-NCR, consumers are tradition-conscious but also globally aware. "A family may come looking for a bridal set rooted in heritage, while their children are also interested in contemporary jewellery for everyday wear," he said.

"Such diversity makes AI particularly valuable. It helps jewellers study the changing consumer preferences, understand the emerging design trends across regions and seasons, and respond with greater precision without compromising on originality," said the Dhirsons director.

"AI is reducing design cycles through faster concept development, virtual prototyping and production planning," he said.

Krishnan said that advanced manufacturing techniques such as 3D printing, paper casting and electroforming allow designers to create intricate yet lightweight pieces with greater precision and faster turnaround times.

"AI is further strengthening this evolution by helping brands analyse consumer preferences, forecast design trends and personalise recommendations across online and offline channels," he said.

Kataria said AI is changing how brands anticipate consumer preferences. "Rather than relying only on what sold last season, it helps identify emerging motifs, silhouettes and price segments by analysing search behaviour and social conversations," she said.

Perhaps AI's greatest strength lies in meaningful personalisation. "AI can understand not just what a customer buys, but why they are buying, whether it is a milestone, self-reward or celebration, creating recommendations that feel more thoughtful and relevant," Kataria added.

Crude oil up as US' bid to crush Iran economy clouds Hormuz outlook

Bloomberg

Crude oil soared to the highest in almost a month, as Donald Trump's threat to crush the Iranian economy further clouded the prospect of ending a war that has upended energy markets.

Brent futures jumped toward $95 a barrel, extending a two-week rally to almost 20 per cent, before paring some of the gains. Measures the US President described as "Economic Warfare and Isolation" could mean that any country allowing financial institutions, businesses, airports or government entities to aid Iran would face economic consequences.

The move to isolate Iran shattered hopes for a near-term deal to reopen the Strait of Hormuz, the chokepoint for about a fifth of the world's oil. Brent's prompt spread — the difference between its two nearest contracts — is about $2 a barrel in backwardation. That's a bullish pattern signalling tight short-term supplies.

First Coffee raises $1.3 million from Japanese VC firm DGDV

Our Bureau
Bengaluru

First Coffee, a grab-and-go specialty coffee brand, has raised $1.3 million in a pre-Series A funding round led by Japanese venture capital firm DG Daiwa Ventures (DGDV).

The round also saw participation from other notable investors such as BEENEXT; Sanjay Kapoor, Co-founder and MD, Genesis Luxury; Shashank Bhagat, Chairman, BI Group; and others, the company said in a statement.

The funds will be used for store expansion, build a formidable corporate team, strengthen brand value through marketing initiatives, and make further investments in product line development.

With this latest round, First Coffee has raised $2.5 million to date. This investment marks DGDV's foray into India's specialty coffee market, signalling the country's huge and growing market potential globally.

Makoto Ibi, Head of Global Investment at DGDV, said, "India remains a key market for us, and through First Coffee we are excited to tap into the specialty coffee space in the country."

"Over the last year, First Coffee has built a very strong brand in North India, especially among younger consumers, serving high-quality specialty coffee across more than 25 outlets. The founders' previous F&B experience in founding and scaling Keventers has been instrumental in achieving that," said Anirudh Garg, Partner at BEENEXT, speaking about First Coffee and its offerings.

BETTING ON YOUTH

First Coffee said it had gained market share amongst Gen Z consumers by offering premium beverages focusing on cold coffee-based beverages and matcha.

As per Customer Market Insights, the Indian coffee market is projected to reach $1,227.47 million by 2032, growing annually at a 9.87 per cent CAGR from 2024 to 2033.

Domestic coffee consumption has increased drastically over the last five years, driven by rising demand for specialty coffee and convenience.

QUICKLY.

T-Hub, OKI Electric to help deep techs go global

Hyderabad: T-Hub, one of the world's largest start-up incubators, has partnered with OKI Electric Industry, a Japanese technology company, to launch a programme designed to help Indian deep tech start-ups access global markets and explore commercial opportunities in Japan. The two organisations have shortlisted eight of the more than 150 applications they received from start-ups across the country. OUR BUREAU

Alstom, Railways in talks for locomotives order

New Delhi: French train maker Alstom is in discussions with the Railways for a follow-on order of 200 locomotives for its manufacturing plant in Madhepura, Bihar, and also for utilising the facility to make other railway-related products, a senior company official said. Vivek Garg, MD of Alstom's Madhepura Electric Locomotive Pvt Ltd, told *PTI* that the initial order of 800 electric freight locomotives will be completed by March 2028. PTI

Centre sets up Ladakh Bench of J&K High Court

Srinagar: The Union Cabinet has approved the setting up of a Ladakh bench of the High Court of Jammu and Kashmir and Ladakh, a move aimed at bringing the higher judiciary closer to litigants in the remote Himalayan Union Territory. The decision comes nearly seven years after Ladakh was carved out as a separate Union Territory following the reorganisation of the erstwhile state of Jammu and Kashmir. Union Home Minister Amit Shah announced the decision in a post on X on Thursday. OUR BUREAU

ESIC has added 4,961 doctors to India's healthcare pool till date

NEXT GEN PROSPECTS. ESIC is expanding its medical education facilities for aspirants

Our Bureau
New Delhi

The Employees' State Insurance Corporation (ESIC) has contributed 4,961 doctors to the nation through its medical institutions, including 1,682 children of insured workers. At the postgraduate level, more than 1,200 students have passed out, strengthening the country's pool of specialised doctors, the Ministry of Labour and Employment said on Thursday. To support workers' families, ESIC reserves approximately 880 seats comprising around 700 seats for the MBBS course and the remaining across BDS, BSc Nursing and paramedical/allied health sciences courses, annually under the 'Ward of Insured Persons (IP)' Quota across its medical colleges.

SEAT ALLOCATION. ESIC reserves approximately 880 seats, comprising around 700 seats for MBBS and the rest for BDS, BSc Nursing and paramedical/allied health sciences courses GETTY IMAGES

The Ministry stated that the government's commitment to social security for workers is reflected in the disbursement of cash benefits and quality healthcare to its beneficiaries through an extensive infrastructure comprising of 169 hospitals, 1,603 dispensaries, 17 medical colleges, two dental colleges, two nursing colleges, three para-medical college, supported by 65 Regional/Sub-Regional Offices, 612 Branch Offices, and 117 Dispensary-cum-Branch Offices.

The ESI scheme is presently implemented in 728 out of a total of 787 districts across the country.

ESIC CONTRIBUTION

As India strides toward its ambitious goal of creating 75,000 new medical seats, ESIC is contributing significantly to this goal by steadily expanding its medical education infrastructure to widen the pathways available to the country's young aspirants, as per the Ministry.

Today, 17 ESIC Medical Colleges stand operational across the country, offering UG Courses (1,550 MBBS seats) and PG courses (559 MD/MS seats, 182 DNB seats, 17 DrNB seats, 31 DM/MCh seats, 10 PhD seats).

Additionally, there are three state-run medical colleges which contribute a further 330 MBBS seats. Further there are two ESIC Dental Colleges offering 124 seats, two Nursing colleges offering 120 BSc Nursing seats and three paramedical colleges offering 292 seats to students who aspire to serve society through medical sciences.

MEDICAL EDUCATION

With more medical colleges in the pipeline, ESIC is poised to further expand access to quality medical education, opening doors of opportunity for countless young minds who dream of becoming doctors, regardless of the circumstances into which they were born, said the Ministry.

CBIC to coordinate with States to plug GST evasion in illegal mining

Our Bureau
New Delhi

In order to curb GST evasion, the Central Board of Indirect Taxes & Customs (CBIC) has instructed its field formations to have a structured co-ordination with the State authorities on sharing information related to illegal mining and transportation of minerals.

"Timely sharing of information relating to illegal mining and transportation of minerals would facilitate identification of cases involving possible suppression of taxable supplies, non-payment or short payment of GST, wrongful availment of input tax credit and other violations of the provisions of the Central Goods and Services Tax Act, 2017," the Board said in an instruction to its field formations.

DATA SHARING

This instruction will lead to the cross-departmental data sharing between CGST formations, State mining authorities and tax administrations. Such an exercise

would enable mining records to be compared with e-way bills, e-invoices and GST returns.

This instruction has been issued after Comptroller & Auditor General (C&AG) in its report, "Assessment, Levy and Collection of GST on Minerals" observed that State mining authorities detect numerous instances of illegal mining, illegal transportation of minerals, seizure of minerals and vehicles, cancellation/suspension of mining leases, excess extraction of minerals, and other violations under the mining laws. The instruction asked all Principal Chief Commissioners/Chief Commissioners of CGST zones to ensure that a nodal officer is designated in each CGST zone for coordination with the respective State Mining Department. A mechanism will be established with the State mining authorities for periodic sharing of information relating to illegal mining and transportation of minerals as detected within the jurisdiction.

Further, intelligence generated from such information will be disseminated to the jurisdictional Commissionerates/DGGI formations, wherever necessary, for further action. It also prescribed periodic meetings with the State mining authorities to review the effectiveness of the information-sharing mechanism and to resolve operational issues.

The audit report observed there is no structured mechanism for periodic sharing of information between the State mining authorities and the CGST field formations.

Consequently, valuable enforcement intelligence available with the State mining authorities is not being systematically utilised by the GST authorities for examination of possible tax implications and initiation of appropriate action under the GST law, the instruction said.

SC forms 5-member panel to probe violence during NEET-UG protests

Krishnadas Rajagopal
New Delhi

The Supreme Court has constituted a high-powered enquiry committee (HPEC), headed by its former judge, R Subhash Reddy, to probe all issues and allegations, including that of police excesses on students, during the nationwide protests against the NEET-UG paper leaks.

Beside Justice Reddy, the committee will include Justice Ravi Shankar Jha, former Chief Justice of the Punjab and Haryana High Court; Justice Shalinder Kaur, former judge of the Delhi High Court; Rishi Kumar Shukla, former Director of the Central Bureau of Investigation; and LR Bishnoi, retired Director General of Police, Meghalaya.

ON PRIORITY BASIS

The order by a three-judge Bench, headed by Chief Justice Surya Kant, said, "The committee shall undertake a continuous and periodic assessment of the issues

enumerated in the order and shall submit its interim findings periodically so as to enable this court to take appropriate measures and issue such directions as may be warranted."

The court suggested that the HPEC take up, on a priority basis, the allegations of targeted violence, harassment and molestation of female protestors. Similarly, it was urged to assess the grievous harm and injury allegedly caused to protestors by police authorities and security personnel.

The court clarified that the constitution of the HPEC "shall in no way deter or debar the police authorities or other security forces from taking administrative or disciplinary action against such of their officers as may be found to be in contravention of the rules governing their conduct".

These include the "use of excessive force and violence against protestors, including the deployment of pellet guns, electric batons, lathi charge and tear gas without adequate warning or proportionality, resulting in severe bodily harm and injuries, some of which are alleged to be of a grievous and lasting nature".The petitioners also raised the question of what would be a "proportionate and measured police response" during protests, public gatherings, and peaceful assemblies.

Further, the court brought to the attention of the HPEC the demand of the petitioners to ensure that police and security personnel wear proper uniforms and visible nameplates at the time of effecting arrests or using force during crowd-control operations, so as to ensure accountability and enable the identification of the individual officers.

INJURY TO POLICE

Similarly, the court listed issues raised by respondents, including the families of injured police officers. These include the alleged use of force and violence by protestors against police officials and security personnel, the damage caused to public property on account of the actions of the protestors and destruction of vehicles and other assets belonging to the State and private citizens alike.

MoPNG launches deep tech start-ups accelerator

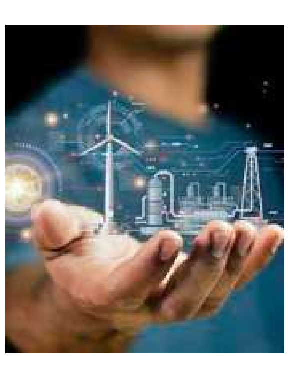
Our Bureau
Chennai

The Petroleum Secretary, along with the CMDs of all oil giants, launched "MC^2+ Ignite: India's Flagship Energy Innovation Accelerator". The MC^2 Foundation, a non-governmental private entity under the aegis of the Ministry of Petroleum and Natural Gas (MoPNG), launched 'MC^2+ Ignite', a sector-specific accelerator programme to support deep-tech start-ups focused on the energy sector.

The programme was launched by the Secretary, MoPNG, along with Kartikeya Dube, Chairman, bp India, and the Chairman and Managing Directors (CMDs) of all oil and gas companies at the IIT-Madras campus.

FIRST COHORT

MC^2+ Ignite will select a cohort of approximately 30



start-ups, who will be eligible for up to ₹2 crore in milestone-linked convertible funding.

DECENTRALISED MODE

Neeraj Mittal, Secretary, MoPNG, and Chairman, MC^2 Foundation, said that the programme will operate in a decentralised model, having its hub in Delhi and nodes within their R&D centres of various sponsoring companies in the oil and gas sector providing access to real pilot sites.

Sri Lanka emerges an additional manufacturing base for TN apparel makers to augment capacity

T E Raja Simhan
Chennai

Sri Lanka is emerging as more than an alternative manufacturing destination for Tamil Nadu's apparel industry, with companies viewing the island nation as a complementary production base that could support growth, mitigate tariff risks and offer customers greater sourcing flexibility.

For Avinashi-based SP Apparels Ltd, Sri Lanka is already becoming an important growth platform.

The manufacturer and exporter of knitted garments for infants and children expects its Sri Lankan operations to contribute ₹150-200 crore in revenue by March 2027, as the factories acquired and integrated over the past year- and-a-half move towards full operational efficiency. Chairman and Managing Director P Sundararajan said delivery performance, productivity and quality had improved, with the factories now operating at near full efficiency.

SP Apparels currently has around 1,650 machines in Sri Lanka, of which about 1,300 are being deployed for exports, he told analysts.

EXPANSION

The factories receive base orders from India, along with the required raw materials, while shipments have remained on schedule.

SP Apparels is also exploring ways to expand its Sri Lankan manufacturing footprint without committing substantial fresh capital. It plans to work with customer-approved factories on a job-work basis, allowing it to add capacity. The company expects this model could add another 500-600 machines within a year.

At the same time, its existing machinery base in Sri

Lanka could be expanded to 2,000 machines, providing additional capacity as demand improves, said Sundararajan.

The strategy effectively creates a dual-country manufacturing network, with Sri Lanka complementing the company's established production base in India, he said.

Chennai-based premium apparel manufacturer Meenakshi India Ltd entered into a contract manufacturing deal with a Sri Lankan factory last year.

Ashutosh Goenka, Chairman and Managing Director, Meenakshi India, said the company entered into the arrangement when the US imposed 50 per cent tariffs on India.

DUTY-FREE ACCESS

With the tariff situation changing, Sri Lanka's relative advantage has narrowed. Sri Lanka enjoys duty-free access to the European Union for its apparel exports, while Indian apparel faces duties of around 8-12 per cent.

Goenka said the India-EU FTA, once operational, could bring India closer to Sri Lanka in terms of market access.

"Organically, Sri Lanka is neither cheaper nor better than India. It is the duties and tariffs that make it preferred over India," he said.

US envoy Gor's India remark sparks Pak protest

Gulzar Bhat
Srinagar

US Ambassador to India Sergio Gor arrived in Leh on Thursday, beginning the Ladakh leg of his visit to Jammu and Kashmir, a day after he described J&K as an "important part of India".

The US envoy was expected to meet Tibetan spiritual leader the Dalai Lama in Leh, but the proposed interaction was dropped after a last-minute change to his itinerary, according to reports.

Gor's arrival in Leh follows his visit to Srinagar on Wednesday, where he met Jammu and Kashmir Chief Minister Omar Abdullah and discussed the region's tourism potential and security situation.

Gor also praised the improvement in the security situation and indicated that the US could review its travel advisory for Jammu and Kashmir. During his Srinagar visit, Gor also took an hour-long shikara ride on iconic Dal Lake.

DIPLOMATIC REACTION

His remarks describing Jammu and Kashmir as an "important part of India" have since triggered a diplomatic reaction from Pakistan.

Pakistan summoned the US Chargé d'Affaires in Islamabad and lodged what its Foreign Ministry termed a "strong demarche" over Gor's comments.

Islamabad described the Ambassador's remarks on the status of Jammu and Kashmir as "factually incorrect" and objected to his characterisation of the region as a part of India.

The envoy's visit to Ladakh comes as the region continues to draw attention for its strategic importance as well as its growing tourism potential.

Telangana seeks assured price of ₹25,000 per tonne for oil palm FFB

Our Bureau
Hyderabad

Telangana has called for an assured price of ₹25,000 per tonne of oil palm fresh fruit bunches (FFB) to ensure income security for farmers across the country.

PRICE REVISIONS

It also wanted price revisions in line with the rising production costs.

"This will insulate oil palm farmers from frequent price fluctuations and ensure remunerative income," Telangana Agriculture Minister Tummala Nageswara Rao said. He submitted a memorandum to Union Home Minister Amit Shah, appealing for measures in this regard at the 31st Southern Zonal Council meeting at Mamallapuram in Tamil Nadu on Thursday. He also sought the cooperation of Andhra Pradesh Chief Minister N Chandrababu Naidu to put pressure on the Union government.

GESTATION PERIOD

"The gestation period in oil palm plantations is very long, which forces farmers to wait years to receive income from the crop. A good rate for their produce will help recover the huge investments that they make in the initial phases," he said.

Stating that oil palm plantation is gaining momentum in Telangana and Andhra Pradesh, the Minister pointed to price fluctuations driven by international price dynamics.

New pest raises quarantine concerns in Kashmir as willow, poplar, apple trees come under attack

Gulzar Bhat
Srinagar

A new pest attacking willow and poplar trees has raised concerns among farmers and scientists in Kashmir, highlighting growing risks from pests entering the Valley along with planting material.

The pest, identified as *Drosicha turkistanica*, is a sap-sucking insect that weakens trees and, in severe infestations, can cause them to wither, according to Bashir Ahmad Rather, a professor at the Mountain Research Centre for Field Crops, Khudwani.

Rather said the pest was new to the region and had been reported in parts of south Kashmir.

"The plant material is not properly quarantined, which ultimately leads to the ar-

rival of new pests," Rather said.

The emergence of the pest has renewed concerns over the movement of planting material into Kashmir, particularly as the Valley has seen the arrival and spread of other pests in recent years.

Farmers said the poplar and willow infestation was first noticed in Kulgam and has since been reported in other parts of southern Kashmir. Gulam Nabi, a farmer from Arwani, said, "Poplar plantation is the main source of income for many people living here."

The latest pest follows the spread of the apple leaf miner in Kashmir's orchards. The pest was initially reported in Shopian and has subsequently been observed in other apple-growing areas of the Valley, farmers said.

The arrival of the leaf miner coincided with the expansion of high-density apple cultivation, with planting material and varieties being brought into Kashmir from countries, including Italy and the United States.

QUARANTINE GAP

Tariq Ahmad, an apple farmer from Shopian, said inadequate compliance with quarantine and other safeguards could increase the risk of introducing pests. "Private distributors are not following the standard operating procedures, which results in such pests entering the Valley," he said.

Ahmad said the leaf miner had increased production costs for growers by forcing them to undertake additional pesticide applications.

BROADER CHALLENGE

Experts said the two cases pointed to a broader challenge for Kashmir's horticulture and tree-plantation economy — expanding access to improved planting material while preventing the introduction of pests and diseases.

Rather said stronger quarantine procedures and closer monitoring of plant material entering the Valley were needed to reduce the risk of further introductions.

HealthEdge leases 1.62 l sq ft from Brigade group in Thiruvananthapuram

Our Bureau
Bengaluru

The Brigade Group has leased 1.62 lakh sq ft of office space at Brigade Square in Thiruvananthapuram to HealthEdge, a Bain Capital-backed healthcare technology company, as demand for technology and knowledge-driven workspace expands beyond India's major IT hubs. Located in Technopark Phase 1, Brigade Square is a 2 lakh sq ft IT office building.

HealthEdge's new campus will house teams across engineering, product development, technology, operations and corporate functions. "Having a global healthcare technology company such as HealthEdge as a key occupier is a strong validation of Thiruvananthapuram's potential as a technology destination," said Nirupa Shankar, Joint Managing Director, Brigade Enterprises.

HealthEdge CEO Kevin Adams said the company's India teams are central to its work across AI and engineering, product development and operations.

QUICKLY.

Pulse Pharma's Vitamin D drug gets DCGI nod

Hyderabad: Pulse Pharmaceuticals has received approval from the Drug Controller General of India (DCGI) for its nano-carrier entrapped Vitamin D3 oral dispersion. "Clinical studies have demonstrated 50-60 per cent higher serum vitamin D levels with nano-carrier entrapped Vitamin D3 oral dispersion compared to conventional formulations," the Hyderabad-based company said on Thursday. The product is being manufactured by Pulse Pharmaceuticals in Roorkee, Baddi and Hyderabad. The proprietary Aqueol platform technology of the company is specifically designed to effectively/deliver lipophilic compounds in water-based mediums. OUR BUREAU

Adfactors PR buys major stake in Aussie firm

Mumbai/Melbourne: Adfactors PR has acquired a majority stake in Australian communications consultancy SenateSHJ, expanding its presence in the Asia-Pacific region and creating a cross-border platform for reputation, critical issues and change communications. "The transaction brings together two independent firms with complementary strengths, beliefs, a shared commitment to outstanding work and a common ambition to help their clients navigate reputation, stakeholder issues and change in an increasingly complex environment," the two firms said in a statement. Financial terms of the transaction were not disclosed. SenateSHJ will retain its brand and continue to operate from its offices in Sydney and Melbourne. PTI

Against 10% norm, IndiGo tests 20% of pilots annually for substance abuse: CEO

OPERATIONAL FOCUS. Says airline has strengthened its SOPs, augmented manpower for handling disruptions

Aneesh Phadnis
Mumbai

IndiGo tests 20 per cent of its pilots for substance abuse annually, which is higher than the Directorate General of Civil Aviation's (DGCA's) prescribed limit, Chief Executive Officer Willie Walsh said on Thursday. The DGCA requires airlines to randomly test at least 10 per cent of their pilots annually.

Responding to shareholder questions at the company's annual general meeting, Walsh said the airline has a comprehensive fitness for duty framework covering alcohol, substance abuse, fatigue and mental well-being.

"Substance testing is done at induction. We've been doing this since 2015. All new employees are subject to substance testing at induction and then randomly thereafter. We exceed the recommended levels of testing where we routinely achieve about 20 per cent of random testing," Walsh said.

> All new employees are subject to substance testing at induction and then randomly thereafter
>
> **WILLIE WALSH**
> Chief Executive Officer, IndiGo

Substance abuse by pilots is in focus after an Air India pilot recently tested positive for marijuana consumption. Subsequently, Air India is testing all its pilots and the DGCA, too, is working on tighter anti-doping rules.

At the AGM, the IndiGo management also faced questions on steps taken to prevent flight disruption, last financial year loss, long-haul network plans, among others.

INDIGO OPERATIONS

Walsh, who took over as the CEO earlier this month, said the airline has taken remedial measures to ensure disruptions like the one witnessed last December do not recur. This includes strengthening of manpower planning and roster process, improved oversight, predictive dashboards and early warning systems enabling rostering staff to take preemptive actions.

Walsh said the airline has established a disruption management group for handling disruptions. "We have strengthened our SOPs and we have augmented manpower and crew resources in our operations control centre. We have enhanced real-time monitoring processes to track forward-looking key performance indicators measuring our operational status, crew health and all other operational metrics that can give us an indication of problems occurring," he said.

IndiGo's revenue from operations grew 5 per cent to over ₹84,000 crore, but the airline swung to ₹2,393-crore net loss in FY26 due to rupee depreciation. The airline continues to face headwinds related to supply-chain disruption, increased fuel price and airspace closures. "These realities require us to remain agile, disciplined and resilient. Yet, they don't change our direction," Walsh said.

Cost control will remain a focus area for IndiGo and the airline will ensure profitable operations on long-haul routes with the introduction of Airbus A350 aircraft from 2028.

"We continue to invest in hiring, training and capability building to support our growth while maintaining our operational reliability and service standards," he said.

Walsh said sustaining customer confidence will remain paramount for the airline. "Our ambition is for IndiGo to be chosen not only for the scale of our network, but also the convenience of our services, the reliability we deliver and the consistent high-quality experience our customers can expect every time they travel with us," he said in his address.

Delhi-NCT to ban diesel, petrol, CNG LGVs from January

S Ronendra Singh
New Delhi

The Commission for Air Quality Management (CAQM) has announced what could become one of the most consequential shifts in India's urban freight policy: From January 2027, Delhi will effectively shut its new vehicle market to diesel, petrol and compressed natural gas (CNG) light goods vehicles (LGVs) of up to 3.5 tonnes, which is also known as N1 category.

The ban then progressively moves into the National Capital Region (NCR) districts of Gurugram, Faridabad, Sonipat, Ghaziabad and Gautam Buddha Nagar (Uttar Pradesh), which may be classified as high vehicle density (HVD) districts from January 2028, highly placed sources told *businessline*.

"No diesel/petrol/CNG LGVs (N1 - 3.5 tonnes GWV or less) shall be permitted to be registered in Delhi-NCR in a phased manner," sources quoting the CAQM's direction dated August 19, said, adding that the ban in the NCR would be effective January 1, 2O27, including HVD districts of NCR.

PHASED BAN

For the N2 category of commercial vehicles (above 3.5 tonnes and up to 7.5 tonnes), no diesel/petrol/CNG would be permitted to be registered in Delhi-NCR, in a phased manner, it said. While the ban in the National Capital Territory (NCT) of Delhi will be effective January 2028, no registration of this vehicle category will be allowed from July 2028 in the HVD districts of NCR.

In all NCR districts other than NCT of Delhi and HVD districts, no diesel/petrol LGVs (N2 — above 3.5 tonnes and up to 7.5 tonnes GVW) would be permitted to be registered from January 2029, the CAQM said.

"These directions shall operate in addition to and not in derogation of the directions, advisories, orders and other measures issued by the Commission under the Act for prevention, control and abatement of air pollution in NCR. In the event of any inconsistency, the provisions of these directions shall prevail to the extent of such inconsistency," a source, quoting the instructions of CAQM, said.

The government of the NCT of Delhi (GNCTD/NCR) should give wide publicity to these directions and take necessary measures for ensuring effective implementation, the instructions added.

To develop strategies for abatement of air pollution caused by vehicular emissions in Delhi-NCT, an expert committee was constituted by the Commission in December 2025 and after extensive consultations with stakeholders, the CAQM noted. The committee, in its interim report submitted in July/August, has observed that within the transport sector, LGVs) — comprising N1 and N2 vehicles account for a notable share of PM 2.5 emissions due to their widespread usage for last-mile goods transport, it said.

The committee recommended the transition of LGVs (NI and N2) to EV in a phased manner in Delhi and HVD districts, and EV/ CNG in NCR districts other than NCT of Delhi and HVD districts, it added.

Domestic air passenger traffic declines 4.8% in July

Our Bureau
New Delhi

This was due to a seasonal slowdown in travel and calibrated capacity deployment by airlines

India's domestic air passenger traffic moderated in July 2026 on a year-on-year basis as airlines continued calibrated capacity deployment despite resilient travel demand.

According to data released by the Directorate General of Civil Aviation (DGCA), scheduled domestic airlines carried around 1.20 crore passengers during July, compared with around 1.26 crore passengers during the corresponding period of last year, a decline of about 4.8 per cent.

Industry observers attributed the decline to the seasonal slowdown in travel as well as calibrated capacity deployment by airlines.

Besides, the data showed that passenger load factors remained robust across most airlines, indicating healthy seat utilisation despite lower passenger traffic.

OPERATIONAL METRICS

Airline-wise, Akasa Air recorded the highest passenger load factor at 91.9 per cent, followed by SpiceJet (84.1 per cent), the Air India Group (83.2 per cent) and IndiGo (82.4 per cent).

In terms of market share, IndiGo held its dominant position among domestic carriers after carrying 80.82 lakh passengers, accounting for 67.4 per cent of the market. Furthermore, the Air India Group — comprising Air India and Air India Express — accounted for a combined market share of 24 per cent after carrying 28.75 lakh passengers. Meanwhile, Akasa Air saw its market share decline to 5.5 per cent after carrying 6.65 lakh passengers.

Other airlines such as SpiceJet accounted for a market share of 1.6 per cent, while Star Air, Fly91, Alliance Air and IndiaOne Air accounted for 0.7 per cent, 0.5 per cent, 0.4 per cent and less than 0.1 per cent respectively. In addition, the overall cancellation rate of scheduled domestic airlines stood at 0.62 per cent, with technical reasons accounting for the largest share of cancellations at 39.9 per cent, followed by operational reasons (27.4 per cent) and weather-related disruptions (22.7 per cent).

COMPLAINT DATA

The DGCA data also showed that airlines received 2,196 passenger complaints, translating into around 1.83 complaints per 10,000 passengers carried.

In terms of operational performance, IndiGo recorded the highest on-time performance (OTP) among major domestic airlines at the country's 10 busiest airports at 91.2 per cent, followed by Akasa Air (90.8 per cent), the Air India Group (88.5 per cent), Alliance Air (76 per cent) and SpiceJet (34.6 per cent).

Across airports, Chennai recorded the highest overall OTP at 96.7 per cent, followed by Bengaluru (94 per cent) and Hyderabad (92.4 per cent). The DGCA attributed the majority of flight delays to reactionary reasons, which accounted for 65 per cent of all delays, followed by operational and air traffic control constraints (7 per cent each), technical and weather-related factors (6 per cent each), passenger-related reasons (3 per cent), airport-related (2 per cent), ramp-related (1 per cent) and miscellaneous (3 per cent).

Company	Prev	Close	Open	High	Low	Qty	52 WH	52 WL	PE	BSE Cl
DJ Mediaprin	104.92	101.95	104.30	106.27	101.00	180.67	124.80	52.00	-	-
DK Enterpri	291.10	287.30	293.65	293.65	285.40	23.82	349.05	191.35	-	-
DLF [2]	669.90	676.15	674.00	682.45	671.95	2371.02	794.25	489.30	46	677.00
DLINK IND [2]	445.75	438.40	443.00	447.00	436.20	158.78	548.95	365.70	15	437.55
DMART	3965.00	3960.00	3973.10	4070.00	3955.10	399.62	4916.30	3528.65	78	3961.00
Dodla Dairy	1102.00	1138.00	1100.80	1156.40	1089.90	66.49	1500.00	964.10	-	-
Dolat Algo	75.13	74.90	76.64	77.30	74.20	373.33	95.76	64.96	-	-
DOLLAR [2]	268.00	272.15	268.90	275.00	265.85	118.16	395.15	220.60	14	273.85
Dolphin Off.	619.25	621.60	613.00	656.25	604.95	130.73	656.25	322.00	-	-
DOMS Ind	2193.10	2209.90	2199.40	2239.60	2195.10	22.21	2770.00	2023.90	-	-
Dr AgarwalHe	501.85	503.10	502.95	505.00	491.70	309.69	568.00	401.00	-	-
Dreamfolks	65.35	68.41	65.98	68.78	65.52	68.63	160.00	56.00	-	-
Dredging Cor	1189.20	1118.30	1199.00	1204.00	1111.50	253.90	1285.00	561.70	80	1120.90
DrReddy'sLa [1]	1170.00	1180.00	1171.20	1183.80	1171.20	1031.11	1414.40	1080.05	148	1181.35
Dwar Sugar [1]	48.28	55.38	48.77	56.45	48.70	42670.09	56.50	32.14	-	55.39
DYNACONS SYS	1116.30	1093.70	1110.10	1129.40	1072.90	57.06	1925.65	781.50	16	1096.25
DYNAMAT.TECH	11735.00	11765.00	11794.00	12050.00	11650.00	20.62	12870.00	6338.85	179	11748.65
Dynamic Cab.	445.95	453.60	446.05	463.00	445.10	343.27	520.00	236.80	-	-
E										
Easy Trip Pl	6.11	6.09	6.19	6.19	6.03	18622.45	10.60	5.77	-	-
Eclerx Ser	1832.90	1804.80	1835.00	1840.80	1797.00	158.77	2492.98	1319.05	34	1804.65
EDELWEISS [1]	122.27	126.62	122.76	130.40	122.76	11818.09	133.90	93.50	26	126.60
EFC (I) Ltd	184.89	190.66	184.80	191.49	184.00	309.14	357.00	171.42	-	-
Eicher Motor [1]	7990.50	8042.00	8047.00	8097.50	7983.00	323.67	8232.80	5881.20	42	8057.10
EID Parry [1]	787.05	810.25	793.80	814.85	787.55	2199.69	1195.90	698.40	-	809.60
EIH [2]	297.65	299.90	298.35	302.95	298.00	111.63	434.35	271.35	29	300.40
Eimco Elecon	2170.80	2180.00	2198.00	2257.50	2124.20	66.76	2380.40	1413.70	32	2182.10
Elantas Beck	11600.50	11599.50	11720.50	11999.00	11523.00	2.60	13200.00	8900.00	-	-
Elec.Mart In	191.24	191.06	192.95	194.00	188.50	1422.55	196.74	84.90	-	-
Elecon Eng [1]	428.85	451.70	430.95	457.00	430.05	900.30	634.95	352.00	34	451.65
Electro Cast [1]	71.76	71.89	71.95	72.99	71.51	602.61	108.30	60.13	50	71.84
Elgi Equipm [1]	637.80	632.45	644.00	644.00	629.15	802.72	641.55	408.95	55	631.05
Elin Elec.	99.65	99.62	99.21	101.20	99.00	65.25	234.00	93.65	-	-
Elitecon Int	16.85	16.79	16.97	17.22	16.70	1793.36	46.40	15.30	-	-
EllenBarrInd	328.50	324.35	336.00	338.20	319.80	406.51	559.80	175.00	-	-
Emami Ltd [1]	400.60	407.40	401.10	413.00	400.65	1301.56	634.65	376.05	20	408.15
Emcure Phr	1891.00	1881.40	1909.00	1926.40	1878.00	126.94	2048.00	1260.00	-	-
Emmvee Photo	316.95	325.60	326.90	339.60	324.10	7476.81	371.55	171.51	-	-
EMPOWER IND	2.23	2.30	2.28	2.31	2.22	3245.97	2.82	1.30	-	-
EMS	394.95	405.00	409.00	413.05	398.80	1731.22	593.85	256.05	-	-
Emudhra	545.20	550.00	558.95	563.00	539.05	166.55	771.05	364.55	-	-
Endurance	2988.60	3001.70	2992.00	3025.00	2976.40	143.44	3078.95	2144.10	54	3000.05
Enginrs Ind [5]	236.90	237.21	237.49	240.60	235.34	1205.40	267.00	163.60	20	237.05
Entero Hlth	1386.80	1408.40	1388.50	1416.90	1388.50	59.40	1467.80	944.00	-	-
Enviro Infr.	196.12	199.01	197.94	201.48	197.94	504.82	276.10	134.71	-	-
Epack Dur.	206.14	203.06	208.00	208.66	202.05	565.98	409.50	196.15	-	-
Epack Prefab	223.05	232.90	226.85	235.00	223.15	876.91	344.00	132.17	-	-
Epigral	1082.20	1120.50	1087.00	1159.00	1087.00	240.96	1911.60	807.00	-	-
EPL	250.80	270.10	252.00	273.00	251.00	6480.00	273.00	176.40	-	-
Equinox Ind.	62.29	63.08	62.29	63.50	62.29	1425.95	105.70	55.36	-	-
Equitas SFB	74.69	76.99	75.00	78.80	74.92	3665.57	83.90	50.00	-	-
ERIS [1]	1348.30	1326.00	1350.00	1351.30	1322.60	80.60	1819.25	1237.90	89	1325.40
Esab India	6057.50	6154.00	6157.00	6241.00	6051.50	6.72	7325.00	4714.55	46	6137.55
Escorts	3054.90	3092.10	3059.60	3110.00	3059.00	76.43	4171.35	2701.00	24	3088.40
Ester Inds [5]	96.08	96.16	97.85	97.85	95.10	73.87	133.00	68.80	-	95.94
Eternal Ltd	320.00	327.95	323.85	328.50	321.35	36661.27	368.45	212.60	-	-
Ethos	2899.90	2867.60	2905.00	2919.90	2849.10	27.81	3245.90	1919.40	-	-
Eureka Forb.	419.85	416.20	426.60	426.60	415.10	205.55	668.30	403.20	-	-
Euro Pratik	268.15	265.75	267.15	271.90	265.00	140.93	390.00	205.10	-	-
EVEREADY (I) [5]	357.15	355.05	357.40	358.75	352.05	73.10	475.20	259.90	16	355.10
EVEREST KANT [2]	111.93	112.80	111.30	114.39	111.00	164.18	154.40	90.20	15	112.30
Excel Ind [5]	1133.25	1114.50	1133.25	1139.50	1096.00	106.52	1347.60	801.00	20	1110.10
ExcelsofTe	71.09	70.88	72.37	72.77	70.31	755.53	142.59	66.40	-	-
Exicom Tele	155.71	157.03	160.50	162.39	156.01	1064.47	182.90	75.60	-	-
EXIDE IND. [1]	459.50	464.10	464.90	467.95	457.05	2283.81	496.00	286.85	33	464.05
Expleo Sol.	887.05	883.15	892.95	899.15	877.00	32.61	1175.10	640.00	-	-
F										
Fabtech Tech	145.48	146.33	147.10	149.82	146.00	198.23	262.80	132.70	-	-
FACT	787.15	772.95	794.50	797.65	771.00	110.82	1059.45	653.00	-	773.85
Fag Bearings [2]	4104.90	4049.30	4152.40	4202.60	4041.00	51.21	4465.00	3519.00	49	4048.05
Faze Three	488.95	490.70	489.00	506.95	486.60	72.51	650.05	322.10	-	-
FDC [1]	344.70	350.15	346.35	351.35	346.35	85.69	528.30	314.75	18	350.65
Fed Mog Goe	471.65	474.00	471.65	480.45	464.10	44.41	578.50	359.00	15	473.10
FedBank Fina	149.80	154.03	150.44	154.85	150.44	1343.07	178.48	119.07	-	-
Federal Bnk [2]	358.80	355.30	361.90	364.20	355.30	4349.44	364.95	188.45	20	355.75
Fermenta Bio	456.10	460.10	456.10	465.00	454.50	39.50	580.45	248.85	-	-
FIEM Inds	2241.00	2190.60	2242.00	2253.50	2187.00	113.03	2668.80	1869.10	22	2191.75
Filatex Fas	0.18	0.18	0.18	0.19	0.17	64582.81	0.68	0.14	-	-
FILATEX INDI [1]	83.15	81.51	83.82	83.94	81.10	1202.24	87.20	36.53	19	81.47
Fine Org [5]	5130.10	5066.20	5130.10	5387.50	5058.60	73.57	5405.00	3856.00	40	5064.25
FINEOTEX CH [1]	44.98	43.55	45.10	45.48	43.21	9825.10	47.13	18.98	-	43.63
Finkurve Fin	71.36	76.32	72.40	77.91	72.05	244.73	134.90	48.02	-	-
Fino Pay.Bnk	147.03	146.16	148.00	149.66	145.25	169.63	339.00	110.03	-	-
Finolex Ind. [2]	158.26	158.61	158.98	159.29	158.00	263.51	223.00	147.40	17	158.70
FinolexCable [2]	1313.70	1291.20	1313.70	1331.00	1250.00	513.14	1375.00	701.00	28	1280.30
FischerMed	38.96	38.95	39.50	39.70	38.50	586.70	1194.40	31.05	-	-
FiveStrBusFn	521.25	527.45	520.00	533.00	520.00	336.61	666.00	338.15	-	-
Flair Writng	248.95	253.00	248.90	254.00	248.85	69.35	348.80	242.90	-	-
Force Mot.	17837.00	17885.00	17951.00	18149.00	17815.00	43.53	26450.00	14911.00	-	-
FORTIS HEALT	911.30	916.80	915.00	920.95	911.05	654.97	1105.00	767.30	347	910.80
Foseco India	5467.00	5506.00	5473.00	5730.00	5431.00	10.73	6819.00	4300.75	47	5529.10
Fractal Anal [1]	834.20	855.25	835.00	873.90	834.50	507.10	1119.60	833.55	70	855.05
FREDUN PHAR	1428.00	1471.80	1422.70	1499.00	1422.70	19.55	1590.00	1400.00	-	-
FrontSprings	1281.40	1293.80	1310.00	1310.00	1279.40	10.74	1869.00	1256.10	-	-
FSL	273.05	272.25	275.75	277.75	271.10	1163.38	381.50	200.60	33	271.70
FSN E Com	327.35	330.35	329.95	332.45	325.40	6631.14	348.00	215.59	-	-
FujiyaPow	483.95	477.50	489.50	494.25	468.00	383.78	494.25	172.00	-	-
Fusion Micro	192.08	203.32	195.00	206.49	193.24	864.78	243.00	136.50	-	-
G										
Gabriel Ind [1]	1438.60	1436.80	1450.00	1475.00	1426.20	128.57	1600.00	795.80	91	1436.35
GAIL	172.50	172.50	172.50	173.59	172.06	3895.72	186.80	134.35	12	172.35
Galaxy Surf	2361.30	2318.20	2392.00	2416.70	2295.00	63.88	2659.35	1512.30	37	2321.35
Gale Preci.	1017.60	1029.60	1032.90	1040.90	1004.70	35.78	1260.00	671.20	-	-
Gallan Metal	575.70	582.40	585.00	595.00	577.55	50.15	946.70	470.80	32	582.00
Gandhar Oil	250.15	254.09	252.50	255.79	246.30	963.33	303.17	115.00	-	-
Ganesh Cons	164.02	162.35	165.99	165.99	161.95	92.67	309.95	152.00	-	-
Ganesh Ecosp	1065.90	1095.50	1081.40	1107.00	1063.30	87.77	1414.00	655.25	54	1087.05
Ganesh Hous	825.90	826.80	825.90	835.00	819.30	18.32	920.15	500.00	-	-
Gareware	759.85	760.25	760.00	776.05	751.20	45.14	863.00	579.45	35	761.45
Garuda Cons.	180.78	182.25	181.50	184.77	181.10	248.71	249.30	130.00	-	-
Garware Hi	7080.50	7109.50	7060.00	7130.00	7031.50	23.07	7990.00	2681.00	-	-
Gateway Dis	54.43	55.10	54.55	55.63	54.05	959.26	70.50	48.10	-	-
GE Vernova	4100.00	4050.10	4140.00	4143.00	4050.10	992.56	5650.00	2523.20	-	-
Geekay Wires	22.62	22.31	22.62	23.23	22.18	160.11	81.25	18.51	-	-
GEMAromatics	175.55	177.39	178.44	182.00	176.20	75.97	349.60	133.00	-	-
Generic Eng	38.39	41.06	39.06	42.90	38.25	433.88	59.96	36.35	-	-
Genesys Intl [5]	182.45	183.55	182.20	187.30	180.00	267.47	441.83	135.47	67	183.50
Genus Pwr [1]	309.30	334.25	310.90	340.90	310.90	16393.46	364.80	210.70	16	334.25
Geojit Fin	80.01	80.79	79.86	82.90	79.80	378.87	85.39	50.86	-	-
GEPowerIn	685.00	666.70	690.05	698.95	663.00	273.81	1084.00	270.90	-	-
GFL	56.76	56.38	57.95	57.95	55.00	236.11	58.05	37.25	-	-
GHCL Text	126.40	123.77	129.44	129.44	122.50	453.72	129.44	65.26	-	-
GIC Housing	137.25	137.64	137.50	138.26	137.10	58.02	183.90	130.15	5	137.50
GICRE [5]	359.60	359.80	361.50	363.00	358.40	675.31	418.00	346.50	7	359.80
Gific Bio Sc [1]	421.75	413.70	421.75	424.35	407.70	72.97	447.85	267.50	56	414.30
Gillette (I)	7505.00	7512.00	7530.00	7582.50	7456.00	14.43	10735.00	7236.20	37	7507.15
GK Energy L	122.13	123.99	122.90	124.61	122.00	273.07	239.60	87.20	-	-
Gland Pharma	2841.30	2820.00	2857.80	2869.80	2811.00	563.34	3039.80	1573.60	-	-
Glaxo Pharma	3032.40	2999.70	3020.00	3049.40	2982.60	304.05	3051.00	2088.00	48	2999.95
Glenmark Pha [1]	2246.50	2332.90	2264.00	2342.00	2252.10	552.16	2471.05	1794.00	45	2325.00
Global Hlth	1417.20	1408.20	1420.00	1429.60	1401.00	120.89	1491.00	956.00	-	-
GLOBUS SPR	905.20	905.10	910.05	915.90	900.00	61.99	1264.20	797.40	27	904.90
GM Breweri	873.50	883.20	877.85	886.00	877.55	17.06	1328.00	669.60	12	883.35
GMM Pfaud [2]	1019.85	1018.20	1030.00	1031.20	1014.00	97.00	1307.50	735.35	71	1024.75
GMR Airports	102.50	100.41	103.02	103.38	100.41	7419.82	115.64	84.11	-	-
GMR P&U Inf.	98.67	98.56	97.50	99.44	97.24	1103.56	136.95	89.00	-	-
GNA	577.15	566.15	572.05	580.00	556.35	391.08	603.10	294.00	18	567.85
GNFC	602.30	592.80	603.00	606.25	591.10	393.00	619.00	364.85	8	593.05
GNG Elect	588.40	624.75	594.00	634.50	589.15	1449.00	689.50	239.00	-	-
Go Digit	252.05	256.70	252.50	259.85	252.50	228.76	381.40	244.20	-	-
GO Fashion	333.60	330.15	335.00	338.15	328.30	81.23	760.90	237.05	-	-
GOCL Corp [2]	398.55	398.25	398.00	403.45	397.50	32.85	460.00	223.60	11	398.15
Godavari Bio	247.15	245.80	247.15	252.15	245.00	122.16	353.00	227.42	-	-
Godawari pwr [1]	246.10	247.88	246.51	249.10	244.72	1275.44	320.00	216.00	19	247.45
Godfrey Phil [2]	2117.60	2103.10	2127.40	2163.80	2095.00	351.12	3945.00	1832.65	25	2105.00
Godrej Agro	573.35	581.65	579.90	584.95	572.05	162.28	774.75	506.70	19	582.05
Godrej Con [1]	930.00	947.00	937.00	948.00	934.00	1961.37	1308.40	906.55	62	943.25
Godrej Ind [1]	1218.00	1223.40	1214.90	1243.90	1204.50	179.65	1443.65	744.00	440	1226.50
Godrej prop [5]	2007.30	2020.00	2011.00	2041.90	2001.30	285.78	2351.60	1434.00	168	2025.00
Gokaldas [5]	797.20	799.90	797.70	809.90	795.00	169.09	953.50	531.60	26	800.15
Gokul Agro [1]	243.02	243.69	246.30	257.99	241.60	4090.02	257.95	150.00	20	244.80
GOKUL REFOIL [2]	40.12	40.43	39.82	40.98	39.82	156.74	47.40	31.07	-	40.29
Goldiam Int [2]	363.70	363.15	366.10	370.00	361.00	413.82	398.00	198.49	118	362.95
Good Luck St [2]	1363.30	1439.40	1385.00	1477.00	1370.00	723.40	1672.75	915.00	26	1439.45
Gopal Snacks	288.45	282.75	289.70	289.70	279.55	228.39	398.00	247.55	-	-
GPPL	165.13	164.81	166.00	168.27	164.16	1659.21	200.00	141.80	15	164.75
GPT Health.	154.06	151.41	153.98	154.19	151.00	107.85	175.00	115.00	-	-
GPT Infra	113.03	112.87	112.50	116.03	111.35	139.18	150.00	96.00	15	113.05
GR Infrapro	883.30	884.00	882.75	888.00	876.60	7.64	1345.00	785.00	-	-
Granules Ind [1]	841.15	841.60	841.70	859.65	838.15	421.05	910.00	452.35	52	841.70
Graphite [2]	717.55	717.05	721.05	728.25	715.00	360.56	802.20	506.00	49	716.75
Grasim Ind. [2]	3270.00	3300.00	3280.00	3310.00	3250.00	1182.21	3412.30	2504.35	267	3295.05
Graur&WeilIn	66.59	66.25	66.66	67.98	66.00	195.56	87.40	66.00	-	-
Gravita Ind [2]	1793.10	1792.80	1814.00	1832.80	1786.10	174.58	1914.40	1267.00	44	1793.50
Great Easte	1315.50	1299.00	1315.50	1315.70	1291.50	455.59	1798.00	922.25	6	1298.80
Greaves Cot [2]	195.03	191.00	196.15	196.55	190.30	984.85	272.00	120.05	20	191.00
Green pwr	9.43	9.54	9.44	9.64	9.41	2060.32	14.76	7.99	-	9.54
Greenpanel I	160.66	160.26	162.30	164.10	157.68	927.00	333.80	157.68	-	-
Greenply Ind [1]	283.90	287.15	282.95	287.60	281.00	71.00	337.00	178.05	41	285.95
GretexCorp	521.70	482.05	526.30	540.95	470.00	615.90	542.80	213.15	-	-
Grind Norton [5]	2052.50	2059.30	2053.00	2082.50	2052.50	17.40	2464.00	1330.00	53	2058.20
GRM Overseas	88.79	86.53	88.25	89.10	86.00	1318.51	517.70	81.95	-	-
GRSE	2638.30	2617.80	2651.00	2655.60	2612.00	279.80	3338.90	1965.00	38	2616.20
GSFC [2]	161.98	160.61	162.40	163.56	160.25	1010.86	220.75	138.80	10	160.70
GSP CropSc	594.10	590.50	594.55	604.00	586.50	169.48	607.80	328.00	-	-
GTL Infra	1.21	1.21	1.22	1.22	1.21	13456.70	1.67	0.96	-	1.21
Guj Fluoro	4689.10	4682.70	4721.10	4760.00	4670.10	263.29	4958.90	2916.60	-	-
Guj. Alkali	664.45	676.85	668.00	683.00	665.15	44.75	815.00	410.00	75	677.60
Guj. Mineral [2]	557.75	561.95	562.00	567.00	558.85	738.58	771.50	400.20	30	561.90
Gujarat Amb [1]	173.83	183.36	174.00	184.67	172.56	2211.34	184.80	101.40	20	183.45
GUJARAT ENER	266.10	267.20	268.25	272.90	266.40	1202.03	452.00	261.25	-	-
Gujarat Hea	438.70	443.15	438.70	444.30	437.00	121.42	668.00	417.25	8	443.00
Gujarat Kidn	157.25	156.41	158.95	162.22	155.33	1155.08	162.22	98.36	-	-
Gujarat Them	372.30	369.25	376.00	376.05	364.00	82.98	479.00	225.05	-	-
GujIndl Pow	171.96	170.18	172.00	176.00	167.24	634.12	204.35	119.95	5	168.00
Gulf oil Lub [2]	1153.70	1151.30	1161.20	1165.00	1141.20	43.88	1331.20	864.50	14	1152.50
Gulshan Poly [1]	182.18	191.92	185.19	192.50	183.51	371.89	227.65	121.75	8	191.95
GYFTR	151.90	159.08	153.40	172.17	152.00	178.16	174.90	139.69	-	-
H										
HAL [5]	5017.00	4998.00	5049.00	5049.00	4972.00	421.51	5149.90	3479.20	36	4995.00
Happi.Minds	410.40	414.30	412.65	431.45	411.35	3342.67	635.00	330.20	-	-
HappyForging	2307.90	2328.20	2334.90	2339.40	2307.70	86.33	2340.00	862.05	-	-
Hardwyn Ind	9.21	9.31	9.29	9.38	9.23	839.48	28.28	8.80	-	-
Hariom Pipe	348.00	347.50	348.15	350.90	345.25	54.57	572.20	268.05	-	-
Harsha Eng	436.55	438.05	439.00	451.00	435.00	192.46	469.00	313.30	-	-
HATHWAY CAB [2]	10.43	10.54	10.46	10.62	10.41	1514.46	15.25	8.79	-	10.54
HATSUN AGRO [1]	930.30	963.70	943.00	977.45	927.55	53.30	1178.80	731.05	59	964.45
Havells [1]	1287.00	1278.00	1287.90	1289.70	1267.60	401.50	1622.70	1123.85	48	1273.00
HBL Engg L	671.85	712.90	674.90	727.05	674.90	3829.87	1122.00	613.00	-	-
HCG	745.25	730.45	743.00	743.00	728.00	120.62	799.35	513.40	161	730.95
HCL Tech. [2]	1324.80	1318.40	1339.70	1345.30	1318.40	1510.87	1770.00	1030.00	20	1319.95
HDB FinSer	681.10	692.35	693.00	712.10	688.10	1759.22	811.80	555.30	-	-
HDFC AMC [5]	2551.70	2624.00	2558.70	2624.00	2553.00	1149.19	2965.00	2206.05	38	2610.00
HDFC Bank [1]	720.00	725.05	725.50	728.30	724.30	17603.81	1020.35	715.05	15	726.50
HDFCLIFE	536.30	542.00	539.90	543.20	536.65	1684.07	814.95	530.45	60	541.20
HEG [2]	708.05	711.95	710.00	718.65	696.10	1404.43	749.00	459.85	63	711.85
Hemisphere	130.39	130.91	131.05	131.69	130.65	313.27	190.69	111.20	-	-
Heranba Ind	162.99	160.39	163.10	164.99	158.23	95.36	379.00	155.38	-	-
HeritageFood [5]	360.00	378.75	361.05	381.40	359.60	595.61	541.60	292.05	29	378.15
Hero Motocor [2]	5709.50	5740.50	5740.00	5740.50	5670.00	298.32	6390.00	4671.55	20	5731.90
HexawareTech	553.30	544.20	553.05	560.95	541.20	117.06	829.40	400.20	-	-
HG Infra	518.55	513.70	515.00	521.00	512.00	150.92	1050.35	430.05	15	513.55
Hikal [2]	214.11	212.26	214.46	215.55	211.53	166.37	282.70	145.95	61	212.50
HIMACHAL FUT [1]	226.53	223.90	227.95	229.80	222.51	10056.12	234.65	59.83	72	223.60
Himadri Spec [1]	750.25	704.20	755.00	767.60	695.50	12482.50	819.50	420.00	45	703.65
Himat.Seide [5]	69.75	71.48	70.10	72.90	69.06	709.98	134.65	68.51	15	71.47
Hind Rectifi [2]	1263.80	1278.40	1263.80	1292.00	1261.20	38.59	1400.00	568.55	77	1279.40
Hind Uni [1]	2020.70	2028.00	2022.90	2043.60	2018.20	1401.47	2734.31	2008.45	44	2036.65
HIND.CONSTN. [1]	19.83	21.22	20.00	21.47	19.99	66092.29	28.48	13.60	-	21.22
HIND.COPPER [5]	554.85	560.10	565.00	574.70	553.60	9758.30	759.20	226.45	45	560.20
Hind.Foods	643.25	653.25	648.10	664.35	645.30	101.12	677.75	442.00	-	-
Hind.oil Exp	153.71	158.20	154.50	160.20	154.05	959.12	188.50	117.80	28	158.10
Hind.Znc [2]	557.00	573.90	570.00	575.00	566.75	6427.83	732.60	418.00	14	573.00
HINDALCO [1]	1038.95	1029.85	1044.00	1048.00	1013.00	4321.76	1179.35	696.85	18	1028.15
Hindware HME	199.19	198.45	199.19	202.68	197.00	95.09	392.70	170.50	-	-
Hitech Pipes	77.06	77.89	77.45	78.25	76.88	411.64	341.25	112.10	11	330.00
HLE Glascoat	315.95	311.80	321.00	321.90	311.00	202.38	661.95	250.00	-	-
HMA Agro Ind	21.94	21.94	22.06	22.21	21.80	1337.09	34.24	20.00	-	-
Home FirstFi	1184.40	1187.40	1184.80	1193.80	1177.90	75.37	1375.00	893.70	-	-
Honasa Cons.	476.60	483.80	479.00	486.30	473.65	851.60	509.80	248.40	-	-
HONEYWELL	36140.00	36715.00	36545.00	37180.00	35850.00	3.04	41469.80	26250.05	58	36765.95
HPCL	366.45	363.20	367.50	368.85	363.20	3121.50	508.45	316.20	60	362.55
HPL	310.80	314.65	312.95	325.00	312.95	178.85	520.10	256.05	23	315.10
Hubtown	180.12	198.81	180.45	205.70	180.01	4731.45	366.00	168.50	47	197.75
HUDCO	188.32	186.05	189.00	189.99	184.48	1804.93	246.90	158.95	9	186.15
Huhtamaki In	268.05	274.60	271.20	277.35	269.25	124.73	330.00	148.60	-	-
HyundaiMotor	2174.50	2227.00	2200.00	2233.70	2180.40	682.79	2890.00	1658.00	-	-
I										
ICE Make Ref	728.25	726.05	734.90	734.90	721.10	19.24	920.00	660.30	-	-
ICICI Bank [2]	1402.00	1411.90	1407.80	1413.00	1403.30	8425.05	1479.90	1187.55	19	1411.50
ICICI PRU AMC	3260.90	3228.90	3262.90	3313.50	3211.10	381.70	3611.00	2530.00	-	-
ICICILombard	1615.70	1625.00	1617.00	1650.00	1617.00	667.66	2064.15	1544.40	33	1629.00
ICICIPruLife	499.50	502.00	501.00	506.35	499.85	637.73	706.50	459.60	43	503.00
ICRA	4893.30	4867.20	4900.00	5000.00	4850.60	24.81	6981.95	4700.00	36	4874.30
IDBI	80.72	81.74	81.30	82.25	81.16	2802.90	118.45	61.05	9	81.61
IDEA CELL	14.07	14.03	14.14	14.19	13.93	232109.94	15.35	6.46	-	14.05
Ideaforge	825.20	806.60	836.00	836.00	791.20	328.08	992.25	366.00	-	-
IDFCFirstBnk	85.49	85.84	85.66	86.50	85.60	13363.45	88.76	58.08	-	-
IEX [1]	123.00	123.35	123.89	125.05	122.48	2988.59	160.30	114.50	23	123.65
IFB	1398.40	1402.90	1409.00	1418.00	1393.00	37.57	2024.90	890.00	36	1399.40
IFCI	81.68	81.76	82.00	82.53	80.37	23214.74	95.75	46.20	-	81.79
IG Petro	476.40	471.05	479.00	483.00	469.00	38.07	532.75	317.80	14	470.45
Igarshi Mot	438.90	446.80	440.00	449.85	439.10	53.06	557.00	272.00	86	446.35
IIFL [2]	630.85	636.70	639.00	649.85	634.00	1236.84	674.95	409.45	18	637.05
IIFL Capital	334.05	333.15	334.15	336.70	333.05	402.50	411.30	240.40	-	-
IKIO Light.	195.17	195.70	195.50	198.80	194.36	97.16	252.90	103.53	-	-
Imagica Wrld	48.52	47.45	48.59	48.65	47.21	280.81	61.90	36.84	-	-
Ind Glycols [5]	1106.30	1101.90	1108.40	1140.00	1096.00	137.21	1222.85	793.95	24	1101.65
Ind.Shelt.Fi	655.25	675.30	660.00	680.00	652.70	212.08	968.75	640.00	-	-
Indegene	565.60	566.70	569.95	576.00	562.00	1256.70	596.80	414.00	-	-
IndHumPip [2]	363.20	368.35	364.30	371.05	359.60	26.98	431.00	280.00	21	368.25
India Nippon [5]	1110.10	1100.80	1110.10	1125.00	1090.80	16.63	1278.65	653.25	24	1097.70
India Pesti.	137.29	138.06	138.15	139.09	137.35	68.55	245.84	125.00	-	-
Indiabulls	26.47	25.75	26.50	26.60	25.54	8152.45	32.50	8.90	-	-
IndiaCements	369.70	370.65	366.50	375.10	366.50	81.02	489.65	342.05	95	370.70
IndiaMart In	1734.30	1749.20	1736.00	1761.90	1736.00	64.54	2685.00	1730.00	-	-
Indian Bank	873.15	871.00	877.15	883.80	871.00	530.22	1000.05	642.80	9	873.00
Indian Htl [1]	723.35	735.85	729.00	737.10	725.75	1766.03	811.90	565.25	59	734.00
INDIAN MET	1457.90	1421.90	1465.00	1482.00	1406.30	135.41	1674.90	814.75	15	1427.55
IndianOilCo	136.30	135.90	137.00	137.12	135.28	7026.47	188.90	130.30	7	135.90
IndianOverBk	33.18	33.16	33.23	33.40	33.14	1140.19	41.73	31.18	11	33.15
IndiaTour De	683.00	687.55	685.85	695.60	683.05	62.13	821.45	368.00	70	687.35
IndigoPaints	1148.80	1130.70	1151.10	1167.00	1124.10	117.39	1345.90	708.05	-	-
IndiqubeSpac	192.17	189.15	196.20	198.20	184.49	196.42	243.80	131.15	-	-
Indo Borax	433.85	498.15	439.00	509.90	431.00	6099.64	509.90	224.00	-	-
INDO COUNT [2]	443.80	435.10	441.40	453.25	430.55	1040.98	463.80	217.25	50	435.30
Indo Farm Eq	137.16	138.06	138.00	140.00	137.00	124.87	271.69	110.70	-	-
Indo Rama	56.29	61.29	56.91	63.45	56.02	1356.54	74.94	28.70	14	61.30
IndocoRem [2]	217.19	222.68	217.51	226.78	217.51	158.49	332.15	163.70	96	221.55
INDO-MIM	967.95	919.55	965.00	965.00	907.30	3493.81	989.90	700.00	-	-
Indosolar	293.15	290.45	293.00	295.95	285.30	79.17	437.30	282.80	-	-
INDOSTAR	250.55	251.40	252.00	252.95	248.05	79.23	292.40	178.50	-	251.60
IndoTech Tra	3709.80	3727.80	3750.00	3895.20	3601.00	67.20	3980.60	1100.00	40	3722.40
Indrapra Gas [2]	152.64	150.55	153.69	153.69	150.20	1967.13	223.55	141.60	18	150.50
Indraprastha	374.45	376.80	375.00	378.25	371.65	167.04	640.05	342.35	18	376.95
IndSwifLab	322.06	333.51	326.00	339.00	323.24	784.97	350.00	87.00	43	333.25
IndusInd BK	1016.70	1008.00	1013.00	1014.50	1002.00	858.06	1077.80	710.85	63	1003.05
IndusTowers	372.40	368.80	373.75	373.85	367.35	3258.89	481.50	312.55	-	-
Info Edge [2]	1378.40	1360.90	1385.30	1390.10	1355.30	1278.11	1439.95	909.20	75	1359.00
Infobeans Te	157.76	156.78	159.34	167.23	155.10	614.03	1030.00	120.33	-	-
INFOSYS [5]	1119.80	1130.00	1143.00	1144.70	1125.70	8559.84	1727.85	984.00	15	1130.20
Ingersoll	4641.40	4705.60	4688.00	4714.00	4641.10	19.42	4768.35	3070.00	54	4709.00
Innova Cap	1039.75	1084.20	1039.55	1120.00	1039.55	125.05	1120.00	622.00	-	-
Inox Grn Enr	175.89	175.08	174.51	178.30	173.00	348.91	189.00	165.00	-	-
Inox India	1930.30	1923.60	1929.50	1950.00	1914.00	49.69	2119.80	1065.00	-	-
Inox Wind	73.74	73.90	74.00	75.14	73.56	5913.00	159.25	72.73	24	73.90
INSECTCID	613.55	606.55	616.50	619.95	603.70	18.09	881.75	525.90	15	606.00
Insolati Ene	93.31	93.42	95.40	98.29	92.78	1494.25	161.81	79.75	-	-
Integra Ess.	1.20	1.14	1.18	1.25	1.14	7538.11	2.08	1.01	-	-
INTELLECT [5]	678.45	685.70	684.10	695.90	684.00	252.17	1244.90	594.65	43	685.65
InterarchBui	1703.40	1688.30	1720.00	1726.60	1685.00	53.43	2762.60	1600.00	-	-
InterGlobeAv	5193.00	5165.00	5235.00	5235.00	5152.00	380.69	6170.00	3894.80	-	5162.55
Intl Gemm In	338.40	335.80	342.00	344.40	335.20	330.86	392.00	287.00	-	-
Inventu Know	1812.30	1791.60	1826.90	1836.00	1771.70	87.77	1933.00	1262.00	-	-
IOL Chem [2]	156.92	163.75	158.45	164.70	158.35	2054.87	179.65	67.14	27	163.80
Ion Exch	372.95	373.10	376.00	376.50	370.80	302.63	486.00	312.70	-	-
Ipca Lab [1]	1900.70	1900.10	1922.00	1928.40	1880.40	236.59	1945.00	1252.95	38	1900.25
IRB INFRA [1]	18.98	18.95	19.10	19.12	18.91	5795.43	23.94	18.50	-	18.94
IRCON	122.62	126.54	123.00	128.00	123.00	2980.87	189.50	114.50	-	-
IREDA	113.92	114.90	114.49	115.80	114.33	3039.80	163.35	108.65	-	-
IRFC	85.18	86.47	85.45	87.20	85.30	8434.19	137.17	85.00	-	-
IRIS Cloth.	58.62	59.27	59.71	60.00	58.13	2295.14	60.18	26.35	-	-
IRM Energy	286.80	285.60	287.10	289.95	284.00	52.72	393.00	165.40	-	-
IRTC	488.35	485.90	490.00	495.00	485.15	1104.98	739.00	485.15	-	-
ISGEC Hvy	756.60	761.75	756.65	778.10	756.25	81.43	1113.90	683.95	-	-
ITC [1]	267.05	271.65	268.20	271.65	265.00	28272.80	426.50	265.10	18	271.25
ITC Hotels	163.49	166.12	164.00	167.90	162.50	1264.19	253.67	137.30	-	-
ITI	279.95	279.50	279.75	281.80	278.10	187.73	372.95	232.90	-	279.50
IValue Infos	278.65	279.65	277.90	287.20	277.80	194.57	340.00	207.35	-	-
Ixigo	168.79	170.45	170.50	172.59	168.11	1166.48	339.15	151.27	-	-
Izmo Ltd	871.55	866.45	873.95	889.90	862.05	79.51	1380.00	403.75	-	866.05
J										
J KUMAR INFR [5]	504.70	503.65	504.85	509.75	501.00	45.96	684.90	424.60	10	503.05
J&K Bank [1]	148.95	148.19	149.18	152.30	147.80	1401.70	202.00	97.40	7	148.25
J.K.INDUSTRI [2]	374.85	373.40	377.00	379.70	372.50	440.31	611.60	317.55	15	373.80
Jagran Prak [2]	61.54	61.79	62.19	62.30	61.23	248.88	79.68	59.10	6	61.75
Jagson Phar [2]	230.28	232.99	229.54	234.13	229.54	68.01	264.65	154.90	33	233.75
Jai Corp [1]	98.68	100.53	99.56	101.17	99.56	218.91	178.00	88.35	20	100.50
JaiBalaj.Ind	66.39	66.08	66.50	67.89	64.80	887.36	668.00	81.00	-	-
JAIN IRRIG [2]	28.05	28.22	28.25	28.42	27.91	1167.61	58.97	26.13	-	28.19
Jain Resourc	288.85	299.75	290.15	307.50	290.15	2350.23	593.95	247.57	-	-
Jamna Aut [1]	120.50	121.43	121.50	122.39	120.12	875.24	152.50	89.80	19	121.40
Jana SFB	571.15	562.85	578.00	584.00	561.15	262.67	593.00	330.00	-	-
Jaro InsofT	439.50	440.05	437.05	446.75	437.05	105.01	890.00	383.50	-	-
Jash Engg	485.15	481.50	485.90	488.15	480.00	34.44	572.85	327.10	-	-
JAY NECO IND	91.22	93.68	92.10	95.45	91.34	7622.64	117.10	57.42	16	93.58
JayBh Maru [2]	125.60	127.19	127.00	128.28	126.71	110.67	206.50	75.00	10	127.10
Jaykay Enter	147.61	145.68	148.57	149.92	145.00	175.81	219.70	115.52	-	-
Jayshree Tea [5]	93.88	100.81	94.53	102.40	94.00	419.57	103.00	70.62	-	100.06
JBM Auto [1]	618.65	623.35	620.00	631.20	620.00	165.01	790.00	477.00	96	623.35
JeenaSikhoLi	497.60	506.20	499.50	518.95	499.40	618.64	849.50	492.00	-	-
JG Chem.	627.95	619.90	629.00	639.90	604.10	194.26	663.10	298.40	-	-
JIN POLY INV	987.70	954.40	995.00	1009.90	950.00	23.98	1480.00	660.00	1	954.25
Jindal Drill [5]	635.10	628.70	639.00	639.00	618.00	520.10	693.95	440.00	11	630.40
Jindal Saw [1]	268.70	269.75	268.95	275.55	268.95	717.36	281.00	153.20	33	269.60
Jindal Sta [2]	724.00	718.40	729.90	731.20	716.00	238.91	883.25	652.45	22	718.45
Jindal Ste [1]	1115.00	1118.90	1120.10	1142.00	1108.40	992.91	1306.00	943.50	33	1116.05
Jindal Wor [1]	35.58	35.10	35.59	36.00	34.85	966.59	42.35	17.99	-	35.13
JioFin Servi	243.15	244.60	244.00	247.25	243.75	8819.15	333.70	223.30	-	-
JK Cement	5276.00	5266.00	5302.00	5349.00	5243.00	21.17	7565.00	4670.05	40	5257.55
JK Lakshmi [5]	558.25	557.90	558.25	563.85	555.05	95.72	990.85	544.00	17	557.70
JK PAPER	379.00	389.60	382.00	391.80	379.30	328.86	444.45	305.35	26	389.45
JM Financial [1]	126.30	129.16	127.00	130.69	127.00	3167.78	199.75	112.30	22	129.15
JNK India	454.00	450.35	454.05	459.20	445.00	109.02	558.00	200.92	-	-
John Cockeri	8010.50	7834.00	8091.00	8225.50	7762.50	15.48	10871.50	4955.00	-	-
JPPOWER	17.03	17.10	17.24	17.29	17.07	22273.78	24.45	13.14	14	17.11
JSW Cement	123.66	125.13	124.19	126.48	123.98	656.73	162.15	106.65	-	-
JSW Dulux L	3094.20	3086.10	3145.00	3145.00	3076.00	14.81	3745.00	2658.70	-	-
JSW ENERGY	543.95	542.00	545.95	547.00	540.10	1459.73	617.30	428.00	110	542.45
JSW Infra	329.90	329.85	332.00	334.70	328.75	1462.46	355.80	233.42	-	-
JSWSL [1]	1285.80	1299.70	1298.50	1310.60	1281.50	3416.35	1333.30	1022.00	42	1296.00
JTL Indus.	72.18	74.61	73.00	74.95	72.69	1430.10	87.20	40.25	-	-
Jub.Ingrevia	708.40	720.40	710.00	729.50	704.80	257.22	795.00	537.30	-	-
Jub.Pharmova	868.00	871.05	871.00	886.35	863.85	181.30	1184.80	786.05	-	-
JUBL FOOD [2]	498.30	507.30	504.85	510.90	499.10	1576.26	667.35	408.50	130	507.90
JUNIPER GREEN	253.71	273.76	252.81	275.52	251.73	7029.43	275.52	232.11	-	-
Juniper Hot	197.79	205.21	194.00	207.00	194.00	509.83	312.50	188.50	-	-
Jupiter Life	320.55	317.70	324.00	324.00	315.00	45.84	1625.00	301.70	-	-
Jupiter Wag	248.50	248.10	249.40	253.95	247.10	783.98	372.85	235.65	-	-
JUSTDIAL	660.45	680.65	660.50	686.60	659.20	232.25	878.70	486.05	11	680.05
JYOTHY LAB [1]	207.88	208.46	207.89	210.37	207.00	491.37	352.15	188.00	27	208.60
Jyoti CNC Au	950.65	949.75	949.00	965.85	943.05	879.08	1055.90	580.10	-	-
JYOTI RESINS	864.55	849.90	877.70	877.70	840.05	36.31	884.95	840.05	-	-
Jyoti Struct [2]	10.71	10.69	10.78	10.87	10.62	2692.65	17.41	7.92	-	10.70
K										
KMC SPE HOSP	136.95	136.94	138.32	139.79	136.00	116.88	148.00	134.70	-	-
K.P.R. MILL [1]	1126.20	1153.20	1132.80	1160.00	1126.10	245.83	1332.00	796.05	61	1153.80
KabraExtrus [5]	500.80	529.10	506.10	541.00	506.10	491.12	540.45	171.00	-	528.70
Kajaria Cere [1]	1208.90	1220.70	1212.50	1227.40	1208.00	87.72	1305.85	870.00	36	1220.60
Kalpataru Lt	273.60	288.35	275.70	290.00	274.30	88.46	429.30	258.00	-	-
KalpataruPro	1376.60	1387.60	1382.50	1404.00	1378.20	159.37	1479.60	1007.10	-	-
Kalyan Jwl.	595.20	596.00	600.70	605.05	592.65	5139.53	648.95	327.05	-	-
KALYANI STEL [5]	875.55	856.65	884.00	884.00	851.20	36.69	981.40	575.00	14	855.35
Kamat Hotels	189.42	190.83	193.00	193.50	187.52	73.53	368.95	142.05	13	190.10
Kanpur Plast	256.59	266.18	255.60	269.00	242.20	77.32	272.20	151.25	-	-
Kansai Nero [1]	201.37	201.51	202.37	204.59	200.53	151.21	262.00	158.00	24	201.35
Kapston Fac.	523.40	524.80	523.40	534.30	522.00	28.64	600.00	237.20	-	-
Karnataka Bk	324.05	335.05	324.75	337.90	320.60	6192.28	337.50	169.05	9	334.35
KarurVysya B [2]	331.05	334.10	331.20	341.95	331.20	2334.67	351.80	201.80	12	334.25
KAVERI SEED [2]	771.35	773.40	768.00	775.85	766.00	102.00	1241.95	705.80	17	769.20
KAYA L	338.45	374.10	339.95	385.00	336.55	245.36	486.90	225.00	-	375.55
KaynesTech	3823.30	3815.00	3826.10	3897.00	3800.00	1015.46	7705.00	2995.00	-	-
KCP [1]	151.39	165.08	151.00	167.35	150.60	1075.02	212.45	125.10	18	164.95
KDDL	3950.10	3942.70	3950.10	4000.00	3910.00	17.81	4150.00	1976.25	58	3956.50
KEC Inter [2]	423.50	424.10	425.00	435.95	418.00	1571.65	938.00	422.10	37	424.75
KEI Inds [2]	5681.10	5675.00	5720.00	5779.00	5643.50	316.30	5931.40	3730.00	54	5661.30
KELLTONTEC [1]	13.34	13.60	13.40	13.76	13.40	1145.89	28.14	13.10	-	13.59
KennametIInd	3616.10	3719.60	3634.20	3749.80	3617.00	75.65	3775.00	2712.40	-	-
Kernex Micro	1875.00	1837.00	1890.00	1895.40	1830.00	276.62	2585.85	850.60	17	1836.85
Kewal Kiran	517.95	518.60	520.25	524.00	516.55	17.95	594.35	408.75	24	518.55
KFIN Tech	948.00	961.00	963.00	973.70	936.80	2182.94	1215.00	784.95	-	-
Khaitan Chm	57.65	56.65	57.70	58.50	55.60	163.63	135.80	42.92	-	-
Kilburn Engg	363.50	357.65	365.00	366.95	354.05	175.28	544.85	332.40	-	-
Kilos oil [2]	2079.90	2150.10	2094.00	2177.00	2080.30	429.27	2720.35	855.95	68	2148.50
KIMS	788.65	790.00	800.50	800.50	787.00	225.53	858.00	575.80	-	-
Kingfa	5780.00	5857.50	5859.50	5924.50	5704.50	19.95	6174.75	3600.00	35	5864.50
KIOCL	377.50	385.40	379.10	395.60	379.10	161.80	634.35	290.55	-	384.95
KIRI DYES	431.30	461.30	435.00	479.95	434.00	5952.45	778.00	334.40	4	461.00
KIRL.BROS. [2]	1951.40	1918.20	1954.30	1978.00	1915.00	34.36	2192.30	1333.00	55	1919.95
Kirlosk.Elec	131.63	130.69	132.70	134.08	129.12	156.59	100.80	26.95	24	-
Kirlosk.Pne	736.70	739.80	737.10	748.40	722.50	317.11	2197.10	722.50	-	-
KirloskarFer	430.15	444.05	431.00	445.45	428.30	85.36	513.00	408.00	-	-
KITEX GARMEN [1]	124.28	124.73	124.50	127.58	123.15	688.86	232.65	123.30	87	124.35
KM Sugar Ml [2]	32.63	35.30	33.01	36.00	33.01	1974.66	35.98	22.55	7	35.20
KNACK PACK	199.60	209.17	201.00	210.94	199.00	1733.97	222.00	180.33	-	-
Knowledg.Mar	2748.40	2691.80	2765.00	2765.00	2677.00	53.17	3758.50	1409.00	-	-
KNR CONST [2]	127.37	127.14	127.95	129.09	126.50	1147.37	219.45	108.55	32	127.05
KOHINORFOODS	31.27	34.81	32.10	35.75	30.95	1740.17	36.99	19.00	-	34.95
KOKUYOCMLN [1]	80.24	79.80	80.69	81.48	79.40	83.70	128.45	70.00	36	79.68
KOLTEPATIL	456.70	465.90	462.90	499.95	462.90	752.54	556.65	292.55	24	466.20
Kotak Mah Bk [1]	390.25	397.35	393.60	399.55	393.15	9258.92	452.98	345.40	27	398.50
KOTHARI PROD [5]	133.39	134.30	135.61	135.61	132.12	41.11	0.15	0.05	-	-
KothariSugar	27.22	30.25	27.88	31.40	27.68	1120.93	15.85	4.45	-	-
KP Energy	268.20	256.65	268.20	271.00	255.15	442.67	463.25	237.90	-	-
KPI Grn Enr	308.35	307.05	309.20	314.55	306.00	1086.52	542.25	301.20	-	-
KPIT Tech	589.10	592.90	595.00	601.25	590.05	641.74	1328.00	543.00	-	-
KRBL. [1]	399.60	397.25	401.00	405.10	392.00	591.86	495.00	274.75	12	398.70
Krishana Ph.	194.30	196.52	194.90	199.99	193.80	874.32	748.55	126.25	-	-
KrishivalFoo	366.25	393.55	368.20	398.70	368.20	110.33	508.00	282.30	-	-
Krishna def	1077.80	1037.90	1083.90	1094.90	1026.00	152.48	1400.00	665.00	-	-
KRN Heat Ex.	1501.20	1518.30	1544.00	1546.00	1511.00	128.05	1598.20	589.80	-	-
Kronox Lab	155.16	186.19	155.01	186.19	155.01	5889.35	186.19	96.00	-	-
Kross	198.27	210.36	199.25	214.89	199.25	773.96	237.60	150.52	-	-
Krsnaa Dia.	536.00	550.00	535.00	551.50	535.00	43.67	894.40	515.00	-	-
Krystal Int.	629.45	681.35	635.00	689.00	620.70	688.37	729.50	500.00	-	-
KSB	807.10	802.50	807.10	813.85	789.90	125.49	1028.30	666.65	-	-
KSE [1]	197.69	196.80	198.50	198.50	193.21	119.47	284.90	174.00	14	196.65
KSH Internat	1006.05	1011.30	1019.00	1027.80	1002.15	137.59	1059.90	330.00	-	-
KSolves Ind	272.65	270.40	272.65	278.95	266.90	46.16	354.85	245.75	-	-
Kuantum Pap.	78.70	74.99	76.25	77.50	74.21	345.20	122.09	65.01	-	-
KUSUMGAR	566.35	572.50	569.90	577.50	556.05	520.67	659.50	548.00	-	-
Kwality Phar	3452.40	3630.30	3490.00	3708.90	3474.70	71.71	3744.00	1561.00	-	-
Kwality Wall	37.71	43.47	38.00	44.30	37.75	101299.69	44.30	22.24	-	-
L										
L & T [2]	4041.30	4081.00	4050.50	4084.90	4048.30	1056.06	4440.00	3288.65	42	4072.00
L&T Finance	315.40	314.75	317.05	320.00	313.70	3115.45	338.60	204.26	-	-
Lal path lab	1887.20	1889.40	1901.30	1908.00	1873.40	308.17	1989.35	1272.00	56	1888.50
Lancor Hold.	27.22	28.91	27.76	29.30	27.21	303.28	33.80	18.12	-	-
Landmark Car	510.25	509.20	512.15	519.20	503.00	109.83	662.80	339.50	-	-
LA-OPALA RG [2]	187.24	178.35	182.05	182.05	176.50	396.33	279.55	163.00	21	178.05
LASER POWER &	322.50	328.40	324.90	335.40	321.30	1655.80	341.95	250.00	-	-
Latent View	276.50	281.75	277.30	285.50	277.30	452.58	517.50	248.00	-	-
Laurus Labs [2]	1801.80	1825.00	1819.00	1832.00	1813.80	1315.07	1870.00	822.85	113	1823.00
Laxmi Organ.	174.31	174.51	175.09	177.50	174.00	394.25	241.00	107.60	-	-
LaxmiDent	195.77	198.18	197.99	202.43	195.57	119.30	377.05	155.88	-	-
LaxmiIndFin	130.89	132.90	132.50	136.62	131.00	230.89	180.90	71.06	-	-
LEAP INDIA	159.69	166.66	162.78	169.80	162.50	18931.62	171.25	143.00	-	-
LEMONTREE	108.08	107.96	108.70	109.10	107.58	3172.64	180.60	99.70	67	108.00
Lenskart Sol	639.60	654.80	646.70	657.90	638.85	6214.55	657.90	356.10	-	-
LG Balkrish	1603.00	1599.60	1603.00	1609.00	1585.00	20.74	2096.95	1229.20	17	1600.00
LG Electroni	1645.10	1632.80	1660.00	1687.30	1628.00	590.19	1755.00	1304.10	-	-
LIC	413.10	419.00	415.05	424.40	412.95	19032.51	936.95	385.90	-	-
LIC Housing [2]	497.00	508.05	500.00	511.45	498.20	2938.87	598.00	459.05	5	507.60
Lincoln Phar	609.50	622.60	612.55	625.00	612.55	18.26	770.00	439.95	13	622.35
LINDEINDIA	6702.50	6695.00	6780.00	6782.50	6679.50	8.64	8042.70	5652.75	104	6694.75
Lloyds Engg	92.90	92.25	93.55	93.70	91.62	4581.96	99.75	37.40	-	-
Lloyds Met.	1919.00	1891.40	1928.00	1931.00	1885.10	298.08	2125.00	1042.90	-	-
LMW	19665.00	19570.00	19650.00	19800.00	19363.00	3.20	20151.00	11920.00	-	-
LOHIA CORP	561.30	539.85	552.00	576.95	536.30	1614.89	580.40	461.00	-	-
Looyds Ent.	78.57	78.55	78.99	79.98	77.92	3763.92	84.70	40.69	-	-
LT Foods	429.50	431.00	432.60	437.00	423.50	440.24	480.00	333.15	-	-
LTIMindtree	4564.40	4553.00	4600.00	4657.00	4517.00	767.53	6429.50	3528.00	-	-
LTTS [2]	3540.90	3579.10	3594.60	3663.90	3570.00	157.11	4746.95	3030.00	30	3578.45
Lumax Ind	5629.00	5808.00	5629.00	5877.00	5629.00	21.99	6969.90	3741.80	29	5802.25
Lumax Tech [2]	1987.10	2043.70	2008.00	2053.00	1996.30	143.58	2109.30	1040.30	66	2045.15
Lupin Ltd. [2]	2225.00	2201.50	2228.30	2237.70	2201.50	531.96	2530.00	1881.80	15	2203.10
LUXIND [2]	1217.40	1201.00	1225.00	1237.00	1196.10	16.77	1837.95	805.05	35	1201.50
M										
M&M FinSer [2]	389.60	382.45	392.00	397.50	379.55	2120.38	415.00	251.70	16	382.45
Macpower CNC	1943.20	1945.90	1979.80	1979.80	1912.20	45.19	2000.00	761.00	-	-
Macrote.Dev.	1210.00	1240.00	1220.00	1246.50	1215.50	952.80	1344.95	650.80	-	-
MadhavCopper	58.36	58.46	58.41	59.49	58.00	68.33	93.20	42.00	-	-
Madhya Bh.Ag	163.63	163.41	163.36	166.80	162.14	307.44	610.90	109.75	-	-
Magadh Suagr	580.55	620.60	594.90	632.00	583.25	275.97	630.00	413.00	17	620.15
MagellanicCl	29.72	29.57	29.89	30.34	29.23	2470.92	90.50	19.40	-	-
MAH HOLIDAY	219.48	221.05	220.00	223.08	212.65	60.45	379.85	208.40	22	220.40
Mah Logis	406.25	406.65	405.00	409.90	402.00	93.52	450.90	278.00	59	406.80
Mah&Mah [5]	3415.00	3424.80	3424.00	3456.40	3401.00	1279.09	3840.00	2896.30	26	3440.65
Mah.seamless [5]	613.90	610.60	617.20	618.60	608.20	187.92	690.00	500.00	11	610.90
MAHINDRALIFE	373.70	377.20	373.70	380.85	372.20	56.45	428.35	288.00	40	376.80
Maithan All	989.25	978.00	994.00	994.20	975.00	18.19	1210.00	831.50	10	978.55
Man ind [5]	643.05	676.90	646.00	699.00	643.00	1829.82	699.00	302.30	21	677.95
Man Infra [2]	109.99	110.29	110.59	111.11	108.51	1279.27	179.75	77.75	29	110.00
Manali Petro [5]	72.80	77.73	74.18	78.50	72.92	4389.60	78.62	39.15	18	77.91
Manappuram G [2]	340.00	349.25	346.05	351.60	345.00	8327.42	381.40	245.10	20	349.00
MandB Eng	278.50	278.10	281.95	283.50	275.30	76.42	535.90	223.05	-	-
Mangal Cred.	222.03	224.55	228.62	232.50	222.09	201.87	287.27	152.06	-	-
Mangalam Cem	894.80	981.85	903.70	1018.90	903.70	2731.23	1023.90	679.80	21	982.70
MangalElec	266.40	263.10	271.75	272.15	262.50	29.22	573.70	206.26	-	-
MANIPAL HEALTH	744.80	724.35	754.00	757.70	719.00	1425.18	757.70	625.45	-	-
Mankind Phr	2394.00	2385.00	2413.00	2413.00	2373.40	307.63	2674.00	1909.70	-	-
ManojVaibGem	148.21	146.84	148.25	151.06	146.15	60.05	214.79	129.10	-	-
Manomay Tex	214.11	211.44	218.27	218.30	207.02	109.30	259.88	160.25	-	-
Manorama Ind	1935.00	1958.70	1935.00	1974.90	1911.10	433.40	2043.00	1060.60	-	-
Marath NXTG [5]	359.30	354.60	359.65	365.00	352.10	90.49	689.90	342.90	13	354.25
MARICOLTD [1]	850.00	858.35	859.00	861.00	849.80	970.87	889.95	690.40	68	853.40
Marine Elec.	371.45	373.25	376.45	395.00	370.50	1145.15	395.00	150.86	-	-
MARKSANS [1]	327.00	320.85	328.50	328.55	318.50	1960.21	345.70	156.00	45	320.60
Marsons Lt	108.37	112.15	109.30	113.40	107.55	5140.61	175.40	100.25	-	-
Maruti Udyog [5]	13690.00	13809.00	13758.00	13826.00	13681.00	186.27	17371.60	12202.10	31	13788.60
MASFIN	300.45	300.25	300.00	301.95	299.90	105.58	358.40	276.00	14	300.60
Mastek [5]	1716.80	1693.50	1726.90	1760.50	1690.00	102.32	2625.50	1334.00	25	1693.40
Mawana Sugar	128.72	140.10	130.99	143.15	129.30	1919.18	142.95	75.00	16	140.30
Max Estate	490.15	499.85	504.95	505.00	491.10	199.85	510.00	305.45	-	-
Max Healthca	997.00	997.90	998.00	1001.80	987.70	1658.84	1256.00	903.00	-	-
Max India	148.46	152.11	150.99	152.44	149.00	115.27	241.57	120.00	-	-
MAYUR UNIQ. [5]	758.15	776.05	761.95	801.65	760.00	183.47	906.35	471.80	15	777.65
Mazagon Dock	2563.80	2570.00	2567.50	2583.20	2552.00	467.90	3061.40	2057.40	-	-
MCLEOD RUSSE [5]	47.58	49.95	49.95	49.95	47.10	657.59	78.28	28.70	6	50.69
MCX [2]	2973.00	3126.00	3020.00	3133.20	3006.00	3923.22	3479.80	1461.00	66	3121.00
Medi Assist	349.80	355.90	351.50	359.95	348.55	166.90	575.55	293.00	-	-
Medicam.Bio	228.73	243.75	229.87	244.40	227.61	49.19	447.65	212.40	-	-
Medplus Hlth	649.30	656.30	650.00	663.00	648.00	1206.02	1022.20	648.00	-	-
Meesho	196.88	209.51	197.07	210.00	195.58	34035.19	254.40	125.56	-	-
MeghamaniOrg	61.87	61.43	62.14	62.85	61.26	785.13	88.88	36.50	-	-
MEGHNA INFRA	701.05	704.95	709.20	713.95	687.40	59.63	721.00	660.00	-	-
MERCURY EV	37.63	39.47	37.99	41.39	37.61	638.61	41.39	30.16	-	-
Metro Brand	924.70	914.30	925.00	932.30	912.00	15.69	1340.40	883.00	-	-
METROPOLIS [2]	555.00	540.80	554.90	554.90	536.60	597.19	608.95	413.00	63	540.65
MFSL [2]	1546.10	1575.00	1550.10	1585.30	1550.10	434.78	1891.35	1408.05	-	1574.80
MGL	1128.00	1137.80	1140.00	1153.70	1130.00	230.81	1377.05	902.00	16	1136.20
Midhani	428.15	420.50	432.00	432.55	419.25	498.94	456.90	266.70	59	420.70
MILKY MIST	199.65	184.89	207.80	211.80	181.50	56542.17	211.80	165.00	-	-
MINDACORP [2]	738.90	743.30	742.50	756.60	740.00	554.06	769.00	468.65	68	742.55
MINERAL&METL [1]	62.15	66.27	62.84	67.58	62.75	42448.88	78.38	51.25	-	66.30
Mirza Intl [2]	31.07	31.07	31.00	31.85	31.00	114.68	43.84	24.78	-	31.02
MM Forgings	657.80	638.95	660.10	669.45	635.00	176.80	690.10	276.05	24	639.40
MMP Ind	391.50	406.35	394.00	413.00	386.65	223.37	413.00	185.20	-	-
Mnkcmil Ltd [1]	124.74	126.91	126.50	129.00	123.31	406.01	182.80	95.35	33	126.80
Modis Navnir	410.15	402.70	414.00	420.00	399.15	54.32	429.05	276.00	-	-
MOIL	253.05	252.75	254.50	256.25	252.00	806.37	405.10	242.65	17	252.95
MOLBIO DIAG	1036.65	1036.65	1046.90	1083.50	1020.05	2213.70	1177.00	926.35	-	-
MOLDTKPACK [5]	669.85	682.40	672.95	685.00	671.10	19.03	870.00	453.80	30	683.90
Monarch Netw	385.15	391.85	386.00	393.30	384.05	93.36	406.95	235.45	-	-
Montecarlo	545.45	541.50	545.50	549.25	540.00	50.85	865.00	465.00	11	542.50
Morepen Lab. [2]	88.42	96.47	88.66	97.50	88.30	47564.14	97.30	33.44	48	96.39
Moschip Tech	206.24	206.31	207.89	209.15	205.80	599.32	288.45	146.80	-	-
Mothersn Sum	39.26	39.18	39.73	39.73	38.70	10128.99	53.59	35.70	-	-
MOTILALOFS [1]	942.10	973.40	946.90	989.55	942.15	2367.40	1097.00	616.05	56	971.10
Motisons Jwl	16.62	16.59	16.73	16.84	16.40	34860.50	20.81	10.62	-	-
MPHASIS	2424.50	2430.00	2452.10	2468.70	2415.30	422.91	3035.15	2033.65	29	2427.50
MPS	2929.60	2917.40	2949.90	2974.00	2884.10	32.85	2980.00	1340.00	35	2922.95
MRF	133630.00	134000.00	133660.00	134185.00	133285.00	2.62	163500.00	122000.00	24	133965.20
MRPL	176.51	173.98	176.00	177.20	169.34	17133.88	214.95	120.35	11	174.05
Mrs.Bect.Fd	263.32	258.02	263.32	265.65	255.46	1462.71	1495.00	165.00	-	-
MSP Stl	34.55	33.96	34.55	34.99	33.75	401.59	46.43	26.16	14	33.96
MSTC	703.75	692.35	699.00	716.00	690.00	349.33	743.90	362.15	-	-
MTNL	26.71	26.79	26.85	27.06	26.70	392.40	48.14	20.30	-	26.81
MufinGreen	135.11	139.51	136.39	140.46	135.11	2108.84	140.46	82.99	-	-
Mukand Ind	134.57	136.96	134.60	138.51	133.11	84.38	154.20	114.65	3	137.65
Mukka Protin	26.38	26.29	26.55	26.70	25.96	373.77	31.23	18.27	-	-
Munj Auto [2]	114.85	115.13	115.70	117.99	112.21	1295.67	130.50	67.22	29	114.85
Muthoot MFin	208.61	213.21	210.01	214.34	209.10	190.09	262.77	141.20	-	-
MuthootFinan	2859.00	2970.00	2910.00	2997.80	2905.40	2309.96	4149.00	2603.30	11	2972.00
MV ELECTRO	570.20	568.30	570.95	578.80	564.40	471.67	686.50	520.00	-	-
MYSORE PETRO	137.91	165.49	160.00	165.49	155.30	383.98	165.49	111.00	-	-
N										
N C L IND.	173.19	174.05	173.19	178.00	172.12	27.11	220.95	147.65	6	173.95
NagarAgri [1]	173.99	170.10	175.50	175.51	169.52	225.80	264.78	112.55	101	170.00
Natco Pharm [2]	886.85	877.50	890.50	895.35	874.55	276.00	1226.10	789.30	18	877.75
NATIONAL FER	70.07	70.30	70.30	70.78	70.21	306.17	103.00	63.90	13	70.25
NationalAlum [5]	386.55	385.60	392.00	395.75	385.10	5349.75	445.10	183.85	10	385.40
Natl Stand	127.30	133.66	120.94	133.66	120.94	130.22	1519.95	120.94	-	-
Nava	549.20	556.75	550.00	558.00	550.00	150.38	739.40	501.65	-	-
Navin Fluori [2]	8277.50	8256.00	8300.00	8395.00	8222.00	59.43	8754.00	4500.10	74	8250.30
NAVKARCORP	97.40	96.88	99.00	99.00	96.18	268.83	132.50	74.28	36	96.80
Navneet Edu [2]	133.88	133.79	133.88	134.45	132.20	50.79	168.00	121.20	20	134.05
Nazara Tech	357.35	357.50	357.00	365.00	356.20	1774.61	1418.00	215.70	-	-
NBCC [1]	87.19	88.25	87.90	89.03	87.74	4634.30	126.00	77.17	35	88.33
NCC [2]	139.57	140.07	139.60	142.89	139.60	2224.26	222.50	130.20	14	140.10
NDR AutoComp	781.05	773.80	780.00	792.30	771.00	20.15	1186.60	605.05	-	-
NDTV [4]	73.34	75.50	73.55	76.57	73.55	101.52	134.30	58.77	-	75.65
NELCAST [2]	117.33	116.63	119.10	119.21	115.92	199.26	172.90	86.05	25	116.65
Nelco Ltd.	910.10	912.00	925.90	936.40	902.40	300.64	1120.60	502.40	227	915.55
Neogen Chem	2328.80	2259.10	2358.90	2368.70	2250.00	137.42	2483.90	966.70	-	-
Nephrocare	691.00	674.15	698.00	698.00	673.00	205.12	769.75	446.00	-	-
NESCO [2]	1033.00	1032.60	1030.90	1044.90	1028.70	17.42	1638.85	1000.00	18	1030.45
NESTLE (I) [1]	1465.00	1458.00	1482.00	1482.00	1454.60	1910.72	1553.00	1145.10	75	1456.65
Netweb Tech	5065.00	5419.80	5095.70	5449.90	5093.00	4457.31	5449.90	2037.30	-	-
Network18 Me [5]	28.07	30.59	28.24	31.24	28.05	45466.71	58.47	27.40	-	30.58
NetworkPeoSR	1594.20	1606.90	1582.50	1630.40	1582.50	19.96	2388.30	846.60	-	-
Neuland Lab	23290.00	23568.00	23154.00	23735.00	23154.00	50.06	23850.00	11500.00	61	23562.25
Newgen Soft	519.95	527.35	524.55	534.50	524.55	1546.77	1042.00	401.05	23	527.50
Neyveli Lig	268.05	272.05	267.45	273.50	267.10	1473.02	387.70	223.00	15	272.00
NGL Fine Chm	3040.40	3033.30	3086.00	3140.00	3000.10	7.55	3602.00	1271.00	-	-
NH	1785.70	1799.30	1790.00	1812.40	1790.00	197.59	2094.30	1564.25	63	1797.40
NHPC	76.17	76.35	76.35	76.95	75.90	6144.29	89.20	68.66	21	76.15
NIACL [5]	185.68	183.08	186.99	186.99	182.29	801.37	218.00	116.95	41	183.10
NIBE	1411.10	1503.60	1435.00	1542.80	1421.00	361.38	1848.00	809.60	-	-
NIIT [2]	92.32	92.58	92.40	93.10	91.80	188.84	117.65	49.45	-	92.45
NIIT Lrn.Sys	236.34	231.46	235.39	236.79	230.04	136.31	443.90	203.30	-	-
Nila Spaces	12.65	12.77	12.63	12.87	12.23	946.14	20.47	11.35	-	-
Nilkamal Ltd	2033.80	2043.70	2051.20	2074.00	1982.00	245.88	2105.00	1035.50	24	2045.15
NipponAM	1217.00	1232.50	1225.00	1266.20	1221.00	3152.92	1266.20	780.25	-	-
Nitco Tiles	90.15	89.61	90.00	91.89	89.33	747.52	130.00	64.20	-	89.80
NITINSPINNER	583.55	586.05	592.00	596.00	580.55	96.70	616.95	300.00	16	586.05
Niva Bupa	83.96	82.88	83.96	84.21	82.50	575.76	91.40	67.50	-	-
NMDC [1]	83.35	83.95	83.88	85.15	83.50	16534.91	97.49	68.19	10	84.23
NMDC Steel	40.15	39.52	40.50	40.65	39.30	5711.37	53.75	33.01	-	-
Nocil	161.57	161.66	162.19	163.69	161.10	264.22	203.25	125.35	34	161.60
Northern Arc	284.35	292.60	286.00	293.80	282.00	651.30	334.00	206.00	-	-
NovartisInd	1531.70	1482.20	1540.00	1574.90	1476.00	16.24	1780.00	1281.00	-	-
NRB Bearing [2]	483.15	483.20	488.95	489.70	478.15	233.23	504.00	213.10	36	481.40
NTPC Green E	91.70	91.88	92.00	92.35	91.62	996.07	119.95	84.00	-	-
NTPC	336.55	337.50	337.10	339.55	334.40	4185.08	414.40	315.55	14	338.00
Nucle.soft E	727.80	736.60	732.65	747.00	728.00	28.38	1129.95	681.50	18	735.25
Nuvama Wealt	1733.40	1727.90	1738.80	1749.90	1715.10	143.62	7640.00	1096.90	-	-
Nuvoco Vist.	318.50	321.70	317.80	322.60	317.00	204.64	477.50	276.25	-	-
O										
OBEROI REAL	1869.70	1904.70	1880.00	1914.80	1866.30	500.90	1985.00	1390.15	32	1906.00
Odisha Cem[2]	1875.00	1897.00	1875.00	1925.00	1864.00	582.88	2495.95	1605.00	266	1897.20
OIL INDIA	474.85	480.90	475.40	481.50	465.00	1364.70	531.00	384.60	12	480.35
Ola Electric	37.28	37.82	37.50	38.20	37.50	21869.02	71.24	21.21	-	37.85
OlectraGreen	1305.60	1291.20	1312.30	1326.00	1284.00	218.47	1714.20	866.60	-	-
OM Infra	85.04	84.67	86.40	86.46	84.29	64.34	144.00	71.50	-	-
Omax Autos.	195.27	199.74	196.00	204.00	192.00	54.19	265.85	84.65	10	197.40
OMAXE	99.41	103.16	99.58	104.00	99.02	1399.62	108.72	62.85	-	103.06
Omnitech Eng	586.65	574.00	588.80	615.00	570.00	1188.00	764.85	176.25	-	-
One PointOne	56.31	56.61	56.89	57.00	55.47	1161.84	65.85	40.58	-	-
ONEMI Tech	300.25	302.65	302.00	314.25	301.00	1666.92	351.50	190.00	-	-
OneMobiwik	195.61	195.66	195.61	198.39	194.20	894.00	334.00	151.46	-	-
OnesourceSpe	1520.50	1534.50	1524.50	1555.70	1518.20	73.14	1925.00	1057.00	-	-

For BSE/NSE live quotes, scan the QR code or click the link https://bit.ly/2FpossK

Company	Prev	Close	Open	High	Low	Qty	52 WH	52 WL	PE	BSE Cl
ONGC [5]	238.00	238.50	239.24	239.24	233.64	11886.28	307.50	227.60	7	238.10
ONIDA ELECT	36.93	36.67	37.60	37.60	36.05	236.60	49.23	21.50	-	-
Onward Techn	282.40	292.25	281.65	295.20	281.65	50.39	354.00	207.65	19	295.45
OPTIEMUS	546.70	551.75	559.95	563.50	547.55	89.56	712.95	289.90	266	549.95
ORACLE FIN [5]	11774.00	11826.00	11825.00	11917.00	11680.00	188.77	11986.90	6232.20	29	11862.05
Orchid Phr	979.50	980.05	981.35	994.60	971.10	54.87	1133.00	480.00	-	-
ORIENT CEM [1]	129.47	130.86	131.89	132.30	129.60	259.12	244.20	122.20	13	130.90
Orient Cera.	43.12	46.73	43.00	47.23	42.52	353.06	56.64	34.00	-	-
Orient Elec.	180.59	186.03	181.20	187.28	181.20	194.57	219.00	149.05	-	-
Orient Hotel [1]	139.50	137.29	138.00	139.00	131.02	5169.19	149.50	80.50	33	136.80
Orient Tech.	240.65	243.15	242.05	247.00	242.05	100.78	513.40	220.80	-	-
ORIENTBELL	343.35	339.20	345.40	348.10	335.90	24.64	378.05	241.00	24	339.70
Orissa Min [1]	4637.00	4651.50	4650.00	4712.30	4620.00	21.01	6132.00	3099.60	-	4657.35
Orkla India	551.00	550.35	551.95	562.00	548.05	67.22	760.00	533.25	-	-
OswalPumps	292.10	304.75	293.00	307.65	291.30	1646.64	888.40	283.10	-	-

P

Company	Prev	Close	Open	High	Low	Qty	52 WH	52 WL	PE	BSE Cl
P&G Health	5781.00	5832.50	5781.50	5913.00	5780.00	22.51	6975.00	4707.00	-	-

Company	Prev	Close	Open	High	Low	Qty	52 WH	52 WL	PE	BSE Cl
Sanofi ind	3271.30	3321.00	3299.00	3330.00	3258.10	17.05	5286.45	3057.60	22	3321.85
Sansera Engg	3894.30	3900.20	3938.10	3961.10	3860.00	91.74	4040.40	1241.30	-	-
Sanstar	106.19	105.23	106.99	107.22	105.05	172.44	137.49	74.30	-	-
Sapphire Fd	233.71	241.35	234.50	245.45	234.50	2320.02	347.90	139.91	-	-
Sarda EnMin [1]	512.05	509.35	512.00	516.50	507.15	301.57	639.95	452.75	20	508.30
Saregama (I) [1]	508.50	520.20	508.55	523.80	508.55	279.40	574.85	305.65	43	520.10
SarveshwarFd	3.40	3.39	3.40	3.44	3.39	1057.59	8.90	2.50	-	-
SASKEN COMM	1913.40	1874.10	1954.80	1954.80	1861.20	15.91	2785.05	993.05	32	1880.00
SATIN	225.09	226.98	227.70	231.00	226.00	163.57	274.20	133.50	7	226.60
SBC Exports	38.88	39.86	38.98	40.20	38.89	11579.39	45.00	15.55	-	-
SBFC Fin.	92.77	93.99	92.77	94.25	92.77	836.06	123.00	79.60	-	-
SBI Cards	623.65	647.05	626.80	654.35	626.75	5399.36	965.00	565.45	-	-
SBI FUNDS MAN	553.95	555.50	557.00	563.00	552.25	2461.68	624.95	550.20	-	-
SBILIFE	1780.40	1782.00	1790.00	1792.50	1775.40	687.83	2132.90	1701.05	69	1780.95
SChand Co [5]	137.14	135.03	137.35	137.97	133.81	61.86	202.10	130.50	46	134.50
SchlossBanga	532.80	539.70	540.35	544.35	528.15	1415.95	544.35	384.50	-	-
SCHNEIDER [2]	1253.80	1242.60	1270.00	1271.70	1236.00	433.57	1548.30	572.60	153	1241.90
ScodaTubes	126.07	126.68	126.07	129.00	125.25	172.95	187.70	110.00	-	-

Company	Prev	Close	Open	High	Low	Qty	52 WH	52 WL	PE	BSE Cl
Tenneco Cle	556.85	568.60	559.00	575.00	555.25	4980.27	657.00	438.05	-	-
TEXMACO RAIL [1]	102.65	105.48	103.59	106.70	103.55	1737.74	152.90	78.15	20	105.45
Thangamayil	5514.50	5457.00	5521.50	5598.00	5440.00	58.27	7429.00	1938.85	43	5456.85
Thejo Engg	2124.60	2101.20	2130.00	2246.40	2062.30	36.10	2286.60	1443.60	-	-
Thermax [2]	4025.50	4034.00	4025.00	4066.00	4025.00	59.60	5277.00	2744.20	93	4036.95
Thirumalai [1]	144.28	156.41	144.44	157.80	144.44	1691.65	328.70	143.75	-	156.20
Thomas Cook [1]	100.55	101.58	100.50	103.50	100.50	811.29	181.50	86.15	38	101.60
Thomas Scot	288.80	290.90	293.95	295.30	288.20	36.10	NA	NA	220	-
Thyrocare Te	582.50	566.70	586.90	590.00	564.05	682.09	662.00	342.55	54	567.20
TILAKNAG IND	573.85	582.45	576.45	586.30	575.00	683.27	591.20	371.50	63	582.35
TIME TECHNO [1]	190.89	191.63	190.95	194.75	190.95	3015.41	248.95	154.00	41	191.50
Timex Group	563.00	591.05	562.95	594.90	560.10	582.82	618.00	312.00	-	-
TIMKEN (I)	3231.80	3176.30	3230.00	3250.00	3170.00	14.94	3924.30	2847.00	58	3173.85
Tinna Rubber	1049.40	1047.40	1053.90	1059.70	1040.00	20.78	1322.00	527.45	-	-
Tips Music	651.70	651.05	650.10	657.00	647.00	166.21	741.00	481.15	-	-
Titagarh Rai	831.75	849.30	839.00	858.80	837.70	565.11	971.00	568.70	-	-
Titan Ind. [1]	5068.00	5068.00	5084.90	5110.00	5060.10	614.44	5168.55	3307.35	84	5062.00
TMB	838.85	869.70	840.10	872.55	840.10	202.41	917.00	411.80	-	-

Company	Prev	Close	Open	High	Low	Qty	52 WH	52 WL	PE	BSE Cl
DSPAMC - DSPSENXETF	79.55		80.18	1.38	88.20	73.27				-
DSPAMC - DSPSILVETF	218.13		227.26	529.83	390.00	107.15				-
EDELAMC - EBANK10	17.08		17.10	1.16	17.90	16.60				-
EDELAMC - EBANKNIFTY	57.93		58.13	0.61	69.39	50.05				-
EDELAMC - ECAPINSURE	23.80		24.18	69.68	25.88	20.50				-
EDELAMC - ELIQUID	1044.21		1044.36	12.43	1044.36	996.00				-
EDELAMC - ELM250	16.75		16.87	307.56	19.20	14.43				-
EDELAMC - ELMDIV	36.49		36.78	1.54	38.67	36.13				-
EDELAMC - EMETAL	12.97		12.97	23.73	15.21	12.41				-
EDELAMC - EMULTIMQ	41.82		41.72	40.71	43.54	36.25				-
EDELAMC - ENEXT50	75.00		74.19	0.68	75.14	68.59				-
EDELAMC - ENIFTY	24.28		24.38	1.10	27.99	22.28				-
EDELAMC - ESENSEX	77.68		77.91	0.15	88.05	71.87				-
EDELAMC ESILVER	226.44		235.29	95.81	375.00	111.70				-
Gold BeEs [1]	125.73		128.88	36486.44	148.42	81.74				128.85
Goldmanamc - CPSEETF	93.14		93.54	594.81	109.95	87.10				93.54
GorwwAMC-Def	98.11		97.91	178.86	102.07	71.78				-
GROWWAMC - CEMNTGROWW	14.89		14.94	61.09	16.27	14.50				-

Exchange Traded Funds

Company	Pr Cl	NSE Cl	Vol	52 WH	52 WL	BSE Cl
BFAM - BANK10BETF	20.62	20.86	1.25	24.90	20.17	-
BFAM -QUIDBETF	1095.20	1095.34	402.83	1116.24	1009.94	-
BFAM-BANKBETF	58.17	58.45	6.23	63.90	50.71	-
BFAM-NIFTYBETF	248.28	249.27	0.90	279.99	227.01	-
Birla Gold	133.97	137.00	723.33	155.86	86.62	137.00
Birla Nifty [1]	28.28	28.48	787.88	161.71	89.32	139.64
BirlaA-SLNN5	77.75	78.29	3.07	80.33	63.02	-
BIRLASLAMC - ABGSEC	114.55	114.32	0.01	116.23	108.18	-
BIRLASLAMC - ABSL10BANK	168.33	168.47	92.22	214.42	150.00	-
DSPAMC - BANK10ADD	16.81	16.91	3.78	18.99	12.08	-
DSPAMC - DSPBANK	58.70	59.01	4.27	62.90	51.01	-
DSPAMC - DSPGOLD	147.89	151.56	368.06	181.00	95.95	-
DSPAMC - DSPIT	32.14	32.62	74.64	41.92	27.17	-
DSPAMC - DSPNEWETF	345.44	347.46	5.22	361.00	304.78	-
DSPAMC - DSPNIFTY	254.07	255.67	2.62	300.00	232.64	-
DSPAMC - DSPPSBKETF	86.90	86.98	12.39	99.88	67.80	-
DSPAMC - DSPPVBKETF	27.76	27.94	26.86	31.88	24.02	-
DSPAMC - DSPQ50ETF	25.46	25.58	3.71	259.02	24.24	-

Company	Pr Cl	NSE Cl	Vol	52 WH	52 WL	BSE Cl
TATAAML-TNIDETF	90.06	90.80	41.94	103.26	74.50	-
UnionAMCGold	148.90	152.30	82.73	177.00	95.55	-
UTIAMC -QUIDBETA	1004.76	1004.91	0.00	1009.78	997.13	-
UTIAMC-BANKBETA	59.23	59.48	20.82	73.70	51.30	-
UTIAMC-GILT10BETA	26.80	26.87	0.59	27.14	25.10	-
UTIAMC-GILT5BETA	65.85	66.34	6.12	67.62	61.51	-
UTIAMC-ITBETA	322.95	323.34	1.34	409.94	270.68	-
Zerod Mid150	11.70	11.77	711.01	13.00	9.63	-
Zerod Top100	10.59	10.67	500.62	11.57	9.48	-
ZerodAMC-Liq	115.53	115.55	11632.65	115.56	102.00	-
ZerodAMSML10	11.19	11.31	914.09	11.74	8.50	-
ZerodhaA-Gol	23.93	24.56	10970.97	27.94	15.25	-
ZerodhAMCGil	30.58	30.55	51.52	31.31	28.71	-
ZerodhAMCSil	22.97	23.90	12583.21	38.01	11.34	-
ZerodhAM-Nif	9.67	9.74	606.63	11.40	8.84	-

*: Closing price is the average of trade price(s) for the last half an hour;52-Week High/Low figures pertain to BSE.

Shares of face value other than ₹10 is indicated in brackets immediately following the name of the company.

Qty (No of shares traded) is denoted in thousands.

The PE(price-earnings multiple) of each stock is based on the latest declared earnings.

The PE computation takes into account the per share earnings of each company for the latest 12 months.

BSE Stocks

Company	Pr Cl	Cl
Mishtann Fd [1]	3.34	3.32
Mitsu Chem	191.50	191.20
Mod.Insul.	439.60	461.55
Molbio Diagnos	1040.35	1032.40
Moschip [2]	206.30	206.35
Motherson Su [1]	39.27	39.18
Motilal Oswal	107.99	107.21
Motisons Jwl [1]	16.58	16.59
Mrs Bect.Fd [2]	263.30	258.10
MSTC	707.05	692.00
Mufin Green [1]	135.15	139.20
Mv Electrosyst	570.05	568.60
Mysore Petro	138.31	165.97
National Secur [2]	802.15	810.20
National Std	128.50	134.90
Nazara Tech [2]	358.80	358.05
NCL Research [1]	0.77	0.78
Neogen Chem	2328.95	2255.85
Nephrocare [2]	686.15	674.70
Netweb Tech [2]	5062.15	5418.85
NHC Foods [1]	1.63	1.71
Nibe	1409.95	1499.50
Nikhil Adhsv [1]	75.14	80.77
Nippon India M	27.08	27.17
Nippon India M	33.71	34.07
Nivabupa	84.04	83.05
NMDC Steel	40.15	39.57
Northern Arc	284.75	292.70

Company	Pr Cl	Cl
Pakka	88.56	88.37
Paradeep.Ph	150.90	148.70
Paras Def&Sp [5]	1496.10	1502.60
Pashupati Cots [1]	86.82	87.16
Paushak [5]	783.10	789.90
PayTM [1]	1585.20	1605.00
PB Fintech [2]	1780.00	1770.60
Physicwall [1]	122.00	121.95
Piccadily Ag	704.85	709.65
Pine Labs [1]	157.65	159.95
Piramal Financ [2]	2054.70	2125.15
Piramal Phr	209.55	216.50
Plaza Wire	50.13	52.15
PN GadgilJwl	603.90	609.50
Pngs Reva Diam	565.00	549.55
Polycab Ind	9100.00	9131.95
Prabha Energy [1]	199.55	213.20
Premier Enr [1]	1008.00	1037.30
Pulsar Intl. [1]	0.46	0.48
Quality Power	1295.60	1332.55
Raghav.Prod	1636.15	1613.75
RailTel Corp	286.85	280.75
Rajnish Wel [1]	0.41	0.41
Ram Rat.Wire [5]	484.80	486.05
Rashi Perip. [5]	837.55	856.10
Rategain Tr [1]	930.10	942.35
Ratnaveer Pr	250.05	269.10
Regaal Res [5]	97.08	95.55

Company	Pr Cl	Cl
Sapphire Fds [2]	233.70	241.10
SBC Exports [1]	38.72	39.82
SBFC Fin	92.78	93.96
SBI Card	626.30	646.05
Sbi Funds [1]	553.75	555.75
Schneider Elec	1982.00	1962.45
Sedemac Mechat	3223.20	3269.15
Senco Gold [5]	331.65	336.15
Senores Pharma	1552.80	1515.05
Seshaasai Tech	379.55	401.65
SG Finserv	692.50	682.95
SG Mart [1]	805.80	805.35
Shadowfax Tech	265.20	254.35
Shaily Eng [2]	3367.75	3348.90
Shakti Press	13.13	12.78
Shalimar Pro [1]	0.27	0.27
Shanti Edu. [1]	211.00	210.15
Shanti Gold In	240.65	254.45
Shilchar Tec	3918.55	3867.35
Shiprocket Lim	143.50	142.19
Shish Ind [1]	9.90	9.91
Shivalik Bim [2]	1028.15	1024.85
Shreeji Shippi	649.00	613.10
ShriraPist	4455.35	4516.35
Shukra Phr [1]	42.70	43.38
SI Paper	121.20	121.50
Siemens Ene [2]	3483.60	3436.60
Sigachi [1]	28.80	30.31

Company	Pr Cl	Cl
Spright Agr [1]	0.42	0.41
Standard Engin	309.50	306.85
Stanley Lif [2]	136.05	139.65
Star H&A Ins	583.75	575.55
Starlineps [1]	7.58	7.31

Company	Pr Cl	Cl
Titan Int [1]	0.95	0.97
TMB	839.60	870.00
TPI India [1]	22.44	23.02
Transrail Ligh [2]	458.10	459.75
Trishakti Ind [2]	239.90	248.20

Company	Pr Cl	Cl
Vintage Coff.	153.05	152.65
Vish.Pr.Pung	33.39	33.49
Vishal Fab [5]	18.19	18.52
VishalMega	103.40	102.60
Waaree Enr	2688.00	2684.00

NSE Trade for Trade